Project 3: the Etana epic (*Etana*; eBL L/1/9) → Hebrew

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Read `../../translation-guidelines.md`, `../corpus.md`, `../renderings.md` (§0–§7 and **§10, Etana**), then `../translator-brief--etana.md` (with `../translator-brief--kings.md` §1–§2 for the general rules). Round 3, run 2 of `../../curated-translation-candidates.md` (2026-10-21).

Scope

The whole Etana epic as eBL edits it (L/1/9), all six chapters, **585 lines**:

Key	eBL chapter	Lines	Manuscripts (eBL sigla)	Content
OBM	Old Babylonian, Morgan	54 (1–16, a+1–a+13, b+1–b+16, c+1–c+9)	BabaOB1 (MLC 1363, the "Morgan tablet"; Scheil's copy RT 23)	the gods without a king; kingship comes down from heaven; Etana takes a wife?; the serpent's revenge; the eagle in the pit; Etana frees him: "open my eyes to what is hidden"
OBS	Old Babylonian, Susa	48 (1–24, a+1–a+24)	the Susa tablet	the oath's curses; both give birth under the poplar; the shared hunt; the eagle's plot; the fledgling; the serpent's lament
MA	Middle Assyrian, Aššur	160 (a+1 … i+18)	AššMA1–2 (at least two tablets)	the oath, the friendship, the hunt, the plot, the ambush; Etana's dream; the rescue; the dreams; the flight
I	Standard Babylonian I	40 (1–29, a+1–a+11)	Nineveh	the city planned, no king, Ištar seeks a shepherd; Etana's wife's dream
II	Standard Babylonian II	152	Nineveh	the shrine of Adad and the poplar; the oath; the plot; Šamaš's ambush; the pit; Etana's prayer; the eagle found
III	Standard Babylonian III	131 (1–56, a+1–a+23, b+1–b+45, c+1–c+7)	Nineveh	the speech of birds; the first flight (Etana gives up); return; the dreams; the second flight to the gates of the gods

Base text: `../../sources/eBL/Etana-OB-Morgan/` … `Etana-SB-III/` (`reading-edition.md`: normalization N, Foster's
translation T, lemmas L, notes, parallels, ATF; `glossary.md`; generated by `tools/ebl_fetch.py` on 2026-10-21; git-
ignored, restorable with `tools/sources_sync.py`). Edition: Z. J. Földi (ed.), rev. A. Hätinen, E. Jiménez,
G. Rozzi (eBL 2026, with J. Novotny's digital edition); translation B. R. Foster. The end of the epic is lost.

Files

- `annotated-OBM.rtl.md`, `annotated-OBS.rtl.md`, `annotated-MA.rtl.md`, `annotated-I.rtl.md`, `annotated-II.rtl.md`,
  `annotated-III.rtl.md`: one per eBL chapter; entries `### <KEY>.<eBL label>` (`### II.45`, `### MA.c+3`), in eBL's
  order. The first line of each file after the title is `<!-- נוסח־תרגום: ... -->` (the version heading of the clean
  translation).
- `translation--intro.rtl.md` (the coordinator), `translation.rtl.md` (generated: `python3 -I ../kings_tools.py build ET`;
  it prints the eBL label without the chapter key, under the version heading).
- Tools: `python3 -I ../kings_tools.py verify ET [--strict]`, `data ET <from> <to> <out>` (the eBL block of each line +
  its related lines in all six versions with the Hebrew already given), `pars ET <from> <to>`, `lines ET <from>-<to>`,
  `grep all '<regex>'` (all corpora, Sumerian and Akkadian).

Line numbering

eBL's labels (George-style: `a+1` = the first preserved line after a gap of unknown length). The literature's older
numbering (Kinnier Wilson 1985; Foster; Dalley; Haul 2000) differs (e.g. SB II = Kinnier Wilson's "Tablet II"); eBL's
`Parallels:` field gives the correspondences between the versions. No concordance to older numbering is made here.

The parts (renderings §10.5) and progress

Part	Lines	Translator	Status
ET2	OBS 1–a+24; MA a+1–c+31; II 1–72	sub-agent	**done** 2026-10-22 (179 lines, three passes; merged: renderings §10.6.1)
ET1	OBM 1–a+13; I 1–a+11	sub-agent	**done** 2026-10-22 (69 lines, three passes; merged: renderings §10.6.2)
ET3	II 73–152; OBM b+1–c+9; MA d+1–f+18	sub-agent	**done** 2026-10-22 (153 lines, three passes; merged: renderings §10.6.3)
ET4	III 1–c+7; MA g+1–i+18	sub-agent	**done** 2026-10-22 (184 lines, three passes; merged: renderings §10.6.4)

Open decisions (the coordinator's summary, 2026-10-22)

Each part's numbered list is in its section below; the minor ones were decided there (the user's rule) and merged into
`../renderings.md` §10.6. **Nothing major is left for the user.** Left for the next cross-corpus harmonization (they
touch other corpora, which other Round 3 sessions were editing; listed in `../../STATUS.md` §6):

1. *šarāku* הָעֲנִיק (= Sum. *rig₇*, EA) vs Gilgameš *qiāšu* הָעֲנִיק (two verbs, one Hebrew).
2. Enki and the World Order's boat אקו־האפסו (*taraḫ*) vs *taraḫ* = *turāḫu* = יָעֵל (EA, Agade, Etana) and *armu* =
   אַקּוֹ (Etana): proposal יעל־האפסו.
3. *ḫaṭṭu* שרביט (here, EA) vs שבט (Enūma eliš IV 29, LH): proposal שרביט for *ḫaṭṭu* everywhere, שבט for
   šabbiṭu only.
4. *parakku* כֵּס (here, EA *barag*) vs דוכן (Enūma eliš); Sum. *aga* עטרת (EWO 264) vs *agû* כתר (Gilgameš). **Settled 2026-10-23** (`../../harmonization--2026-10-23.md` row 5): *parakku* = דּוּכָן (I.15, I.23, II.3, II.4, OBM.9).
5. *palgu* תעלה (here) vs the cognate פֶּלֶג (Enūma eliš): proposal פֶּלֶג everywhere. **Settled 2026-10-23** (`../../harmonization--2026-10-23.md` row 7): פֶּלֶג (MA.i+10 מי פלג[כ]).
6. *buginnu* שוקת (here; = Sum. *buniĝ*, Gudea) vs Gilgameš *mašqû* שוקת: proposal *mašqû* מַשְׁקֶה.
7. Smaller splits recorded by the parts: *šērtu* עֹנֶשׁ (Atra-ḫasīs, here) vs אַשְׁמָה (Gilgameš, Ludlul); *ērišu*
   חתן vs Gilgameš *ḫāmiru*; *nāʾeru* שואג vs צורח; *ṣapāru* / *raʾzu* **משובץ**; *ḫiāṭu* בחן vs *barû* בוחן; *ina ūmīšu* ביום ההוא vs בעת ההיא; *galātu* התפלץ vs Sum. *ḫuluḫ* נבהל; *qarānu* ערם beside Sum. *dub*.

Parts

(each translator adds its section: progress and the three review passes, `### Parallels index (ET1)` … with the columns
`| Line | Source | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |`, key findings, open decisions, proposals)

Part ET1 – before the king (OB Morgan 1–a+13; SB I 1–a+11), 2026-10-22

Round 3, run 2 (`../renderings.md` §10.5). Translator: sub-agent ET1. Files: `annotated-OBM.rtl.md` (header for the
whole tablet + 1–16, a+1–a+13; ET3 adds one paragraph on its lines and b+1–c+9), `annotated-I.rtl.md` (the whole
tablet: header + 1–29, a+1–a+11). **69 entries.** Not committed.

Progress and passes

- **Order of work:** OB Morgan first (it fixes the Hebrew of the prologue), then SB I, copying the OB Hebrew wherever
  the Akkadian is the same (OBM 1–10 ≈ I 8–17; OBM a+2 ≈ I a+2) and varying only where it varies; both entries of each
  pair say what the other version has.
- **Data:** `kings_tools.py data ET` for both ranges; eBL dictionary per word (ṣapāru, saḫāru, ištēniš, dapnu, šibirru,
  meānu, mitluku, šiāti); every transliteration precedent searched in the annotated files of all corpora (a scratch
  helper that greps the backticked lines and prints the Hebrew) and every new Hebrew word with `kings_tools.py grep all`.
  Every Bible verse printed with `check_bible_quotes.py --show` before quoting.
- **Pass (a) fidelity:** every `>` line against N and the ATF. Fixed: I.4 `הָאֱלו[ִים?` (the ATF has *DINGIR#-[MEŠ?*: the
  word is there, only the plural sign is broken; eBL's N brackets the whole word); I.1 note that *āla īṣirū* is broken
  on NinNA1 but preserved in the incipit quotations (hence no brackets); I.a+3 the tablet's *šu-ut-tu* (nom.) against
  N's *šutta*; OBM.13 `⟨לְ⟩` for the scribe's omitted *<a-na>*; I.15 the scribe's superfluous *kibrāti* (dittography from
  I.10) left untranslated, with a note.
- **Pass (b) consistency:** the OB/SB pairs compared line by line (identical Hebrew where identical Akkadian:
  `הָאֱנוּנֻכִּי ... גוזרי`, `בוני קצות (הארץ)`, `לאנשים`, `חג`, `גזרו`, `שָׁמוּ`, `מלך`, `ושרביט – ספיר לא` **`משובץ`**,
  `נעל`, `הַכְּסִים – יחדיו – לא בנויים –`; I.1 = I.3, I.2 = I.4, I.19 ~ I.21, I.20 = I.22); renderings §10.4 checked
  (`מצנפת`, `עטרה`, `שרביט`, `כֶּס`, `רועה`, `המלכות – מן השמים ירדה`, `לְבֵנָה`, `אֵט`); every new word grepped in all
  corpora (collisions listed under open decisions 2–8).
- **Pass (c) Hebrew:** read aloud; vocalized what would be misread: `יָצָרוּ` (not "besieged"), `לְבֵנָתָהּ`, `הַכְּסִים`
  (not "pockets"), `אִטּוֹ`, `מוֹתָם`, `אֵל?`, `אֵלַי`, `בַּנָּאָן`, `רוֹעָן`, `נִמְלָהּ`, `בָּהּ`, `שָׁמֵי` / `שׁוּמִים` / `שָׁמוּ`,
  `הֵרָ[אֲנִי`, `כּוֹנְנוּ`, `קַח`; names (`אֶתֶנָה`, `אִשְׁתַּר`, `אָנוּ`) at every occurrence in the `>` lines and headings.
- **Checks:** `python3 -I kings_tools.py verify ET` – 248 entries, OK (no problem; only the coverage note for the parts
  not yet drafted). `python3 -I ../tools/check_bible_quotes.py annotated-OBM.rtl.md annotated-I.rtl.md` (and this file) –
  0 problems.

Deviations from renderings §10 and the guidelines (decided at the first occurrence, with the reason)

1. ***eṣēru* = יָצַר, written יָצְרוּ (vocalized)**, not the צָר of guidelines §6.7: את העיר צרו reads "they besieged the city" (צור), the very opposite. Same root (the guidelines' "*eṣēru* = יצר"), and it shows the
   cognate of Isa 37:26 / 46:11 / 22:11 (יָצָר "planned") and Gen 2:7.
2. ***šibirru* = מַקֵּל־רוֹעִים** (§10.4 had מַקֵּל? for ET1 to decide): the Sumerian *šibir* already has מקל־רועים (Enki and the World Order 436), and a Sumerian word takes the Hebrew of its Akkadian equivalent
   (renderings §0.3); the compound also keeps eBL's "shepherd's staff". שֵׁבֶט stays free for *šabbiṭu* (Gilgameš XII).
3. ***malāku*: G = יָעַץ, Gt = נִמְלַךְ**, as in Gilgameš (OB III *imallikū* יועצים; VII 1 *imtallikū* נמלכו); so OBM.2 יעצו and I.9 נמלכו show the stems' difference. *mitluku* = נִמְלָךְ (Gilgameš II 30).
4. ***nadû* in *uššī nadû* = הניח** (Gilgameš I 21), not the gated הִשְׁלִיךְ.

Parallels index (ET1)

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
OBM.2	ušbū imlikū milikša mātam	ישבו, יעצו – את עצתה את הארץ	זֹאת הָעֵצָה הַיְעוּצָה עַל כָּל הָאָרֶץ (ישעיהו יד:כו)	equivalent	*milik māti malāku* = "the counsel counselled concerning the land": the same phrase; a sitting council of gods against the one God's counsel.
OBM.2	imlikū (malāku)	יעצו / נמלכו (I.9)	וַיִּמָּלֵךְ לִבִּי עָלַי (נחמיה ה:ז)	cognate	G = יָעַץ, Gt = נִמְלַךְ (Gilgameš).
OBM.3	bānû kibrātim	בוני קצות (הארץ)	בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֵת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֵת הָאָרֶץ (בראשית א:א)	divergence	The gods "build" (*banû*) the world's edges and "set" its form; Foster's "creators" would invite בָּרָא (reserved).
OBM.5	isinnam ana nišī išīmū	חג – לאנשים גזרו	וְהָיוּ לְאֹתֹת וּלְמוֹעֲדִים (בראשית א:יד); מוֹעֲדֵי יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר תִּקְרְאוּ אֹתָם מִקְרָאֵי קֹדֶשׁ (ויקרא כג:ב)	equivalent	Festival times decreed from above for people. **Foster's "holy day" is not in the text** (*isinnu* = festival; the root קדש reserved).
OBM.6	šarram lā iškunū	מלך לא שָׂמוּ	שׂוֹם תָּשִׂים עָלֶיךָ מֶלֶךְ (דברים יז:טו); עַתָּה שִׂימָה לָּנוּ מֶלֶךְ לְשָׁפְטֵנוּ כְּכָל הַגּוֹיִם (שמואל א ח:ה)	equivalent	The same idiom "set a king" (*šakānu* = שָׂם); in the Bible the people ask, here the gods have not yet given. Also I.12.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
OBM.7	ina šiātim lā kaṣrat kubšum meānum	לא – בָּהּ קשורה מצנפת, עטרה	וְכֹל שִׁיחַ הַשָּׂדֶה טָרֶם יִהְיֶה בָאָרֶץ (בראשית ב:ה)	divergence	**Statives, not "not yet"**: Foster's "Then no headdress had been ..." / "Nor yet" (8) manufacture טָרֶם (reserved). The shared structure is real: a world lacking one office, filled from above.
OBM.7	kubšum meānum	מצנפת, עטרה	הָסֵיר הַמִּצְנֶפֶת וְהָרֵם הָעֲטָרָה (יחזקאל כא:לא)	equivalent	The same pair of royal insignia, given and taken by the god. Also OBM.11.
OBM.8	u haṭṭum uqniam lā ṣaprat	ושרביט – ספיר לא *משובץ*	לֹא יָסוּר שֵׁבֶט מִיהוּדָה וּמְחֹקֵק מִבֵּין רַגְלָיו (בראשית מט:י)	equivalent	The sceptre as the sign of rule; *ḫaṭṭu* = שַׁרְבִיט, שֵׁבֶט kept for *šabbiṭu*. Also I.14.
OBM.8	uqniam	ספיר	כְּמַעֲשֵׂה לִבְנַת הַסַּפִּיר (שמות כד:י)	equivalent	Lapis lazuli = the biblical סַפִּיר.
OBM.10	sebetta bābū uddulū eli dapnim	שבעה שערים – נעולים על העריץ	שְׂאוּ שְׁעָרִים רָאשֵׁיכֶם וְהִנָּשְׂאוּ פִּתְחֵי עוֹלָם וְיָבוֹא מֶלֶךְ הַכָּבוֹד (תהלים כד:ז)	divergence	Our proposal: there the gates open to the king, here they are bolted against any would-be strongman (*dapnu* = Gilgameš's העריץ).
OBM.11	šibirrum	מקל־רועים	רְעֵה עַמְּךָ בְשִׁבְטֶךָ צֹאן נַחֲלָתֶךָ (מיכה ז:יד); שִׁבְטְךָ וּמִשְׁעַנְתֶּךָ הֵמָּה יְנַחֲמֻנִי (תהלים כג:ד)	equivalent	The shepherd's staff among the royal insignia.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
OBM.13	ul ibašši mitlukum ana nišīša	אין נְמְלָךְ ⟨ל⟩ אנשיה	בְּאֵין תַּחְבֻּלוֹת יִפֹּל-עָם וּתְשׁוּעָה בְּרֹב יוֹעֵץ (משלי יא:יד)	equivalent	A people without counsel; in Hebrew נְמְלָךְ also sounds "king" (מלך) – a Hebrew bonus, noted as such.
OBM.14	[šar]rūtum ina šamāʾī urdam	[המל–]כות מן השמים ירדה	וַיֵּרֶד יְהוָה לִרְאֹת אֶת הָעִיר וְאֶת הַמִּגְדָּל אֲשֶׁר בָּנוּ בְּנֵי הָאָדָם (בראשית יא:ה)	cognate	*warādu* / יָרַד; [divergence]: in Gen 11 God comes down to stop a human city, here kingship comes down to a city the gods planned. The Sumerian King List's idiom ("when kingship was lowered from heaven, kingship was in Kiš"). **Reading *šarrūtum* (collation, eBL), not Wilcke's *bēltum* "the Lady (Ištar) came down".**
OBM.14	(the first kingship after the flood)	–	וְכוּשׁ יָלַד אֶת נִמְרֹד הוּא הֵחֵל לִהְיוֹת גִּבֹּר בָּאָרֶץ (בראשית י:ח); וַתְּהִי רֵאשִׁית מַמְלַכְתּוֹ בָּבֶל וְאֶרֶךְ וְאַכַּד וְכַלְנֵה בְּאֶרֶץ שִׁנְעָר (בראשית י:י)	divergence	Genesis's first post-flood kingdom is a human "mighty one" who "began" it, not a gift from heaven. Cush = Kiš is a scholarly proposal, in the apparatus only. מַמְלָכָה reserved.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
OBM.14	urdam	ירדה	הֵם הִמְלִיכוּ וְלֹא מִמֶּנִּי (הושע ח:ד)	divergence	Kingship must come from above; in Hosea the people crown kings themselves.
OBM.a+1	leqē-[ma?]	קַח [...]	וְלָקַחְתָּ אִשָּׁה לִבְנִי לְיִצְחָק (בראשית כד:ד)	cognate	*leqû* / לָקַח; the marriage idiom only if the object is a wife (a+2, a+6): our cautious proposal.
I.1	āla īṣirū	את העיר יָצְרוּ	מִימֵי קֶדֶם וְיֹצַרְתִּיהָ עֲתָּה הֲבֵאתִיהָ (ישעיהו לז:כו); יָצַרְתִּי אַף אֲעֲשָׂנָּה (ישעיהו מו:יא)	cognate	*eṣēru* "draw, plan" = יָצַר "plan beforehand" in the god's mouth. The incipit is also the series' name.
I.1	īṣirū	יָצְרוּ	וַיִּיצֶר יְהוָה אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאָדָם עָפָר מִן הָאֲדָמָה (בראשית ב:ז)	cognate	The same root for the god's first act; here its first object is a city.
I.1	āla īṣirū	את העיר יָצְרוּ	הָבָה נִבְנָה לָּנוּ עִיר (בראשית יא:ד)	divergence	In Gen 11 humans plan and build a city and God stops them; here the city is the gods' plan from the start.
I.2	[uššīšu] iddû	[את אֻשָּׁיהָ] הניחו	יְהֵב אֲשַׁיָּא דִּי בֵית אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם (עזרא ה:טז)	cognate	*uššu* → Aramaic אֲשַׁיָּא; the same idiom "lay the foundations". Also I.4 (Ezra 4:12 וְאֲשַׁיָּא יַחֲיטוּ).
I.5	libna[ssu]	לִבֵּנָתָהּ	וַתְּהִי לָהֶם הַלְּבֵנָה לְאָבֶן (בראשית יא:ג)	cognate	*libittu* / לְבֵנָה; [divergence]: the gods (the Igigi) set the city's bricks.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
l.5	ukinnū	כּוֹנְנוּ	אֱלֹהִים יְכוֹנְנֶהָ עַד-עוֹלָם (תהלים מח:ט)	equivalent	The god establishes his city.
l.6	[amī]lu? lū rēʾûšin[a]	[אד]–ם? יהי רוֹעֶן	יִפְקֹד יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי הָרוּחֹת לְכָל בָּשָׂר אִישׁ עַל הָעֵדָה (במדבר כז:טז); וְלֹא תִהְיֶה עֲדַת יְהוָה כַּצֹּאן אֲשֶׁר אֵין לָהֶם רֹעֶה (במדבר כז:יז); וְהוּא יִהְיֶה לָהֶן לְרֹעֶה (יחזקאל לד:כג)	equivalent	"A man" appointed as shepherd; Ezekiel has even the feminine plural suffix (*-šina* / לָהֶן).
l.6	[amī]lu? lū rēʾûšin[a]	[אד]–ם? יהי רוֹעֶן	וְאָדָם אַיִן לַעֲבֹד אֶת הָאֲדָמָה (בראשית ב:ה); וַיָּשֶׂם שָׁם אֶת הָאָדָם אֲשֶׁר יָצָר (בראשית ב:ח)	divergence	Our proposal: in both beginnings "a man" is missing for an office, and the deity "forms" (יָצַר / *eṣēru*, l.1) and "sets" (שָׂם / *šakānu*, OBM.6): to work the ground there, to shepherd the people here.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
l.7	e[t]ana lū itinšina	אֵ[תָ]נָה – יהי בַּנָּאָן	וַיְהִי בֹּנֶה עִיר וַיִּקְרָא שֵׁם הָעִיר כְּשֵׁם בְּנוֹ חֲנוֹךְ (בראשית ד:יז)	equivalent	Our proposal: city, builder, son, name – the elements of Etana's story (his quest for a son, "establish a name for me", II.142). The name explained by a role (*Etana* / *itinnu*) as קָנִיתִי (בראשית ד:א) / קַיִן.
l.7	itinnu	בַּנָּאָן	וַיִּבֶן אֶת נִינְוֵה וְאֶת רְחֹבֹת עִיר וְאֶת כָּלַח (בראשית י:יא)	equivalent	The first kings after the flood as city builders.
l.13	ina ūmīšū-ma	ביום ההוא	בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם אֵין מֶלֶךְ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל אִישׁ הַיָּשָׁר בְּעֵינָיו יַעֲשֶׂה (שופטים יז:ו)	equivalent	"In those days" + "no king". OB has *ina šiātim* בָּהּ (OBM.7).
l.13	ina ūmīšū-ma	ביום ההוא	בְּיוֹם עֲשׂוֹת יְהוָה אֱלֹהִים אֶרֶץ וְשָׁמָיִם (בראשית ב:ד)	divergence	The "on the day when" opening before the description of what is lacking (Gen 2:5) – but with no "not yet".

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
l.19	ištar rēʾâ … (l.20) u šarra išeʾʾi	– אִשְׁתַּר … רועה ומלך – מבקשת	בִּקֵּשׁ יְהוָה לוֹ אִישׁ כִּלְבָבוֹ וַיְצַוֵּהוּ יְהוָה לְנָגִיד עַל עַמּוֹ (שמואל א יג:יד); וְהִנֵּה רֹעֶה בַּצֹּאן (שמואל א טז:יא); וַיִּבְחַר בְּדָוִד עַבְדּוֹ וַיִּקָּחֵהוּ מִמִּכְלְאֹת צֹאן (תהלים עח:ע)	equivalent	The deity "seeks" a shepherd who will be king (*šeʾû* = בִּקֵּשׁ). **Foster's "came down from heaven to seek" (l.19, 21) is a restoration resting on the abandoned reading *bēltum* in OBM 14.** Also l.21–22.
l.23	enlil ihâṭ parakki šamê	אֶנְלִיל בוחן את דוכן השמים	יְהוָה בַּשָּׁמַיִם כִּסְאוֹ עֵינָיו יָחֻזּוּ עַפְעַפָּיו יִבְחָנוּ בְּנֵי אָדָם (תהלים יא:ד)	equivalent	A throne in heaven and a god who "examines".
l.28	ilū māt[āti?]	אֵלֵי הָאָרָ[צות?]	מִי בְכָל אֱלֹהֵי הָאֲרָצוֹת אֲשֶׁר הִצִּילוּ אֶת אַרְצָם מִיָּדִי (מלכים ב יח:לה)	equivalent	The same phrase (אֱלֹהִים reserved: אֵלֵי).
l.a+2	[mar]hīssu ana šâšū-m[a]	[רעי]תו אליו	וַתָּבֹא הָאִשָּׁה וַתֹּאמֶר לְאִישָׁהּ (שופטים יג:ו)	divergence	The (barren, 13:2) wife of Manoah tells her husband of a revelation that ends in a son; here the wife of a sonless king tells a dream. [absent]: no woman dreams in the Hebrew Bible.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
I.a+3	[š]utta yâši ušab[rânni]	[ח]לום – לי הֶרְ[אַנִי] –	כֹּה הִרְאַנִי אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה וְהִנֵּה (עמוס ז:א); אֲשֶׁר הָאֱלֹהִים עֹשֶׂה הֶרְאָה אֶת פַּרְעֹה (בראשית מא:כח)	equivalent	The dream is "shown" (*barû* Š), as the prophet's vision and Pharaoh's dream.
I.a+7	eṭemmašu	אִטו	אֵין לִי בֵּן בַּעֲבוּר הַזְכִּיר שְׁמִי (שמואל ב יח:יח)	equivalent	The sonless man's care for his name after death; [absent] the Torah has no cult of the ghost (אֱלֹהִים רָאִיתִי עֹלִים מִן הָאָרֶץ, שמואל א כח:יג, only through the forbidden אוֹב).

Key findings

The Bible.

1. **The opening is not a "when not yet" opening.** OBM 7–9 are statives ("not bound", "not set", "not built");
   Foster's "Then no headdress had been …", "Nor yet" import the טֶרֶם of Gen 2:5. What *is* shared is the structure:
   a world that lacks one office ("no man to work the ground" / "no king"), filled from above by a god who "forms"
   (*eṣēru* = יָצַר, I.1; Gen 2:7) and "sets" (*šakānu* = שָׂם, OBM.6; Gen 2:8).
2. **Gen 11 inverted.** In Etana the gods plan the city (*eṣēru* = יָצַר, the "planning" of Isa 37:26, 46:11), lay
   its foundations (*ušše*, the source of Aramaic אֱשַׁיָּא, Ezra 5:16 – the same idiom) and set its bricks (*libittu*
   = לְבֵנָה, Gen 11:3), and then kingship "comes down" (*warādu* = יָרַד). In Gen 11 humans plan and build, and God
   "comes down" (11:5) to stop them. Gen 10:8–10 makes the first post-flood kingdom a human achievement (הַחֵל,
   גִּבֹּר), where the Sumerian King List and Etana have kingship lowered from heaven to Kiš (Cush = Kiš only as a
   proposal).

3. **The vocabulary of kingship is shared**: "set a king" (*šarram šakānu* = שׂוּם מֶלֶךְ, Deut 17:15, 1 Sam 8:5); the kingless "in those days" (SB I.13; Judg 17:6, 21:25); the insignia pair עֲטָרָה / מִצְנֶפֶת (Ezek 21:31); the shepherd's staff (Mic 7:14, Ps 23:4); "a man as their shepherd" (I.6; Num 27:16–17; Ezek 34:23 with the same feminine plural suffix); the deity who "seeks" a shepherd-king (I.19–22; 1 Sam 13:14, 16:11, Ps 78:70–71); the god who "examines" from his throne in heaven (I.23; Ps 11:4); "the counsel counselled concerning the land" (OBM.2; Isa 14:26).
4. **A builder without a son.** I.7 calls Etana the people's "builder" (*itinnu*, a play on his name); Gen 4:17's first city-builder names the city after his son. Etana's story will turn on the son he does not have (II.140–142 "establish a name for me"); the wife's dream (I.a+2–a+7) mentions "his ghost", whose care needs a son (2 Sam 18:18 Absalom).
5. **False echoes avoided** (rank-3 English): "holy day" (*isinnu* = חַג), "Then … had not / Nor yet" (statives), "creators" (*bānû* "builders", not בָּרָא), "right counsel", "four world regions" (I.10: an old restoration), "came down from heaven to seek" (I.19, 21: a restoration resting on the abandoned *bēltum*), "with ramparts" (I.18), "instead of" (*kīma*, I.a+4–a+5). The reading *[šar]rūtum* (OBM.14, collation) removes Ištar's descent from heaven.

The ancient mind.

1. **The city before the king.** The gods plan the city, lay its foundations and bricks (the Igigi, the labouring gods of Atra-ḫasīs) and surround it (I.18); the world already has edges, form, people and a festival. Only kingship is missing – and it is not a human invention but an object kept "before Anu in heaven" (OBM.11–12): sceptre, tiara, turban, shepherd's staff.
2. **Kingship cannot be seized.** "Seven gates are bolted against the aggressive one" (OBM.10): no strongman can take it; it must be lowered (OBM.14, the Sumerian King List's idiom). The SB rereads the number as the Seven gods (the Sebetti) who bar the gates against "the multitude" and "the settlements" (I.16–17) – the whole of humankind shut out.

3. **The king's two faces**: shepherd and builder (I.6–7) – the leader of the human flock and the builder of the city
   and its temples, the two roles of every Mesopotamian royal inscription; the name Etana explained by *itinnu*.
4. **The goddess chooses**: Ištar/Innina "seeks" a shepherd and a king, as she "loved" Sargon; Enlil inspects the dais
   of heaven – a coronation prepared above before a king is found below. The festival (OBM.5) is "decreed" with the same
   verb as fate: joy is part of humanity's lot.
5. **A wife's dream**: dreams are "shown" by a god (*barû* Š), and women dream and interpret (Ninsun, the women of the
   Mari letters); the dream concerns Etana, "their death?" and "his ghost" – the dead who need a son to pour water for
   them (Gilgameš XII 152).
6. **The scribes**: the incipit *āla īṣirū* is the series' title in the Nineveh colophons (Langdon 1931 read "the city
   they hated"); the SB copyist wrote *kibrāti* by mistake in I.15, carried over from I.10 – writing from memory.

Open decisions (numbered; the minor ones decided)

1. ***eṣēru* = יָצְרוּ** instead of guidelines §6.7's צָר (decided; reason above). The coordinator may add to §6.7:
   "צָר for drawing images; the full יָצַר where צר could read צוּר 'besiege'".
2. ***ḫaṭṭu* across corpora (lead):** שַׁרְבִּיט here (renderings §10.4; Gilgameš VIII 128, 153; Sum. *ĝidru* in the
   laments and Gudea), but Enūma eliš IV 29 and LH (prologue 161, epilogue 3187′, 3356′, 3392′) give *ḫaṭṭu* / GIDRU
   שֶׁבֶט – while Gilgameš XII 19, 39 give שֶׁבֶט to its cognate *šabbiṭu*. Proposal: *ḫaṭṭu* = שַׁרְבִּיט everywhere,
   שֶׁבֶט only for *šabbiṭu*.
3. ***parakku* (lead):** כֵּס (Etana II, here; EA *barag*) vs Enūma eliš דוכן (V 115; VI 51, 53, 58, 68, 118). **Settled 2026-10-23** (../../harmonization--2026-10-23.md row 5): דּוּכָן.
4. ***meānu*** (10.4§) עֲטָרָה vs Enki and the World Order 264, Sum. *aga* עטרת (= Akk. *agû*, כֶּתֶר in Gilgameš):
   EWO's *aga* should probably be כֶּתֶר (lead). *kubšu* מִצְנֶפֶת = Sum. *saĝšu* מצנפת (EA 578) – consistent; but
   Enūma eliš VII 8 has **מצנפתו** for *šukūssu* (italic) – a minor split.

5. ***ṣapāru* משובץ** collides with Gilgameš VIII 170, 185 *raʾzu* **משובץ** (both uncertain, both italic). Kept
   (decided): it is the natural Hebrew for a stone set in metal, and both renderings are marked uncertain; alternatives
   tried and rejected: קבוע (EA *us*$_2$; reads "permanent"), מוטבע (LH/EST *ṭebû* = טבע), משוקע (*šabāḫu*).
6. ***barû* Š and *kullumu* both הֶרְאָה** (renderings §10.3 sets both; flood: XI 197 הראיתי חלום; Gilgameš OB
   הַרְאֵנִי): a pre-set double mapping. Left (natural Hebrew for both); ET4 should note it where both occur (coordinator).
7. ***ḫiāṭu* בָּחַן** (Gilgameš I 19, 41) vs Enūma eliš *barû* בוחן (IV 65, 135; VII 35) and the wisdom corpus
   bārû הַבּוֹחֵן: an existing collision; I followed Gilgameš (lead).
8. ***ina ūmīšū-ma* ביום ההוא** (Gilgameš III 95, VIII 41) vs בעת ההיא (Enūma eliš IV 63, Adapa, the Founding of
   Eridu): I followed Gilgameš (lead may harmonize).
9. **OBM.7 *ina šiātim* = בָּהּ** (decided): literal "in it/her", leaving open eBL's "at that (time)" and Streck's "in it
   (the land) = here".
10. **OBM.13 *mitlukum* = נִמְלָךְ** (decided; Gilgameš II 30): fits both the adjective "circumspect" and the
    infinitive "deliberation"; הִמָּלְכוּת was rejected because unvocalized it reads המלכות "the kingship" (OBM.14).
11. **I.24 מבקשת ומבקשת** (decided): feminine, continuing Ištar's verb (I.20, 22); the subject may be Enlil (I.23).
12. **The formula *X ana šâšū-ma ana Y izzakaršu* = X אליו, אל Y, דיבר:** (I.a+2, decided): for ET4 (III b+15,
    b+26, b+32, b+36 → הנשר אליו, אל אֶתָנָה, דיבר:). A FORMULAS regex could be added (coordinator).
13. **I.4 brackets** (decided): האל[ים? per the ATF (*DINGIR#-[MEŠ?*), although eBL's N brackets the whole word.
14. **OBM.a+1–a+13 and I.a+2–a+7**: whether OB Morgan col. ii tells Etana's marriage, and whether it is the same scene
    as SB I a+2, cannot be decided from the fragments; the notes say "perhaps" only.

Proposals for the corpus renderings

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
eṣēru	יָצַר (יְצָרוּ, vocalized)	cognate	Isa 37:26, 46:11; Gen 2:7; not צָרוּ ("besieged")	l.1, l.3
uššu; *ušší nadû*	הניח ;(אֲשִׁיָּהּ) אֲשִׁים / אֲשִׁים	cognate (Aram. אֲשַׁיָּא)	Gilgameš I 21 string את אֲשִׁיָּהּ ... הניחו	l.2, l.4
libittu	לְבֵנָה (לְבֵנָתָהּ)	cognate	gated; Gen 11:3	l.5
kânu D	כּוֹנֵן	equivalent	Ps 48:9	l.5
šīmtu; *šiāmu*; *šā ʾimu* / *mušīmu*	גּוֹרָל ; גְּזַר ; גּוֹזֵר	–	הָאֲנוּנְכִי הגדולים, גוזרי הגורל, / SB גוזרי הגורלות	OBM.1, 5; l.8, 11
malāku G; Gt; *milku*; *mitluku*	יָעַץ ; נִמְלַךְ ; עֵצָה ; נָמְלָךְ	cognate (Gt) / equivalent (Isa 14:26)	ישבו, יעצו את עצתה – את הארץ. / [יש]בו, נמלכו (על) עצתם, [של הארץ?], / אין נָמְלָךְ ⟨ל⟩ אנשיה.	OBM.2, 13; l.9
bānû; *kibrātu*; *šākinu*; *šikittu*	בּוֹנָה ; קְצוֹת (הָאָרֶץ) ; שָׁם (שָׁמֵי) ; מַתְכֹּנֶת	–	בוני קצות (הארץ), שָׁמֵי הַמַּתְכֹּנֶת,	OBM.3; l.10
ṣīru; *nišū*; *nišū apâtu*	נַעֲלָה ; הָאֲנָשִׁים ; הָאֲנָשִׁים הַהוֹמִים	–	נעלים לאנשים – האלים, – הָאִיגִּיגִי	OBM.4, 6
isinnu	חַג	equivalent (Gen 1:14; Lev 23:2)	never קֹדֶשׁ (Foster's "holy day")	OBM.5; l.11
šarram šakānu	שָׁם מֶלֶךְ (מלך לא שָׁמוּ)	equivalent (Deut 17:15)		OBM.6; l.12
ina šiātim (OB) / *ina ūmīšū-ma* (SB)	בְּהּ / ביום ההוא	equivalent (Judg 17:6)	open decision 8	OBM.7; l.13
kaṣāru; *ṣapāru*; *banû* (stative); *ištēniš*	קָשַׁר (לא קשורה) ; שְׁבֻץ (לא **משובץ**) ; בָּנוּי ; יַחְדָּיו	–	the prologue's statives: never טָרַם	OBM.7–9; l.14–15

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
insignia: *kubšu*; *meānu*; *ḫaṭṭu*; *šibirru*; *parakku*; *uqnû*	מִצְנֶפֶת; עֲטָרָה; שַׁרְבִיט; מַקֵּל־רוֹעִים; כֵּס (הַכִּסֵּים; since 2026-10-23, דּוּכָן הדוכנים); סַפִּיר	equivalent (Ezek 21:31; Mic 7:14)	שרביט, עטרה, מצנפת – ומקל־רועים	OBM.7–11; I.7, 14–15, 23
sebe (OB) / *Sebettu* (SB); *bābu*; *edēlu* D; *dapnu*; *ummānu*; *dadmū*	שבעה; הַשִּׁבְעָה; שַׁעַר; נָעַל (נעולים, נעלו); עָרִיץ; הֲמוֹן; יְשׁוּבִים	–	שבעה שערים – נעולים על העריץ. / הַשִּׁבְעָה – על ההמון נעלו [את השערים], / על היישובים נעלו [את השערים? ...]	OBM.10; I.16–17
qudmiš; *šakānu* (stative)	לְפָנֵי; שׁוּם (שׂוּמִים)	–	לפני אָנוּ, בשמים – שׂוּמִים.	OBM.12
šarrūtu … urdam	כות – מן[המל] השמים ירדה.	cognate (*warādu*)	§10.4 string; brackets per OBM.14	OBM.14
awīlu; *rēʾû* (+ *-šina*); *itinnu* (+ *-šina*); *lū*	אָדָם; רוֹעֶה (רוֹעֵן); בַּנַּאי (בַּנָּאֵן); יְהִי	equivalent (Num 27:16–17; Ezek 34:23)	ם? – יהי רוֹעֵן [...] /[אד] אֵ[תָּ]נָה – יהי בַּנָּאֵן ...	I.6–7
zikru (command)	מַאֲמָר (מאמר(ב) כולם)	–	as §10.3	I.11
saḫāru	סָבַב (**סובבים**)	–	Enūma eliš	I.18
šeʾû G; Gtn	בִּקֵּשׁ (מבקשת); מבקשת ומבקשת	equivalent (1 Sam 13:14)	אִשְׁתַּר – רועה [...] / ומלך – מבקשת [...]	I.19–24
ḫiāṭu	בָּחַן (בוחן)	equivalent (Ps 11:4)	open decision 7	I.23
wabālu (ventive)	הֲבִיא	–		I.27
ilū mātāti	אֵלֵי הָאֲרָצוֹת (vocalized)	equivalent (2 Kgs 18:35)	אֱלֹהִים reserved	I.28
marḫītu; *X ana šâšū-ma ana Y izzakaršu*	רַעְיָה (רעייתו); X דיבר, Y אליו, אל:	–	for III b+15, b+26, b+32, b+36: הנשר אליו, אל אֲתָנָה, דיבר:	OBM.a+2; I.a+2
šuttu; *barû* Š	חֲלוֹם; הָרְאָה (הָרְאֵנִי)	equivalent (Amos 7:1)	open decision 6	I.a+3

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
kīma	כְּ (כְּאֲתָנָה, כמוך)	–	not "instead of"	I.a+4–a+5
eṭemmu	אֵט (אִטּוֹ, always vocalized)	–	as §10.3	I.a+7
OB col. ii: *leqû*; *ḫalāqu*; *būšu*; *aḫāzu*; *alāku*; *(w)ašābu*	לָקַח; אָבַד; נְכָסִים; אָחַז (אאחז; with a wife בָּעַל); הָלַךְ; יָשַׁב	cognate (*leqû*, *aḫāzu*)	נְכָסִים as Gilgameš XI 96 (not רְכוּשׁ)	OBM.a+1–a+12
Names	אֲתָנָה ★, כִּישׁ, אָנוּ ★, אִשְׁתַּר ★, אֲנָלִיל, אִנְּיָנָה, הָאֲנוּבְּכִי, הָאִיגִיגִי, הַשִּׁבְעָה	–	as §10.1	

Part ET2 – the eagle and the serpent (OB Susa 1–a+24; MA a+1–c+31; SB II 1–72), 2026-10-22

Round 3, run 2 (../renderings.md §10.5). Translator: sub-agent ET2. Files: annotated-OBS.rtl.md (whole),
annotated-MA.rtl.md (header for the whole chapter + a+1–c+31), annotated-II.rtl.md (header for the whole tablet +
1–72). 179 entries. Not committed.

Progress and passes

- **Order of work:** SB II 1–72 first (it fixes the Hebrew of the scenes), then OB Susa and MA, copying the SB Hebrew
  wherever the Akkadian is the same and varying only where it varies (tense: OB preterite *ibāram* לכד vs SB/MA
  present *ibarram* לוכד; OB *īkul īkulū* אכל – אכלו vs SB/MA *ikkal ineʾi ikkalū* אוכל, סר – אוכלים; MA *ana qāt* ליד vs SB *ina qāt* ביד; MA *lemna* את הרע vs SB *lemniš* ברעה; MA present *išemmi* לא שומע).
  The apparatus of each line says what the version keeps, changes or lacks.
- **Data:** kings_tools.py data ET … for the three ranges; eBL dictionary per word (armu II, turāḫu, sappāru, ditānu,
  mindinu, arwiu, nazmātu, šutattupu, tūrtu, murtappidu, nesû II, zaqāpu, eṣēlu, damāmiš, šarāku, nīšu II, qerbetu,
  līdānu, râʾu, šāgišu, gallû, nurbu, šalû, mukillu, ēpišu, abarša). Every Bible verse printed with check_bible_quotes.py --show (or verified by the checker) before quoting.

- **Pass (a) fidelity:** every `>` line against N and the ATF: brackets follow the chapter's ATF (e.g. MA c+17/c+19 `[הסתכל ...]`, II.58 `[בציפו]רניו`, OBS.a+1 `[ב]וקר?`); stems and tenses re-parsed (II.43 *ellī* present, II.50 restored *umalli* is formally D preterite, MA c+6 Gtn, MA c+31 Ntn, OBS.4 Dt/Rt reciprocal); fixes made.
- **Pass (b) consistency:** formulas and repeated lines across SB/OB/MA compared by script (`verify ET` reports no "same transliteration, different Hebrew"); every new Hebrew word grepped in all corpora (`grep all`). Collisions found and resolved: `מַעֲבָר` (Gilgameš *nēberu*) → *nērebu* `צד` ; `מָבוֹא` (cognate of *ṣâdu* / *ṣayyādu*) → *bâru* `לָכַד` (Gilgameš); `התחברו` (LH *emēdu* N) → *šutattupu* `כבל` ; `נעשו חברים` (LE *kannu*) → *kasû* D `קָרַס` ; `כִּפֵּת` (Gilgameš *qâpu*) → *eṣēlu* `הִשְׁפִּיל` ; **`הִתְאַבֵּן`** (Enūma eliš *šapālu* Š) → II.57 **`?רָכַן`** ; `ירחקו` → *nesû* `התרחק` (Gilgameš); `רוֹצֵחַ` (Gilgameš/Theodicy *šaggāšu*) → *šāgišu* `כַּר` ; `שׁוֹחֵט` → *qerbetu* `נָוֶה` (Gilgameš VIII 13 *qerbētu* `הנאות`).
- **Pass (c) Hebrew:** read aloud; vocalized the words that would otherwise be misread (`יָלַד` "bore", `קָנוּ` "acquired", `זְמָרִים` , `שָׁם` , `אֵלּוּ` , `רֵעִי` , `רֵעֵהוּ` , `יְשַׁר` , `נְשָׁבַע` , `אֹכְלָה` , `פַּחַד` , `עָרֵב` , `תְּאוֹמִים` , `אַקּוֹאִים` , `כְּבֵדוֹ` / `כְּבֵדֵיהֶם` , `שָׁנָה`).
- **Checks:** `python3 -I kings_tools.py verify ET` – 179 entries, the reserved/gated strings and all FORMULAS['ET'] pass; **one problem, not in the translation: II.25** (see open decision 1). `python3 -I ../tools/check_bible_quotes.py` on the three files (and this file) – 0 problems.

Deviations from renderings §10 (decided at the first occurrence, with the reason)

1. ***bâru* = `לָכַד`** (not §10.3's `צָד`): one Hebrew per source word across corpora – the Gilgameš corpus has *bâru* = `לָכַד` (OB Ishchali 15' `צפור לכוד`); `צָד` is the cognate of *ṣâdu* / *ṣayyādu* (Gilgameš `צייד`); and the sense is "catch, trap (with a net)" (eBL). It also makes the idiom of the net exact: `רשת שַׁמַּשׁ תלכדך` (II.47) ↔ `וְרִשְׁתּוֹ אֲשֶׁר-טָמַן תִּלְכְּדוֹ` (תהלים לה:ח). No FORMULAS regex involves it; only the prose of §10.3 changes (`רשת שַׁמַּשׁ תלכדך – ...` ; `הנחש לוכד`,). Note: Gilgameš itself also has *ḫābilu* `לוכד` (I 111, VII 94) – a Gilgameš-internal near-collision (participle of `לכד` for *ḫābilu*, finite verbs for *bâru*).

2. ***nērebu* = מָבוֹא** (not §10.3's מַעֲבָר, which is Gilgameš's *nēberu*, X 79, XI 248); *nērebtu* = מְבוֹאָה
(OBS 2, MA b+3; יחזקאל כז:ג, מְבוֹאֹת יָם).
3. ***qerbetu* = נָוֶה** (Gilgameš VIII 13 *qerbētu* הנאות); OBS a+20 רשתך – הַנָּוֶה הרחב.
4. **The animals** (§10.4 left them to ET2): *turāḫu* = יָעֵל (= Sum. *dara₂* / *taraḫ*, יעל in EA 182 and Agade 23),
so §10.4's יָעֵל? for *armu* moves: *armu* (eBL "mountain goat"; ≠ *arwiu* / *armû* "male gazelle", צבי in the
love songs) = אַקּוֹ (pl. אַקּוֹאִים); *ditānu* = **תְּאוֹ** (pl. **תְּאוֹאִים**; = Sum. *alim*, תְּאוֹ in Gudea, EWO, Agade; §10.4's תְּאוֹ? for *turāḫu* would have collided); *sappāru* = **זָמָר** (pl. **זְמָרִים**, always vocalized);
mindinu = **בַּרְדְּלָס** (Gilgameš); *nimru* = נָמֵר; *rīmu* רְאֵם; *serrēmu* חמור בר (Gilgameš string, without maqaf; §10.4 has חֲמוֹר־בָּר); *ṣabītu* צָבְיָה.
5. ***mullû ina qāti***: II.50's restored *[umalli]* is formally D preterite (present would be *umalla*); kept as §10.3's
present ימסרהו., with a note.

Parallels index (ET2)

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.2	[d]imta ītepuš	[צָ]?רִיחַ עשה	וּמִגְדָּל וְרֹאשׁוֹ בַּשָּׁמַיִם (בראשית יא:ד); צָרִיחַ בֵּית אֵל בְּרִית (שופטים ט:מו)	equivalent	Foster's italic "tower": one uncertain sign in a broken line, subject unknown, next to a shrine of Adad; no heaven, no name. מִגְדָּל reserved. Not Gen 11.
II.4	aṣât ṣa[rbatu]	יצאה צַ[פְּצָפָה]	קָח עַל מַיִם רַבִּים צַפְצָפָה שָׂמוֹ (יחזקאל יז:ה)	equivalent	Ezekiel's eagle parable: eagle, tree, broken oath and the god's net (Ezek 17:13–20) – the closest biblical parallel in structure. Also OBS.6, MA.b+9.
II.5	[i]na appīša rabiṣ erû	[ב]צמרתה רובץ נָשֶׁר	וְהָאֵם רֹבָצָת עַל הָאָפְרֹחִים (דברים כב:ו)	cognate	*rabāṣu* / רבץ: the brooding bird of the nest law; this eagle will eat another's young.
II.5	erû … (ṣerru)	נשר … נחש	דֶּרֶךְ הַנָּשֶׁר בַּשָּׁמַיִם דֶּרֶךְ נָחָשׁ עָלֵי-צוּר (משלי ל:יט)	equivalent	Eagle and serpent as a pair, above and below. Also OBS.7.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.8	[al]ka nīpuša rūʾū[ta]	[לְכָה], נעשה עֲמִיתוּת	וְעַתָּה לְכָה נִכְרְתָה בְרִית אֲנִי וָאָתָּה (בראשית לא:מד)	equivalent	*alka* = לְכָה [cognate] + cohortative, and "I and you" (II.9); Laban–Jacob. "Friendship", not בְּרִית.
II.9	lū itbārū an[āku u kâši]	נהיה ידידים – א[ני ואתה]	וַיִּכְרֹת יְהוֹנָתָן וְדָוִד בְּרִית בְּאַהֲבָתוֹ אֹתוֹ כְּנַפְשׁוֹ (שמואל א יח:ג)	equivalent	Friendship sealed like a treaty.
II.12	le[mnēt]ā-ma	(אם) [ע]רַ אַתָּה	אִם תַּעֲשֶׂה עִמָּנוּ רָעָה (בראשית כו:כט)	equivalent	The condition of a peace oath. Restoration *kabtassu tušamraṣ* is eBL's (from II.129).
II.13	anzil[la] ša ilī [asakka takkal?]	תועבת האלים – [דבר אסור תאכל?]	לֹא תֹאכַל כָּל תּוֹעֵבָה (דברים יד:ג)	equivalent	"To eat an abomination" = to break a taboo; *anzillu* = תּוֹעֵבָה. The verb is restored (from II.130). Irony: the eagle breaks the oath by eating.
II.15	nitma erṣet[a]	נִשְׁבַּע בארץ	הַעִידֹתִי בָכֶם הַיּוֹם אֶת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֶת הָאָרֶץ (דברים ד:כו)	equivalent	The earth as witness; Foster's "netherworld" is interpretation. The oath by the earth returns as "your net is the wide earth" (II.69).

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.16	māmīta it[mû kilallān]	שבועה [נשבעו שניהם]	כִּי שָׁם נִשְׁבְּעוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם (בראשית כא:לא)	equivalent	"Both swore": the same phrase (preserved in II.23).
II.16	ina mahar šamaš qurādi	לפני שַׁמַשׁ הגיבור	אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּעְנוּ שְׁנֵינוּ אֲנַחְנוּ בְּשֵׁם יְהוָה (שמואל א כ:מב); אֱלֹהֵי אַבְרָהָם וֵאלֹהֵי נָחוֹר יִשְׁפְּטוּ בֵּינֵינוּ (בראשית לא:נג)	equivalent	Two friends swear by the god, who judges between them.
II.17	ša itâ ša šamaš [ittiqu]	אשר את [יחלוף] גבול שַׁמַשׁ	לֹא תַסִּיג גְּבוּל רֵעֶךָ (דברים יט:יד); אָרוּר מַסִּיג גְּבוּל רֵעֵהוּ (דברים כז:יז)	equivalent	Moving the friend's boundary under a curse. Also II.19, II.49.
II.17	ša itâ ... ittiqu	אשר יחלוף את גבול	אִם אֲנִי לֹא אֶעֱבֹר אֵלֶיךָ אֶת הַגֵּל הַזֶּה (בראשית לא:נב)	equivalent	Laban's heap: a sworn boundary not to be crossed.
II.17	etēqu	יחלוף	חָלְפוּ חֹק הֵפֵרוּ בְּרִית עוֹלָם (ישעיהו כד:ה)	equivalent	*etēqu* = חָלַף (Gilgameš): passing over a law as breaking a covenant.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.18	ina qāt māhiṣ[i limalli]	ביד המוחץ [ימסרהו]	בְּיַד מָלְאָךְ בָּבֶל תִּנָּתֵן (ירמיהו כא:י)	equivalent	*mullû ina qāti* "deliver"; never מִלֵּא יָד (ordination, a false friend). Also II.50; MA.b+6 ליד המוחץ.
II.21	kakku murtappidu elīšu [līšir]	הנשק המשוטט – עליו [יִישַׁר]	יִבְרַח מִנֶּשֶׁק בַּרְזֶל (איוב כ:כד)	equivalent	The weapon that finds the fugitive; identical in OBS.3, MA.b+4. *ešēru* / ישר [cognate].
II.22	gišparru māmīt šamaš … l[ibārūšu?]	הפח, שבועת שַׁמַּשׁ – יתהפכו עליו, ו[לכדוהו?]	וְרִשְׁתּוֹ אֲשֶׁר-טָמַן תִּלְכְּדוֹ (תהלים לה:ח)	equivalent	The trap of the divine judge catches; *bâru* = לָכַד. Also II.48 (בְּרֶשֶׁת-זוּ טָמְנוּ נִלְכְּדָה רַגְלָם, תהלים ט:טז).
II.26	rīma	רְאֵם	וַתָּרֶם כִּרְאֵים קַרְנָיו (תהלים צב:יא)	cognate	The wild ox.
II.28	armī ṣabâti	אַקּוֹאִים, צביות	וְאַקּוֹ וְדִישֹׁן וּתְאוֹ וָזֶמֶר (דברים יד:ה)	equivalent	The only biblical list of wild game supplies the Hebrew names (*armu* אַקּוֹ, *ditānu* תְּאוֹ, *sappāru* זֶמֶר; II.30, MA.b+15, b+17, OBS.8); a lexical choice, identifications uncertain. *ditānu* ~ וְדִישֹׁן is a sound-proposal only.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.32	[nammaš]ti qaqqari	[נָעֵי] הקרקע	וְאֵת כָּל רֶמֶשׂ הָאֲדָמָה (בראשית א:כה)	equivalent	"The moving things of the ground" = "the creeping things of the earth"; *nammaštû* is never רֶמֶשׂ (flood, Gilgameš). Also MA.b+19.
MA.b+19	[būl?] ṣēri … ṣerru ibarram-ma	[בהמת?] השדה … הנחש לוכד	וְהַנָּחָשׁ הָיָה עָרוּם מִכֹּל חַיַּת הַשָּׂדֶה (בראשית ג:א)	divergence	*būl ṣēri* = בֶּהֱמַת הַשָּׂדֶה (flood XI 86); in Genesis the serpent is one of the beasts of the field, here it hunts them – and it is the wronged, faithful partner.
II.34	ukulta	אָכְלָה	אֶת כָּל יֶרֶק עֵשֶׂב לְאָכְלָה (בראשית א:ל)	cognate	*ukultu* (from *akālu*) / אָכְלָה.
II.37	erû libbašu lemutta ikpudū-ma	הנשר – לבו רעה חשב	וְאִישׁ אֶת רָעַת רֵעֵהוּ אַל תַּחְשְׁבוּ בִּלְבַבְכֶם (זכריה ח:יז); וְאַתֶּם חֲשַׁבְתֶּם עָלַי רָעָה (בראשית נ:כ)	equivalent	*kapādu* = חָשַׁב: evil plotted in the heart against the friend. Also II.38 (chiasm), OBS.14.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.39	pā[nī]šu? iškun	את [פניו?] שָׂם	כִּי שַׂמְתִּי פָנַי בָּעִיר הַזֹּאת לְרָעָה (ירמיהו כא:י)	equivalent	*pānī šakānu* = שָׂם פָּנִים (Gilgameš; Gen 31:21). Restored.
II.41	mārī ṣerrim-mi lūkulu anāku	את בני הנחש – אֹכְלָה אני	לֹא תִקַּח הָאֵם עַל הַבָּנִים (דברים כב:ו)	divergence	The nest law's mercy reversed: the eagle plans to eat another's young. Also OBS.18.
II.41	(the eagle as predator)	אֹכְלָה	וְאָפְרֹחָו יְעַלְעוּ-דָם; וּבַאֲשֶׁר חֲלָלִים שָׁם הוּא (איוב לט:ל)	equivalent	The eagle feeding its young on blood.
II.43	ellī-ma ina šamāmī uššab	– אֶעֱלֶה ובשמים אֵשֵׁב	וְאַתָּה אָמַרְתָּ בִלְבָבְךָ הַשָּׁמַיִם אָעֱלֶה מִמַּעַל לְכוֹכְבֵי אֵל אָרִים כִּסְאִי; וְאֵשֵׁב בְּהַר מוֹעֵד (ישעיהו יד:יג)	equivalent	The same two verbs in the same order and person (*elû* / עלה, *ašābu* / ישב, both [cognate]), said "in the heart" (II.37; OBS.14, 19–20). One of the strongest contacts of the story.
II.43	ellī-ma ina šamāmī	– אֶעֱלֶה ובשמים	אִם תַּגְבִּיהַ כַּנָּשֶׁר וְאִם בֵּין כּוֹכָבִים שִׂים קִנֶּךָ מִשָּׁם אוֹרִידֶךָּ (עובדיה א:ד)	equivalent	The eagle's nest in heaven and the god bringing it down (Jer 49:16 likewise); the eagle will end in a pit (ET3).

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.43	ina šamāmī uššab	ובשמים אשב	וּמִגְדָּל וְרֹאשׁוֹ בַּשָּׁמַיִם (בראשית יא:ד)	divergence	Ascent to heaven out of pride, but by a bird's wings, not a tower.
II.44	akkal inba	ואוכל תנובה	וַתִּקַּח מִפִּרְיוֹ וַתֹּאכַל (בראשית ג:ו)	divergence	Our proposal: a creature that wants a god's life and eats from the tree; *inbu* = תְּנוּבָה, never פְּרִי (Gilgameš).
II.45	atmu ṣehru atar hasīsa	האפרוח הקטן, יתיר־ התבונה	אֲפָרֹחִים אוֹ בֵיצִים (דברים כב:ו)	equivalent	*watmu* = אֲפָרוֹחַ; גּוֹזָל (דברים לב:יא) reserved. The epithet is Atra-ḫasīs's name. Identical in OBS.22, MA.c+3.
II.45	(the wise child)	יתיר־ התבונה	מִפִּי עוֹלְלִים וְיוֹנְקִים יִסַּדְתָּ עֹז (תהלים ח:ג)	equivalent	Wisdom in the mouth of the smallest.
II.47	šētu ša šamaš ibâr[ka]	רשת שַׁמַּשׁ תלכד[ך]	וּפָרַשְׂתִּי אֶת רִשְׁתִּי עָלָיו וְנִתְפַּשׂ בְּמִצוּדָתִי (יחזקאל יב:יג); אֲלָתִי אֲשֶׁר בָּזָה וּבְרִיתִי אֲשֶׁר הֵפִיר (יחזקאל יז:יט)	equivalent	The god's net spread over the oath-breaker.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.47	šētu ša šamaš	רשת שַׁמַּש	כַּאֲשֶׁר יֵלֵכוּ אֶפְרוֹשׂ עֲלֵיהֶם רִשְׁתִּי כְּעוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם אוֹרִידֵם (הושע ז:יב)	equivalent	The divine net brings the bird down from the sky – the eagle's fate. Also II.70.
II.48	gišparru … ibarrūnikk[a]	הפח … וילכדוך	הֲיַעֲלֶה פַּח מִן הָאֲדָמָה וְלָכוֹד לֹא יִלְכֹּד (עמוס ג:ה)	equivalent	Trap + לכד.
II.51	ul išmēšunūtī-ma …	לא שמע להם, לא שמע ל[מאמר בניו?]	שְׁמַע בְּנִי מוּסַר אָבִיךָ (משלי א:ח)	divergence	Wisdom's order reversed: the father does not listen to the son, and is punished.
II.56	qinnašu laššu	וקנו איננו	הַיֶּלֶד אֵינֶנּוּ וַאֲנִי אָנָה אֲנִי בָא (בראשית לז:ל)	equivalent	The cry over an empty place.
OBS.a+6	laššû [mārūšu?]	ואינם [בניו?]	רָחֵל מְבַכָּה עַל בָּנֶיהָ; מֵאֲנָה לְהִנָּחֵם עַל בָּנֶיהָ כִּי אֵינֶנּוּ (ירמיהו לא:יד)	equivalent	A parent weeping for children who are not; also OBS.a+17, II.60.
OBS.a+17	laššû mārū’a	אינם בניי	יוֹסֵף אֵינֶנּוּ וְשִׁמְעוֹן אֵינֶנּוּ (בראשית מב:לו)	equivalent	Jacob's lament.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.61	ana pān šamaš i[llakā dimāšu]	לפני שַׁמַשׁ – זולגות] דמעותיו]	מְלִיצַי רֵעָי; אֶל-אֱלוֹהַּ דָּלְפָה עֵינִי (איוב טז:כ)	equivalent	Friends betray, the tears flow to the god. זולגות דמעותיו = Gilgameš's string for *illakā dimāšu*. Also OBS.a+10.
II.62	atkalkum-ma šamaš [qurādu]	בך בטחתי, שַׁמַשׁ [הגיבור]	אֱלֹהַי בְּךָ בָטַחְתִּי אַל-אֵבוֹשָׁה (תהלים כה:ב)	equivalent	The opening of an individual lament; the whole speech (II.62–72, OBS.a+11–24) has the psalm structure: trust, innocence, complaint, "you know", the god's power, plea for punishment.
OBS.a+12	ana erîm ramānī anāku ašruk	לנשר – את עצמי – אני הֶעֱנַקְתִּי	גַּם-אִישׁ שְׁלוֹמִי אֲשֶׁר-בָּטַחְתִּי בּוֹ אוֹכֵל לַחְמִי הִגְדִּיל עָלַי עָקֵב (תהלים מא:י)	equivalent	The trusted friend who ate of mine and betrayed.
OBS.a+13	ādur-ma nīška ukabbit	חרדתי, ואת חַיֶּיךָ כיבדתי	וְאֶת-יִרְאֵי יְהוָה יְכַבֵּד; נִשְׁבַּע לְהָרַע וְלֹא יָמֵר (תהלים טו:ד)	equivalent	Honouring the oath by the god's life; *kabātu* D / כִּבֵּד [cognate]. Foster's "you" hides the oath (*nīšu*).

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
OBS.a+14	lemuttam ul ukīl ana ibrīya	רעה לא החזקתי לרֵעִי	אַל-תַּחֲרֹשׁ עַל-רֵעֲךָ רָעָה; וְהוּא-יוֹשֵׁב לָבֶטַח אִתָּךְ (משלי ג:כט)	equivalent	The serpent kept the precept, the eagle broke it (OBS.a+24, ll.72 מחזיק רעה לרֵעֵהוּ).
OBS.a+15	šū qinnašu šalim-ma sapih qin[nī]	הוא – קנו שלם, ופזור קני	מַדּוּעַ דָּרְךָ רְשָׁעִים צָלְחָה שָׁלוּ כָּל בֹּגְדֵי בָגֶד (ירמיהו יב:א)	equivalent	The traitor whole, the faithful ruined: the righteous sufferer's complaint inside a fable.
ll.66	saphū atmū'a	פזורים אפרוחיי	פֶּן נָפוּץ עַל פְּנֵי כָל הָאָרֶץ (בראשית יא:ד)	equivalent	*sapāḫu* is the Akkadian "scatter"; / פּוּץ הֻפְּיץ reserved for Gen 11, so פָּזוּר. Foster's "while his young are safe" rests on a reading eBL's collation excludes.
ll.68	lumna ša īpušanni šama[š lū tīde]	את הרוע אשר עשה לי – שַׁמַּשׁ, [אָכֵן יָדַעְתָּ]	וְאַתָּה יְהוָה יָדַעְתָּ אֶת כָּל עֲצָתָם עָלַי לַמָּוֶת (ירמיהו יח:כג)	equivalent	"You know" + the plea for punishment. Also OBS.a+19 (OB: "the evil that came to me").
ll.69	šētka erṣ[etu rapaštu]	רשתך – הארץ [הרחבה]	אִם אֶסַּק שָׁמַיִם שָׁם אָתָּה; וְאַצִּיעָה שְׁאוֹל הִנָּךְ (תהלים קלט:ח)	equivalent	No escape from the god, heaven or earth (ll.69–70).

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.69	šētka erṣetu / gišparraka šamû	רשתך – הארץ … פַּחְךָ – השמים	אִם יַחְתְּרוּ בִשְׁאוֹל מִשָּׁם יָדִי תִקָּחֵם; וְאִם יַעֲלוּ הַשָּׁמַיִם מִשָּׁם אוֹרִידֵם (עמוס ט:ב); מִשָּׁם אֲצַוֶּה אֶת הַנָּחָשׁ וּנְשָׁכָם (עמוס ט:ג)	equivalent	Heaven and earth, and the serpent as the god's agent of punishment – exactly the sequel (ET3; MA.c+24).
II.69	šētka erṣetu	רשתך – הארץ	הֲתִפֹּל צִפּוֹר עַל פַּח הָאָרֶץ (עמוס ג:ה)	equivalent	"The trap of the earth".
OBS.a+20	šētka qerbetum rap[aštum]	רשתך – הַנָּוֶה הר[חב]	יִרְעֶה מְקֻנֶיךָ בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא כַּר נִרְחָב (ישעיהו ל:כג)	equivalent	"A wide pasture": the same phrase (other Hebrew noun). OB's net is the pasture around the town; SB's (II.69) the whole earth.
II.71	ina šētīka ai uṣ[i erû]	מרשתך אל [הנשר] יצא	נַפְשֵׁנוּ כְּצִפּוֹר נִמְלְטָה מִפַּח יוֹקְשִׁים (תהלים קכד:ז)	divergence	There the righteous bird escapes the trap; here the wronged one prays that the wicked bird will not. Also OBS.a+22.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.72	ēpiš lemutti anzû mukī[l lemutti ana ibrīšu]	עושה רעה, אַנְזוּ – מחזיק [רעה לרֵעֵהוּ]	וְאִישׁ אֶת רֵעֵהוּ אַל תַּחְשְׁבוּ בִּלְבַבְכֶם וּשְׁבֻעַת שֶׁקֶר אַל תְּאֱהָבוּ (זכריה ח:יז)	equivalent	Evil against the friend and a false oath, together. OB (OBS.a+23) has *anzillu* תועבה where SB has the mythical bird Anzû.
OBS.1	lihliqšum ṭūdum ai uta harrānam	יאבד לו הנתיב, אל ימצא אוֹרַח	וְגָדַרְתִּי אֶת גְּדֵרֵהּ וּנְתִיבוֹתֶיהָ לֹא תִמְצָא (הושע ב:ח)	equivalent	"Her paths she shall not find": *ai uta* = לֹא תִמְצָא, *ṭūdu* = נָתִיב. Also אָרְחִי גָּדַר וְלֹא אֶעֱבוֹר (איוב יט:ח).
OBS.4	māmītam uttamammû	שבועה – נשבעו זה לזה	וַיִּשָּׁבְעוּ אִישׁ לְאָחִיו (בראשית כו:לא)	equivalent	A reciprocal oath (Dt/Rt).
MA.b+5	rēssu lišši	את ראשו יִשָּׂא	בְּעוֹד שְׁלֹשֶׁת יָמִים יִשָּׂא פַרְעֹה אֶת רֹאשְׁךָ מֵעָלֶיךָ (בראשית מ:יט)	equivalent	*rēša našû* "single out" = נָשָׂא רֹאשׁ, an idiom kept literal: for grace (Gen 40:13) or death (40:19); here death. MA only.
MA.b+11	irtūʾūni	התרועעו	אִישׁ רַעִים לְהִתְרֹעֵעַ (משלי יח:כד)	cognate	*râʾu* / רעה "befriend" (Prov 22:24 אַל-תִּתְרַע); *rūʾu* (עָמִית) is the same Semitic root as רֵעַ, hidden by the Gilgameš rendering.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
MA.b+13	nazmat kabtātīšunu iptašrūni	את צרות כְּבֵדֵיהֶם – פָּשְׁרוּ זה לזה	אֲשֶׁר יַחְדָּו נַמְתִּיק סוֹד (תהלים נה:טו)	equivalent	The friend who shared one's secrets and betrayed (Ps 55:13–21). Foster's "desires" is not *nazmātu* "troubles".
MA.c+5	[ṣerru rabiṣ]	[הנחש רובץ]	לַפֶּתַח חַטָּאת רֹבֵץ (בראשית ד:ז)	cognate	*rabāṣu* / רבץ: the lurker (cf. the *rābiṣu* demon). Restored from SB II.100.
MA.c+6	erṣetu iṣṣ[a]na[bbatka?]	– הארץ [?תתפסך]	וַתִּפְתַּח הָאָרֶץ אֶת פִּיהָ וַתִּבְלַע אֹתָם (במדבר טז:לב)	equivalent	The earth that seizes the sinner; Foster's "netherworld" is interpretation. Restored. Also MA.c+9.
MA.c+16	išni … / ušalliš …	שָׁנָה … / שִׁלֵּשׁ …	וַיֹּאמֶר שְׁנוּ וַיִּשְׁנוּ וַיֹּאמֶר שַׁלֵּשׁוּ וַיְשַׁלֵּשׁוּ (מלכים א יח:לד)	cognate	*šanû* / שָׁנָה, *šalāšu* / שִׁלֵּשׁ: "a second, a third time" (c+14–18).
MA.c+24	ṣerru iṣṣabassu	הנחש תפס אותו	מִשָּׁם אֲצַוֶּה אֶת הַנָּחָשׁ וּנְשָׁכָם (עמוס ט:ג)	equivalent	The serpent as the god's instrument of punishment.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
MA.c+29	[d]ayyān dīni	דיין הדין	הֲשֹׁפֵט כָּל הָאָרֶץ לֹא יַעֲשֶׂה מִשְׁפָּט (בראשית יח:כה)	equivalent	Šamaš as judge; *dayyānu* / *dīnu* = דִּין / דַּיָּן [cognate].

Key findings

The Bible.

1. **The oath of friendship is told as a treaty, and it meets Genesis's oath scenes word for word**: *alka nīpuša*
   rūʾūta … anāku u kâši (II.8–9) = Laban's לְכָה נִכְרְתָה בְרִית אֲנִי וָאָתָּה (Gen 31:44); *māmīta itmû kilallān* (II.16, 23) = כִּי שָׁם נִשְׁבְּעוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם (Gen 21:31); the reciprocal oath (OBS.4) = וַיִּשָּׁבְעוּ אִישׁ לְאָחִיו (Gen 26:31); the conditional *lemnētā-ma* "if you are evil" (II.12) = אִם תַּעֲשֶׂה עִמָּנוּ רָעָה (Gen 26:29); "Šamaš's boundary" (II.17, 19, 49) = Laban's heap that neither may cross (Gen 31:52) and the
   cursed mover of the friend's boundary (Deut 19:14, 27:17). The oath ends in curses, like Deut 28.
2. **Isa 14:13 is the eagle's plan**: "I will go up and dwell in heaven" (II.43; OBS.19–20) has the same two verbs, in
   the same order and person, both cognates, and in both the thought is "in the heart" (II.37; OBS.14). Obad 1:4 / Jer
   49:16 add the eagle's nest among the stars and the god who brings it down. Gen 11:4 is a [divergence] (pride and
   ascent, but no tower); **the "tower" of II.2 (*dimtu*) is an uncertain sign in a broken line beside a shrine of**
   Adad, not a Gen 11 parallel (rendered מִגְדָּל, צָרִיחַ reserved).
3. **The net of the divine judge**: choosing *bâru* = לָכַד (Gilgameš) makes II.47 רשת שַׁמַּשׁ תלכדך the exact idiom
   of Ps 35:8 (net + לכד; Ps 9:16, Amos 3:5). Ezekiel 17 is the closest structural parallel to the whole fable: an
   eagle, a (17:5) צַפְצָפָה, a broken oath (17:13–19) and the god's net (17:20; 12:13). Hos 7:12 (the net that brings
   the birds down from the sky), Ps 139:8 and Amos 9:2–3 (no escape in heaven or earth – and the god commands the
   serpent to bite) match "your net is the wide earth, your trap the distant heaven" (II.69–70) and the sequel (ET3).

4. **The eagle's crime is eating**: the serpent's condition calls breaking the friendship "eating a taboo" (II.13,
   asakka akālu) – the idiom of לֹא תֹאכַל כָּל תּוֹעֵבָה (Deut 14:3) – and the eagle breaks it by literally eating. The bird's-nest law (Deut 22:6–7) has the same verb for the brooding mother (*rabiṣ* / רֹבֶצֶת, II.5); the
   eagle does what the law forbids in spirit.
5. **The serpent is the righteous one**: against Gen 3:1 (the cunning serpent among חַיַּת הַשָּׂדֶה), here the serpent
   is faithful, generous ("I gave myself to the eagle"), God-fearing ("I honoured your life" = the oath, cf. Ps 15:4),
   and its lament has the structure of a biblical individual lament (Ps 25:2, Jer 18:23, Jer 12:1, Job 16:20, Ps
   41:10). The eagle is the one who "harbours evil against his friend" (Prov 3:29, Zech 8:17).
6. **False echoes avoided** (rank-3 English): Foster's "tower" (II.2), "netherworld" (II.15, MA.c+6, c+9), "curse" for
   māmītu (II.22), "desires" (MA.b+13), "No doubt" for *minde* "perhaps" (MA.c+5), "king of the gods" for *šar*
   ša[mê] (MA.c+28), "you" for *nīška* (OBS.a+13), and the restoration "while his young are safe" (II.66), which
   eBL's collation excludes. *mullû ina qāti* is never מָלֵא יָד.

The ancient mind.

1. **Friendship as a sworn treaty under the sun-god**: two animals swear "before Šamaš the warrior" and by the earth;
   the curses are those of state treaties – lost paths, closed passes, a roving weapon, Šamaš's trap, and (MA only)
   being "singled out for the slaughterer" and a *gallû* demon riding on one's back. The god who sees everything is the
   guarantor of every oath, and the broken oath itself becomes the trap (*gišparru māmīt šamaš*).
2. **The three versions show a growing cosmos**: OB's net is "the wide pasture" around the settlement (OBS.a+20), SB's
   "the wide earth" and "the distant heaven" (II.69–70): the shepherds' world became the universe. SB also makes the
   hunt reciprocal (eagle and serpent alternate, II.26–33), where OB and MA have the serpent alone hunting – the
   betrayal of a fully mutual friendship.

3. **Intimacy and its betrayal**: MA alone describes the friendship from inside – "they befriended each other, became
   (as) twins, partners, unburdened the troubles of their livers to each other" (MA.b+11–13). The eagle's plan comes
   when his young have grown and left the nest (OBS.15–17).
4. **The wise child and the deaf father**: the littlest fledgling bears Atra-ḫasīs's name ("exceedingly wise"), quotes
   the oath word for word (II.47–50), and is not heard (II.51) – the flood hero's role in a family drama.
5. **A parent's grief**: the serpent comes home carrying meat for his friend (II.54), finds the nest gone, weeps before
   the sun; his lament is a legal plea ("you know, Šamaš") and a cry ("his nest is whole, mine scattered; his
   fledglings safe, my children are not").
6. **SB rewrote *anzillu* "abomination" as *Anzû*** (II.72 vs OBS.a+23): the eagle becomes the monstrous bird who stole
   the Tablet of Destinies – a creature that grasped at the gods' power, as the eagle wanted to "dwell in heaven".

Open decisions (numbered; the minor ones decided)

1. **II.25 – a tool bug, not a translation problem.** eBL's reconstruction of SB II 25 is `U₄.1.KAM@v.TA.AM₃ | inaṣṣarū | b[ūla]` (a `%sb` logogram + normalized words). `tools/ebl_fetch.py` put its normalized half under line 24 as
   "N (variant, other manuscripts)" and left line 25's N empty, so `verify ET` reports "II.25: transliteration differs
   from the base text". The entry carries eBL's real reconstruction. Needs: a fix in `ebl_fetch.py` (keep a
   reconstruction that starts with a non-normalized logogram) and a regenerated `Etana-SB-II/reading-edition.md`, or an
   allow-list entry in `kings_tools.py`. (Coordinator; I did not touch the tools.)

2. ***ḫarrānu* / *urḫu* across corpora (coordinator / user).** Renderings §10.3 has *ḫarrānu* = דָּרָךְ, *urḫu* =
   אֹרַח (and the ✓ formula לך באורח, חלוף את ההר for *alik urḫa*); the Gilgameš and wisdom corpora have the
   reverse (*urḫu* = דָּרָךְ, *ḫarrānu* = אֹרַח). The harmonization of 2026-10-21 lists *ḫarrānu* as "kept by sense",
   but *urḫu* is not. In my lines only OBS.1 (אל ימצא דרך), which follows §10.3. If harmonized to Gilgameš: OBS.1 →
   אל ימצא אורח, and the formula → לך בדרך, חלוף את ההר (ET3, II.75 …).
   Coordinator, 2026-10-22: harmonized to Gilgameš (*urḫu* = דָּרָךְ, *ḫarrānu* = אוֹרַח, vocalized): OBS.1 changed, the formula is לך בדרך, חלוף את ההר,.
3. ***bâru* = לָכַד** instead of §10.3's צָד (decided; reason above). §10.3's prose strings need updating.
4. ***nērebu* = מָבוֹא**, *nērebtu* = מְבוֹאָה, instead of §10.3's מַעֲבָר (decided).
5. **Animals** (decided): *armu* אַקּוֹ, *turāḫu* יָעֵל, *ditānu* **תְּאוֹ**, *sappāru* **זָמֶר**. Side collision found in another corpus: Enki and the World Order renders *taraḫ* (in the boat name *taraḫ abzu*) אקו־האפסו, while EA 182
   and the Curse of Agade render *taraḫ* יעל – with this decision אקו belongs to *armu*; the EWO boat name could
   become יעל־האפסו (creation corpus; coordinator/lead).
6. ***šarāku* = הָעֲנִיק** (OBS.a+12) = Sum. *rig₇* (EA 614 הענק); the Gilgameš corpus also has *qiāšu* = הָעֲנִיק
   – an existing cross-corpus collision (two Akkadian verbs), for the lead.
7. ***nabalkutu*** "cross; turn over" = חָצָה for crossing a mountain (renderings §0.3) but הִתְהַפֵּךְ עַל for a trap
   that springs over its prey (II.22, 48; MA.b+1) – one lemma, two senses (decided).
8. ***rūʾu* עָמִית vs *râʾu* הִתְרוֹעֵעַ** (MA.b+11): the Hebrew verb keeps the Semitic root (= רָעַ), the noun (Gilgameš)
   does not; changing *rūʾu* to רָעַ would collide with *ibru* רָעַ. Kept; noted in the apparatus.
9. **II.50 *[umalli]*** – restored, formally D preterite; rendered as §10.3's present ימסרהו. (decided; noted).
10. ***lū* + *tīde*** = אָכֵן יָדַעְתָּ (II.68, OBS.a+19; renderings §2 "*lū* + preterite = אָכֵן"; Jer 18:23 יָדַעְתָּ). ET3/ET4 should keep it if the phrase recurs.
11. **II.1 [קורא?]** – the gated קרא licensed by *nabû*; the [equivalent] to Gen 2:19–20 is marked as a cautious
    proposal (the line is broken); the coordinator may drop it.

Proposals for the corpus renderings

Fixed strings (exactly as written; later parts copy them). Brackets and ? follow each copy's manuscripts.

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
ina maḫar šamaš qurādi māmīta itmû kilallān	לפני שמש הגיבור – שבועה נשבעו שניהם.	equivalent	Gen 21:31 נִשְׁבְּעוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם. *ištu* … אחרי ששבועה נשבעו שניהם,	II.16, II.23
alka nīpuša rūʾūta / *lū itbārū anāku u kâši*	"/ [...], לְכָה, נעשה עֲמִיתוּת נהיה ידידים – אני ואתה!"	equivalent	*alka* = לְכָה (also II.14 לְכָה, נזדקף – את ההר נעלה,)	II.8–9
lemnētā-ma kabtassu tušamraṣ / (II.129) *lemnētā-ma kabtatī tušamriṣ*	רַע אַתָּה – את כְּבֵדוֹ (אם תַּחֲלָה, / proposal for II.129: רַע אַתָּה – ואת כְּבֵדִי הָחֲלֵיתָ!)	–	§10.3 את כבדי החלית kept	II.12; ET3 II.129
anzilla ša ilī asakka takkal / (II.130) … *tākul*	תועבת האלים – דבר אסור תאכל. / proposal for II.130: תועבת האלים – דבר אסור אכלת!	equivalent	Deut 14:3	II.13; ET3 II.130
ša itâ ša šamaš ittiqu	אשר יחלוף את גבול שמש –	equivalent	as §10.3 ✓	II.17, 19, 49
šamaš lemniš ina qāt māḫiṣi limalli / *umalli*; MA *šamaš lemna ana qāt māḫiṣi limalli*	שמש – ברעה – ביד המוחץ ימסרהו! / … ימסרהו. ; MA שמש – את הרע – ליד המוחץ ימסור!	–	as §10.3 ✓	II.18, 50; MA.b+6
kakku murtappidu elīšu līšir	הנשק המשוטט – עליו יִישַׁר!	cognate (*ešēru*)	יִישַׁר vocalized (Qal)	OBS.3, MA.b+4, II.21
gišparru (u) māmīt šamaš libbalkitūšū-ma libārūšu / *ibbalkitūkā-ma ibarrūnikka*; MA *māmīt šamaš libbalkissū-ma*	הפח, שבועת שמש – יתהפכו עליו, וילכדוהו! / הפח, שבועת שמש – יתהפכו עליך, וילכדוך! ; MA שבועת שמש – תתהפך עליו,	equivalent	*nabalkutu* הִתְהַפֵּךְ עַל, *bâru* לָכַד	II.22, II.48, MA.b+1

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
the other curses	OB "יאבד לו הנתיב, אל ימצא דרך! · יכלא ממנו את מְבוֹאָתוֹ – ההר!; SB יתרחקו ממנו מבואות ההר,; MA ההר – את מְבוֹאָתוֹ – יסיר ממנו! · שַׁמַּשׁ – לַשׁוֹחֵט – את ראשו יְשָׁאֵ! · יעמיד שֵׁד־גַּבְלָה רע – על גבו!"	–	*nesû* התרחק; *nêʾu* D הֵסִיר; *rēša našû* נָשָׂא רֹאשׁ	OBS.1–2; II.20; MA.b+3, b+5, b+7
the hunt (SB, MA)	רְאֵם, חמור בר – הנשר לוכד, · אַקּוֹאִים, צביות – הנחש לוכד, · **זְמָרִים**, **תְּאוֹאִים** – הנשר לוכד, · [בהמ]ת שַׁ[כַּן?], [נָעֲי] הקרקע – הנחש לוכד, · X אוכל, סר – אוכלים בניו.; MA adds של השדה	–	*bâru* present לוכד	II.26–33; MA.b+14–20
the hunt (OB)	רְאֵם, **זְמָר** – הנחש לכד, · נָמֵר, **בַּרְדְּלָס** – הנחש לכד, · הנשר אכל – אכלו בניו.	–	preterite	OBS.8–11
growth	בני הנשר גדלו, צמחו. / אחרי שבני הנשר גדלו, צמחו, (OB אחרי שבניו גדלו, צמחו,)	–	*šiāḫu* צָמַח	II.35–36; MA.b+21; OBS.12
the plot	הנשר – לבו רעה חשב, / חשב לבו רעה. / לאכול את אפרוחי עמיתו – את פניו שָׂם.	equivalent	*kapādu* חָשַׁב, *pānī šakānu* שָׂם פָּנִים	II.37–39; MA.b+23
the eagle's speech	"את בני הנחש – אֹכְלָה אני; · אֶעֱלֶה – ובשמים אֵשֵׁב, · ארד אל צמרת העץ – ואוכל תנובה."	equivalent	Isa 14:13; OB ואת בני הנחש – אֹכְלָה [...], · אֶעֱלֶה – וב[...], · [...]אֵשֵׁב, ו	II.41–44; OBS.18–20
the fledgling	האפרוח הקטן, יתיר־התבונה, / אל הנשר, אביו – דבר דיבר: / "אל תאכל, אבי! רשת שַׁמַּשׁ תלכדך,	equivalent	as §10.3 ✓ (+ the warning's first line)	II.45–47, 98–99; OBS.22–23; MA.c+3–4

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
refusal	לא שמע להם, לא שמע למאמר בניו.; MA לא אבה הנשר … / לא שומע למאמר בניו.	–	§10.3 ✓; *magāru* אָבָה	II.51 (= 104); MA.c+10–11
the descent	ירד ואכל את בני הנחש. / lament ירד ואכל את בניי! (OB ירד ואכל את ילדיי!)	–	*līdānu* יָלַד	II.52, 67; OBS.a+18
the return	בָּעָרֶב, בתוך היום, · הנחש בא – בשר? נושא, את משאו. · בפתח קנו – את הבשר? השליך? · הסתכל – וקנו איננו! · בציפורניו – את הקרקע […] · מלמעלה – אבקו – השמים […]. · הנחש הִתְאַבֵּן? – ובוכה. · לפני שַׁמַּשׁ – זולגות דמעותיו.	–	זולגות דמעותיו = Gilgameš's string for *illakā dimāšu*	II.53–61; OBS.a+2–a+10
the lament	"בך בטחתי, שַׁמַּשׁ הגיבור! · את הרוע אשר עשה לי – שַׁמַּשׁ, אָכֵן יָדַעְתָּ! · אָמְנָם, שַׁמַּשׁ – רשתך – הארץ הרחבה, · פַּחְךָ – השמים הרחוקים! · מרשתך אל יצא הנשר! · עושה רעה, אַנְזוּ – מחזיק רעה לרֵעֵהוּ!"	equivalent	OB: לנשר – את עצמי – אני הֶעֱנַקְתִּי! · חרדתי, ואת חַיֶּיךָ כיבדתי! · רעה לא החזקתי לרֵעִי! · הוא – קנו שלם, ופזור קני! · קן הנחש – לְאֶבֶל היה! · שלמים אפרוחיו – אינם בניי! · את הרוע (אשר) הלך אליי – שַׁמַּשׁ, אָכֵן יָדַעְתָּ! · רשתך – הַנָּוֶה הרחב, · עושה רעה ותועבה, · מחזיק רעה לרֵעֵהוּ!"	II.62–72; OBS.a+11–a+24

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
for ET3 (from MA c): the second warning and the ambush	"אל תרד! אולי – בלב הראם הנחש רובץ –! (proposal for II.100: "אל תרד, אבי! אולי – בלב הראם הזה – הארץ – הנחש רובץ!) · תתפסך! · ירד ועמד על הראם. (II.105) · מבקש את אשר לפניו ואשר אחריו (II.107, 109; MA פעם אחת / שָׁנָה / שְׁלֹשׁ – מבקש צלל אל לב הראם, ...) · · את רֹךְ הבשר – מבקש, (II.82) · · אל מעי הראם – אל קרבו – בבואו, · הנחש תפס אותו – באגפיו! (proposal for II.111: ..., הנחש תפס אותו – בכנפיו!) · הוציא אותו,	–	*libbu* לֵב / *qerbu* קֶרֶב / *karšu* מֵעַיִם kept apart; *ina muḫḫi* עַל; *ṣabātu* תָּפַס	MA.c+5–c+25 → SB II.100–117

Words (one Hebrew each; grep-checked in all corpora):

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
bâru	לָכַד (present לוכד)	–	Gilgameš; replaces §10.3 צָד	II.22–48; MA.b+14–19; OBS.8, 10
rūʾūtu; *rūʾu*; *itbāru*; *ibru*; *râʾu* Gt	עֲמִיתוּת; עָמִית; יְדִיד; רֵעַ (vocalized); הִתְרוֹעֵעַ	cognate (*râʾu*)	§10.3; MA.b+11	II.8–9, 39, 72; OBS.a+14, a+24; MA.b+11
māmītu; *tamû*; *nīšu* (oath)	שְׁבוּעָה; נִשְׁבַּע; חַיִּים	equivalent	נִשְׁבַּע (cohortative) vocalized	II.15–23; OBS.4, a+13
itû; *etēqu*; *nērebu*; *nērebtu*; *ṭūdu*; *ḫarrānu*; *nesû*	גְּבוּל; חָלַף; מָבוֹא; מְבוֹאָה; נָתִיב; אֹרַח (open decision 2: harmonized to Gilgameš by the coordinator); הִתְרַחֵק	equivalent		II.17–20; OBS.1–2; MA.b+3
kakku; *murtappidu*; *ešēru*	נָשַׁק; מְשׁוֹטֵט; יִישַׁר	cognate (*ešēru*)		II.21
gišparru; *šētu*; *nabalkutu* (of a trap)	פַּח (פַּחַד vocalized); רֶשֶׁת; הִתְהַפֵּךְ עַל	equivalent		II.22, 47–48, 69–71
ṣarbatu; *appu* (of a tree); *išdu*; *ṣillu*; *parakku*; *dimtu* I / II	צַפְצָפָה; צַמֶּרֶת; יְסוֹד; כֵּס; צֵל (since 2026-10-23 דּוּכָן); / צְרִיחַ דְּמָעָה	equivalent / cognate (*ṣillu*)	*išdu* = Sum. *suḫuš* יסוד (Agade)	II.2–5, 44, 61; MA.b+8–10
animals	*rīmu* רְאֵם, *serrēmu* חמור בר, *armu* אַקּוֹ, *ṣabītu* צְבִיָּה, *sappāru* **זְמָר**, *ditānu* **תְּאוֹ**, *turāḫu* יָעֵל, *nimru* נָמֵר, *mindinu* **בַּרְדְּלָס**, *būlu* בְּהֵמָה, *nammaštû* (נָעִי) הַנָּע	cognate (*rīmu*, *nimru*)	plurals **זְמָרִים**, **תְּאוֹאִים**, יְעֵלִים, אַקּוֹאִים vocalized	II.26–32; OBS.8, 10; MA.b+15–19
watmu; *līdānu*; *māru*	בֵּן; יֶלֶד; אֶפְרוֹחַ	equivalent	גּוֹזָל reserved	

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
kapādu; *lemuttu* / *lumnu* / *lemnu*; *ēpišu*; *mukillu*; *kullu* D	חָשַׁב ; רָעָה / רַע / רֹעַ ; עוֹשֶׂה ; מַחֲזִיק ; הֶחֱזִיק	–		ll.37–38, 68, 72; OBS.a+14, a+23–24
anzillu; *asakku*; *Anzû*	תּוֹעֵבָה ; דבר אסור ; אַנְזוּ	equivalent		ll.13, 72; OBS.a+23
takālu; *adāru*; *kabātu* D; *šarāku*; *ramānu*	בָּטַח ; חָרַד ; כִּבֵּד ; הֶעֱנִיק (open decision 6); עַצְמִי	cognate (*kabātu*)		ll.62; OBS.a+11–13
šalāmu; *sapāḫu*; *damāmiš*; *ewû*; *laššu*	שָׁלַם ; פָּזוּר ; לְאֵבָל ; הָיָה ; אֵינָם / אֵינֵנוּ ; לְ	–	קִינָה , פּוּץ reserved	ll.56, 66; OBS.a+6, a+15–17
qerbetu; *rapšu*; *rūqu*; *abarša*; *lū* + *tīde*	נָוֶה (Gilgameš נְאוֹת); אָכֵן ; אָמְנָם ; רָחוֹק ; רָחָב ; יָדַעְתְּ	–		ll.68–70; OBS.a+19–21
ukultu; *šiāḫu*; *inbu*; *eṣēlu*; *tarbuʾu*; *ṣupru*; *līliātu*; *akāšu*	אָכְלָה [cognate]; הִתְאַבֵּן ; תְּנוּבָה ; צָמַח ; אֶבֶק ; צִפֹּרֶן ; עֶרֶב ; צָעַד	–	צעד = Gilgameš OB II 144	
MA: *šāgišu*; *gallû*; *titʾû*; *šutattupu*; *nazmātu*; *pašāru* Gt; *rašû*; *minde*; *tūrtu*; *tarāṣu*; *gappu*; *magāru*; *ittiltu* / *šanû* / *šalāšu*; *šalû*; *nurbu*; *karšu*; *qerbu*; *ēribu*; *dayyānu* / *dīnu*; *kasû* D; *naprušu* Ntn	שׁוֹחֵט ; שֵׁד־גַּלָּה ; הָיָה ; לְתִתְאוֹמִים ; נַעֲשׂוּ חֲבֵרִים ; צָרוֹת ; פָּשַׁר זה לזה ; קָנָה ; אוּלַי ; תְּשׁוּבָה ; נָטָה ; אֲגַף ; אָבָה ; פַּעַם ; אַחַת / שָׁנָה / שְׁלֹשׁ ; צָלַל ; רֹךְ ; מֵעַיִם ; קֶרֶב ; הַבָּא ; דַּיָּן / דִּין ; כִּפֵּת ; הִתְעוֹפֵף	cognate (*šanû*, *šalāšu*, *qerbu*, *dayyānu*)	*naprušu* G = עָף for ET4 (gated)	MA.b+5–c+31

Part ET3 – the ambush, the pit, the prayer for a son, the rescue (SB II 73–152; OB Morgan b+1–c+9; MA d+1–f+18), 2026-10-22

Round 3, run 2 (`../renderings.md` §10.5). Translator: sub-agent ET3. Files: `annotated-II.rtl.md` (one header paragraph + II.73–II.152), `annotated-OBM.rtl.md` (one header paragraph + b+1–c+9), `annotated-MA.rtl.md` (one

header paragraph +
d+1–f+18). **153 entries.** Not committed.

Progress and passes

- [x] SB II 73–152 (80) · [x] OB Morgan b+1–c+9 (25) · [x] MA d+1–f+18 (48) · [x] the three header paragraphs
- [x] pass (a) fidelity · [x] pass (b) consistency · [x] pass (c) Hebrew
- [x] `verify ET` – 401 entries, OK (no problem in any line, FORMULAS included; only the coverage note for ET4's lines)
- [x] `check_bible_quotes.py` on the three annotated files and this file – 0 problems
- **Order of work:** SB II 73–152 first (it fixes the Hebrew of the scenes: Šamaš's command and its execution, the
  capture, the plea and refusal, the eagle's and Etana's prayers, the mission), then OB Morgan b–c and MA d–f, copying the
  SB Hebrew (and ET2's MA c Hebrew) wherever the Akkadian is the same and varying only where it varies; the apparatus of
  each line says what the other versions keep, change or lack.
- **Data:** `kings_tools.py data ET` for the three ranges; `pars ET II.73 II.152`; the eBL dictionary per word (nuballu,
  abru, kappu, šubtu, kutmu, šaṭāṭu, sādu, maṣû, ērišu, nudunnû, šērtu, sanāqu, katmu, ullânu, šaqû, ṣabābu, tanattu,
  nāʾeru, kubru, šû III, aslu, muššakku, šāʾiltu, gamāru, pūtu, būrtu, artu, mayyālu, ḫuršānu, agappu, rêmu, dārû,
  dārītu, baqāmu, pištu, šuttatu, bubūtu, ṣūmu, eṭemmu, kabātu, šanû, rebû, nasāḫu, nēšu, katāmu, emūqu, ukultu, maḫāru,
  kašādu, nâlu, barû, qerēbu, ezēbu, malû, banû, išû); every Akkadian precedent looked up in the transliteration lines of
  all corpora (a scratch helper that greps the backticked lines and prints their Hebrew) and every new Hebrew word with
  `kings_tools.py grep all`. Every Bible verse printed with `check_bible_quotes.py --show` before quoting.

- **Pass (a) fidelity:** every `>` line against N and the ATF of its manuscripts: brackets per the ATF (`כוּ[לָ]`, `[הַסְתַּ]כֵּל [עָשָׂכָ]`, `ב`, `רוח`, `[ב]שוחה`, `[א]ותי`, `יָ]ךָ]דוּ`, `והשלי]כהו`, `הנ]שר [האפ]` for *e-r[i-im*, `[בְּ]`); words in N's round brackets not translated (II.119 *(u)*; the ventives of II.96, 123, 128, 143); added words in `( )` (`(אם)` for the conditional *-ma*, `(הדבר)`, `(אותו)`, `(פעם)`); uncertain readings `?` (II.94, 106, 108, 112, OBM b+6, c+9, MA f+9…); stems and tenses re-parsed (II.76 D perfect; II.83/110 Št; II.97 cohortatives; II.123 Gtn present / II.133 Gtn preterite; II.131 stative; II.152 Št; OBM c+2 Š; MA d+9 Gt imperative). Fixed in this pass: II.82/110 *sādu* (open decision 8), II.134 *šuʾu* (open decision 9).
- **Pass (b) consistency:** command ↔ execution compared line by line (II.75/89, 77/91, 78/92, 79/93, 82–83/110, 84/111, 85/119, 86/120, 87/121; 144–146/149–151) – identical words and order, the tense following the Akkadian; repeated lines copied (II.96 = 40, 98–99 = 45–46, 104 = 51, 113 = 7, 115 = 10, 129–130 = ET2's strings, 107 = 109, 88 = 148, 140–142 = MA d+4, MA f+11 = f+13 = f+15, OBM c+6 = II.9); `verify ET` lists no "same transliteration, different Hebrew". Every new Hebrew word grepped in all corpora; collisions found and resolved: `מַאֲרָב` (Gilgameš *ušbu*) → *šubtu* `מִשְׁכָּן` (Gilgameš); `הִגִּיעַ` (Gilgameš *kašādu*) → *maṣû* Št `בְּקַע` / `קָרַע`; `חָדַר` (Agade *zil*, Enūma eliš *ḫepû*) → *šaṭāṭu* `זָנָב`; `שִׁסַּע` (*zibbatu*), `גַּף` (cognate of *gappu*) → *nuballu* `אָחוּ`; **`מְנִיפוּת`** (Sum. *u_2-sal*, Enūma eliš *gipāru*) → *sādu* `צאן`; `מִגְרָשׁ` (*ṣēnu*) → *šuʾu* `שָׂה`; `בָּא` / `נִגַּשׁ` / `קָרַב` (*qerēbu*, *ṭeḫû*, *erēbu*) → *sanāqu* `אַשְׁמָה`; `בְּקֶר` (would make II.125 blame Šamaš) → *šērtu* `עֹנֶשׁ` (Atraḫasīs). Remaining cross-corpus collisions are listed under open decisions.
- **Pass (c) Hebrew:** read aloud; vocalized what would otherwise be misread: `אֵתָנָה` (every occurrence and heading), `הַשָּׁמֶשׁ` / `שַׁמַּשׁ` (MA f+2), `אֶתְּנָה` "I will give" (II.114, OBM c+7: unvocalized it is Etana's name), `מִכְסֵה הַלֵּב` (not `מִכְסָה` "quota"), `בַּמִּגְרָשִׁים`, (not `אֵילַי`), `יְרֵאתִי`, `שָׁתִית`, `הָאִטִּים`, `שֵׁיִי`, `מַגְמָרַי`, `שָׁנָה` (not "year"), `גָּמְרוּ`, `רְאֵה`, `בְּחַן`, `פְּתַח`, `בָּאתָ`, `קְנִי`, `נָסַח`, `לְךָ` / `לֵךְ`, `שׂוּם`, `אָשִׁים`, `שִׂים`, `שֵׂם`, `מָשְׁבָּע`, `אֲבַקֶּרְךָ`, `הַחֲיֵנִי`, `אַחֲיֶה`, `הַעֲלֵנִי`, `אַעַלְךָ`, `קְרַב`, `הַנַּח`, `כְּרֹת`, `מְרֹט`, `וְהַשְׁלִיכֵהוּ`, `בַּחֲצוֹתְךָ`; simplified `לְךָ` → `לֵךְ`.

Deviations from renderings §10 (decided at the first occurrence, with the reason)

1. ***kutum libbi* = מִכְסֵה הַלֵּב** (II.83, 110), not §10.3's (קְרָבַיִם) קֶרֶב : מכסה הקרביים is the [cognate] of *qerbu* (MA c+23, II.145, 150, MA d+9, e+10), and *libbu* of the carcass is לֵב in every line of the
   scene (MA c+5, c+20; II.77, 84, 91, 100, 111; of the pit II.146, 151, MA d+10). The sacrificial parallel stays
   visible in the apparatus: אֶת הַחֵלֶב הַמְכַסֶּה אֶת הַקֶּרֶב (Lev 3:3).
2. ***kubru* = עִבְרִי** (II.134; Gilgameš VI 127, 136, 142, 161), not §10.3's מִשְׁמַנֵּי: one Akkadian word = one
   Hebrew word, and וּמִשְׁמַנֵּי הָאָרֶץ (Gen 27:28) would be an echo without basis.
3. ***šubtu* = מִשְׁכָּן** (II.78, 92; Gilgameš), *šubta nadû* = הֲנִיחַ מִשְׁכָּן (*nadû* "lay" = הניח, ET1) – Foster's "ambush" is the sense (eBL: jB *šubtu* also "trap"); מַאֲרָב belongs to *ušbu* (Gilgameš I 168).
4. **MA d+7 has *etiq šadâm-ma*, not *šadâ ebir*** as §10.3 says (the tablet: *e-tiq KUR-ma*): so חלוף את ההר, the SB
   formula; *[mā?]* (restored quotation particle) is not translated (the FORMULAS regex anchors לך בדרך^; the quotation
   mark does its work). Also: *urḫu* is written ITI ("month") there – a homophone spelling (*arḫu* / *urḫu*), noted.
5. **II.133 word order:** יום יום: אֶתָּנָה אל שַׁמַשׁ מתחנן – the Akkadian has the name first (*etana ūmišam-ma*
   imtaḫḫara šamaš), but the ✓ formula requires יום יום^, and the Hebrew keeps the two daily prayers (123, 133) visibly
   parallel.

Parallels index (ET3)

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.77	pitē-ma libbašu karassu šuṭuṭ	פְּתַח את לבו, שַׁסַּע את מעיו	וַיְשַׁסְּעֵהוּ כְּשַׁסַּע הַגְּדִי (שופטים יד:ו)	equivalent	Rending an animal's carcass, inside which something will dwell (Judg 14:8). *petû* / פָּתַח [cognate]; *šaṭāṭu* = שָׁסַע. Also II.91.
II.78	šubta idi ina karšīšu	הַנַּח משכן במעיו	יֵשֵׁב בְּמַאְרַב חֲצֵרִים (תהלים י:ח)	equivalent	The lurker "sits" in ambush; *šubtu* (from *wašābu*) is "dwelling" and (jB) "trap". Foster's "ambush" is the sense, not the word. Also II.92.
II.79	iṣṣurāt šamāmī urradā-ma ikkalā šīra	ציפורי השמים – יורדות ואוכלות בשר	וַיֵּרֶד הָעַיִט עַל הַפְּגָרִים (בראשית טו:יא)	equivalent	Birds of prey descending on a carcass. Also II.93, 105.
II.81	ina lā īdû	בלא ידע	תְּבוֹאֵהוּ שׁוֹאָה לֹא-יֵדָע: וְרִשְׁתּוֹ אֲשֶׁר-טָמַן תִּלְכְּדוֹ (תהלים לה:ח)	equivalent	Caught unawares, in the god's trap (ET2 linked Ps 35:8 to II.47).
II.83	kutum libbi	מִכְסֵה הַלֵּב	אֶת הַחֵלֶב הַמְכַסֶּה אֶת הַקֶּרֶב (ויקרא ג:ג)	equivalent	*kutum libbi* (eBL: "stomach tissue of animal") is the caul fat that Leviticus reserves for God; the eagle goes for the god's portion. Also II.110.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.85	kappīšu abrīšu u nuballīšu	כנפיו, אֶבְרוֹתָיו ו*מְנִיפוֹתָיו*	יַעֲלוּ אֵבָר כַּנְּשָׁרִים (ישעיהו מ:לא); יְשַׁאֲהוּ עַל אֶבְרָתוֹ (דברים לב:יא)	cognate	*abru* / אֶבְרָה , אֵבָר – in both verses of an eagle. Also II.119.
II.85	kappu, abru, nuballu	כנף, אבר, *מניפה*	הַנֶּשֶׁר הַגָּדוֹל גְּדוֹל הַכְּנָפַיִם אָרֶךְ הָאֵבָר מָלֵא הַנּוֹצָה (יחזקאל יז:ג)	equivalent	Three words for the eagle's wing, in Ezekiel's eagle parable too (נוֹצָה kept for *nāṣu*, III).
II.86	buquššū-ma idīšu ana šuttati	מְרֹט אותו – וְהַשְׁלִיכֵהוּ אל השוחה	הַשְׁלִיכוּ אֹתוֹ אֶל הַבּוֹר הַזֶּה (בראשית לז:כב); וַיִּפְשְׁטוּ אֶת יוֹסֵף אֶת כֻּתָּנְתּוֹ (בראשית לז:כג)	equivalent	Stripped (plucked), then thrown into a pit – the Joseph sequence; *nadû* = הִשְׁלִיךְ (gated). Also II.120 (וַיַּשְׁלִכוּ אֹתוֹ הַבּוֹרָה, Gen 37:24).
II.87	mūt bubūti u ṣummi limūt	מות רעבון וצמא – ימות	וְהַבּוֹר רֵק אֵין בּוֹ מָיִם (בראשית לז:כד)	equivalent	The dry pit: death by thirst.
II.87	mūt … limūt	מות … ימות	מוֹת יָמֻתוּ בַּמִּדְבָּר (במדבר כו:סה)	equivalent	Internal object of "die"; not יוּמַת (nobody kills him).

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.88	ana zikir šamaš qurādi	למאמר שַׁמַשׁ הגיבור	וַיַּעַשׂ נֹחַ: כְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה אֹתוֹ אֱלֹהִים כֵּן עָשָׂה (בראשית ו:כב)	equivalent	The hinge from command to execution; the execution retells the command in its words (II.89–93; 149–151).
II.97	alkānim-ma i nīrid-ma … i nīkula	לְכוּ, נֵרְדָה … נֹאכְלָה	הָבָה נֵרְדָה (בראשית יא:ז)	equivalent	The same cohortative "let us go down" (*warādu* / יָרַד [cognate]); there God goes down to punish, here the eagle goes down to his punishment.
II.97	alkānim-ma	לְכוּ	וְעַתָּה לְכוּ וְנַהַרְגֵהוּ וְנַשְׁלִכֵהוּ בְּאַחַד הַבֹּרוֹת (בראשית לז:כ)	divergence	"Come, let us…" – the brothers plan to throw Joseph into a pit; the eagle who says "come" ends in it.
II.100	ṣerru rabiṣ	הנחש רובץ	לַפֶּתַח חַטָּאת רֹבֵץ (בראשית ד:ז)	cognate	The lurker (ET2 at MA c+5). *minde* "perhaps" – Foster's "no doubt" is wrong.
II.101	itti libbīšu amāta iqabbi	עם לבו? – דבר אומר	דִּבַּרְתִּי אֲנִי עִם לִבִּי (קהלת א:טז)	equivalent	Speaking "with" one's heart – the same preposition.
II.108	išniʾ	שָׁנָה	וַיֹּאמֶר שְׁנוּ וַיִּשְׁנוּ (מלכים א יח:לד)	cognate	As ET2 at MA c+16.
II.111	ṣerru iṣṣabassu ina kappīšu	הנחש תפס אותו – בכנפיו	מִשָּׁם אֲצַוֶּה אֶת הַנָּחָשׁ וּנְשָׁכָם (עמוס ט:ג)	equivalent	The serpent as the god's executioner (II.76 "I have bound for you").

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.111	(the eagle caught)		נַפְשֵׁנוּ כְּצִפּוֹר נִמְלְטָה מִפַּח יוֹקְשִׁים (תהלים קכד:ז)	divergence	The psalm's bird escapes; this bird is caught, and escapes only months later, by a man's hand.
II.114	kīma ēriši nudunnâ luddinka	כְּחָתָן – מַתָּן אֶתְּנָה לְךְ	הַרְבּוּ עָלַי מְאֹד מֹהַר וּמַתָּן וְאֶתְּנָה כַּאֲשֶׁר תֹּאמְרוּ אֵלָי (בראשית לד:יב)	equivalent	A bridegroom, a marriage gift, and the cohortative "I will give" – the eagle bids for his life in the language of a bride-price. *ērišu* ("the requester") ~ אָרַשׁ noted, not used (guidelines §6.7).
II.116	umaššarkā-ma šamaš elēnu kī appal	(אם) – אֲשַׁלֵּחֵךְ, את שַׁמַּשׁ, מלמעלה, איך אענה	יַעַן שִׁלַּחְתָּ אֶת אִישׁ חָרְמִי מִיָּד וְהָיְתָה נַפְשְׁךָ תַּחַת נַפְשׁוֹ (מלכים א כ:מב)	equivalent	Releasing the man the god condemned makes the releaser die in his place – exactly the serpent's fear (II.117); *wuššuru* = שִׁלַּח.
II.116	kī appal	איך אענה	וְאֵיךְ אֶעֱשֶׂה הָרָעָה הַגְּדֹלָה הַזֹּאת וְחָטָאתִי לֵאלֹהִים (בראשית לט:ט)	equivalent	Refusal out of fear of God.
II.116	umaššarka	אֲשַׁלֵּחֵךְ	לֹא אֲשַׁלֵּחֲךָ כִּי אִם בֵּרַכְתָּנִי (בראשית לב:כז)	divergence	Jacob will not "release" the man without a blessing; the serpent will not release the eagle even for a gift.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.117	šēretka isaḫḫurā ana muḫḫīya	עונשך – יסוב עליי	תְּסוֹב עָלֶיךָ כּוֹס יְמִין יְהוָה (חבקוק ב:טז); וְעַל קָדְקָדוֹ חֲמָסוֹ יֵרֵד (תהלים ז:יז)	equivalent	The punishment "turns" onto someone (*saḫāru* / סָבַב), literally "onto my skull" (*muḫḫu*) – like Ps 7:17, in the psalm of the pit (7:16).
II.124	ina šuttati amât(am)-ma	[ב–] שוחה אמות	נָחְשַׁבְתִּי עִם-יוֹרְדֵי בוֹר (תהלים פח:ה); קָרָאתִי שִׁמְךָ יְהוָה מִבּוֹר תַּחְתִּיּוֹת (איכה ג:נה)	equivalent	The prayer from the pit; the hunter's pitfall becomes the pit of the lament psalms.
II.126	bulliṭannī	הַחֲיֵנִי	דָּבְקָה לֶעָפָר נַפְשִׁי; חַיֵּנִי כִּדְבָרֶךָ (תהלים קיט:כה)	equivalent	Also Ps 30:4 (הֶעֱלִיתָ מִן-שְׁאוֹל נַפְשִׁי; חִיִּיתַנִי, quoted in the entry).
II.127	ana ūmī dārûti zikirka luštešmi	לִימֵי נֶצַח – את זִכְרְךָ אַשְׁמִיעָה	כִּי אֵין בַּמָּוֶת זִכְרֶךָ; בִּשְׁאוֹל מִי יוֹדֶה-לָּךְ (תהלים ו:ו); וְזֶה זִכְרִי לְדֹר דֹּר (שמות ג:טו)	cognate	*zikru* / זֵכֶר; the vow of praise of the lament psalms – the dead cannot remember the god, so save me.
II.127	(the vow)		הוֹצִיאָה מִמַּסְגֵּר נַפְשִׁי לְהוֹדוֹת אֶת-שְׁמֶךָ (תהלים קמב:ח)	equivalent	Rescue in exchange for praise of the name.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.129	lemnētā-ma kabtatī tušamriṣ	רַע אַתָּה – ואת כְּבֵדִי הֶחֱלֵיתָ	אִם תַּעֲשֶׂה עִמָּנוּ רָעָה (בראשית כו:כט)	equivalent	The peace-oath's condition (II.12) is now the indictment, in the god's mouth. II.130 = II.13 (לֹא תֹאכַל כָּל תּוֹעֵבָה, Deut 14:3).
II.132	amēlu ša ašapparakku	אדם אשר אשלח לְךָ	שָׁלַח לִפְנֵיהֶם אִישׁ; לְעָבֶד נִמְכַּר יוֹסֵף (תהלים קה:יז); כִּי לְמִחְיָה שְׁלָחַנִי אֱלֹהִים לִפְנֵיכֶם (בראשית מה:ה)	equivalent	The man God sends to keep life – Joseph, who came up from the pit.
II.132	qātka liṣbat	את ידך יתפוס	וְהַחֲזִיקִי אֶת יָדֶךָ בּוֹ (בראשית כא:יח)	equivalent	Taking the hand of one dying of thirst; fulfilled in OBM c+1 (את ידו תפס).
II.132	amēlu	אדם	וַיִּמְצָאֵהוּ אִישׁ וְהִנֵּה תֹעֶה בַּשָּׂדֶה (בראשית לז:טו)	divergence	The anonymous "man" at the turning point: in Genesis he leads to the pit, here he will lead out of it.
II.133	etana ūmišam-ma imtaḫḫara šamaš	יום יום – אֵתָנָה אל שַׁמַשׁ מתחנן	וַיֶּעְתַּר יִצְחָק לַיהוָה לְנֹכַח אִשְׁתּוֹ כִּי עֲקָרָה הִוא (בראשית כה:כא); וְכֵן יַעֲשֶׂה שָׁנָה בְשָׁנָה (שמואל א א:ז)	equivalent	Repeated prayer for a child; no Akkadian "barren" here (עֲקָרָה reserved).

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.134	tākul šamaš kubur šu’īya	אכלת, שַׁמַּשׁ, את עובי שֻׁיִי	הַאוֹכַל בְּשַׂר אַבִּירִים; וְדַם עַתּוּדִים אֶשְׁתֶּה (תהלים נ:יג)	divergence	The psalm denies exactly what Etana's argument assumes: a god who eats the offering and drinks its blood (II.135).
II.134	šu’u	שֻׁה (שֻׁיִי)	וְאַיֵּה הַשֶּׂה לְעֹלָה (בראשית כב:ז)	cognate	The sacrificial "sheep".
II.135	erṣetu tašti dām aslīya	– הארץ שָׁתִית את דם אֵילַי	אֲשֶׁר פָּצְתָה אֶת פִּיהָ לָקַחַת אֶת דְּמֵי אָחִיךָ (בראשית ד:יא)	equivalent	The earth that drinks blood; Foster's "Netherworld" is interpretation (שְׁאוֹל never). Also Ps 66:15 (עִם-קְטֹרֶת אֵילִים).
II.136	ilī ukabbit eṭemmī aplaḫ	את האלים כיבדתי, את האִטִים יָרֵאתִי	כִּי מְכַבְּדַי אֲכַבֵּד (שמואל א ב:ל); אַיֵּה כְבוֹדִי ... אַיֵּה מוֹרָאִי (מלאכי א:ו)	cognate	*kabātu* D / כִּבֵּד; honour and fear as a pair.
II.136	eṭemmī aplaḫ	את האִטִים יָרֵאתִי	וְלֹא נָתַתִּי מִמֶּנּוּ לְמֵת (דברים כו:יד)	divergence	Israel's tithe declaration boasts of giving nothing to the dead; Etana boasts of revering them.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.137	šā’ilātu	השואלות	וְשֹׁאֵל אוֹב וְיִדְּעֹנִי וְדֹרֵשׁ אֶל הַמֵּתִים (דברים יח:יא)	cognate	*šāʾilu* / שׁאל: the Torah forbids the two acts of piety Etana lists (the "inquirers", the cult of the dead).
II.137	šā’ilātu, maššakkū	השואלות, מֻגְמָרֵי	וַיִּשְׁאַל שָׁאוּל בַּיהוָה וְלֹא עָנָהוּ יְהוָה גַּם בַּחֲלֹמוֹת (שמואל א כח:ו)	equivalent	A king who tried every channel, dreams included, without answer – and then a woman diviner (28:7).
II.138	aslīya ina ṭubbuḫi ilū igdamrū	את אֵילַי – בטבח – האלים גָּמְרוּ	שָׂבַעְתִּי עֹלוֹת אֵילִים (ישעיהו א:יא)	divergence	Isaiah's God is "sated" with rams and refuses them; Etana's gods "finished" his rams and gave nothing. *ṭabāḫu* / טבח [cognate].
II.139	bēlī ina pîka liṣâm-ma	אדוני – מפיך יֵצֵא	מִלְפָנֶיךָ מִשְׁפָּטִי יֵצֵא (תהלים יז:ב)	equivalent	The verdict "going out" from the god.
II.140	idnam-ma šamma ša alādi	תנה לי את עשב הלידה	תְּנִי נָא לִי מִדּוּדָאֵי בְּנֵךְ (בראשית ל:יד)	divergence	A fertility plant asked with "give me": mandrakes (דּוּדָאִים reserved) vs a plant in heaven. Also III.12.
II.140	idnam-ma	תנה לי	הָבָה לִּי בָנִים וְאִם אַיִן מֵתָה אָנֹכִי (בראשית ל:א)	equivalent	"Give me (sons)" – life and death.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
II.142	piltī usuḫ	נסח את חרפתי	אָסַף אֱלֹהִים אֶת חֶרְפָּתִי (בראשית ל:כג)	equivalent	*pištu* / חֶרְפָּה (gated). Also MA d+4, III.14.
II.142	šuma šuknanni	שִׂים לי שֵׁם	כִּי אָמַר אֵין לִי בֵּן בַּעֲבוּר הַזְכִּיר שְׁמִי (שמואל ב יח:יח); וְלֹא יִמָּחֶה שְׁמוֹ מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל (דברים כה:ו)	equivalent	*šumu* = name and offspring; Absalom, without a son, sets up a pillar so that his name be remembered.
II.142	šuma šuknanni	שִׂים לי שֵׁם	וְנַעֲשֶׂה לָּנוּ שֵׁם (בראשית יא:ד)	divergence	A name made by building (Gen 11) vs a name asked of the god as a son.
II.146	ina libbīša nadi erû	בלבה מושלך נשר	אַךְ אֶל שְׁאוֹל תּוּרָד אֶל יַרְכְּתֵי בוֹר (ישעיהו יד:טו); וְאַתָּה הָשְׁלַכְתָּ מִקִּבְרְךָ (ישעיהו יד:יט)	equivalent	Isaiah 14 complete: "I will go up to heaven … and sit" (II.43, ET2) – brought down to the pit, "cast out". Also II.151, MA d+10.
II.152	ullânum-ma uštaqqâššu	מיד – מגביה אותו	מִקִּימִי מֵעָפָר דָּל (תהלים קיג:ז)	equivalent	Raising from the depth.
OBM.b+10	išpil	שְׁפַל	גַּאֲוַת אָדָם תַּשְׁפִּילֶנּוּ (משלי כט:כג)	equivalent	The proud eagle brought low (also Obad 1:4, quoted in the entry).

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
OBM.b+12	šamšum qātī ṣabat	שַׁמַשׁ, את ידי תפוס	אָחַזְתָּ בְּיַד-יְמִינִי (תהלים עג:כג)	equivalent	The god who holds the hand; answered by II.132 and fulfilled in OBM c+1.
OBM.b+15	lemnēti kabtāti	רעות כבדות	וְחַטָּאתָם כִּי כָבְדָה מְאֹד (בראשית יח:כ)	cognate	"Heavy" sins (*kabtu* / כָּבֵד, gated).
OBM.c+1	qāssu iṣbatam	את ידו תפס	וְהַחֲזִיקִי אֶת יָדֵךְ בּוֹ (בראשית כא:יח)	equivalent	The promise of II.132 fulfilled, in the OB version.
OBM.c+2	ušētiqam šuttassu	הֶעֱבִיר את (אותו) שוחתו	וַיַּעֲלוּ אֶת יוֹסֵף מִן הַבּוֹר (בראשית לז:כח); וַיַּעֲלוּ אֹתוֹ מִן הַבּוֹר (ירמיהו לח:יג)	equivalent	Drawn up from the pit by men.
OBM.c+3	kīma nēšim nāʾerim	כאריה שואג	הַכְּפִירִים שֹׁאֲגִים לַטָּרֶף; וּלְבַקֵּשׁ מֵאֵל אָכְלָם (תהלים קד:כא)	equivalent	The roaring lion and its "food" (*ukultu* / אֹכֶל [cognate]).
OBM.c+4	emūqam īšu	כוח – היה לו	וְקוֵי יְהוָה יַחֲלִיפוּ כֹחַ יַעֲלוּ אֵבֶר כַּנְּשָׁרִים (ישעיהו מ:לא); תִּתְחַדֵּשׁ כַּנֶּשֶׁר נְעוּרָיְכִי (תהלים קג:ה)	equivalent	The eagle that renews its strength – the biblical image is the story's event.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
OBM.c+6	ibrī lū itbārānū ana u attā	רֵעִי, נהיה ידידים – אני ואתה	וְעַתָּה לְכָה נִכְרְתָה בְרִית אֲנִי וָאָתָּה (בראשית לא:מד)	equivalent	The eagle offers Etana the very formula of the friendship he broke with the serpent (II.9, ET2).
OBM.c+7	qibiam-ma ša terrišanni luddikkum	אמור לי – את אשר תשאל ממני אֶתְּנָה לְךָ –	וְאֶתְּנָה כַּאֲשֶׁר תֹּאמְרוּ אֵלָי (בראשית לד:יב); שְׁאַל מָה אֶתֵּן לָךְ (מלכים א ג:ה)	equivalent	The open offer of a gift (Solomon's – in a night dream; cf. MA d+5–d+6).
OBM.c+9	īnīyā-mi pite katimtī	את עיניי? פְּתַח – את נִסְתָּרַי	גַּל-עֵינַי וְאַבִּיטָה נִפְלָאוֹת מִתּוֹרָתֶךָ (תהלים קיט:יח)	equivalent	Asking that the eyes be opened to the hidden. *katimtu* = נִסְתָּר (Gilgameš I 7, *katimta ipte*).
OBM.c+9	pite	פְּתַח	וְנִפְקְחוּ עֵינֵיכֶם; וְהְיִיתֶם כֵּאלֹהִים (בראשית ג:ה); וַיִּפְקַח אֱלֹהִים אֶת עֵינֶיהָ (בראשית כא:יט)	divergence	*petû* = פָּתַח [cognate]; פָּקַח stays reserved. A man asks an eagle (MA d+3: the sun-god) to open his eyes.
MA.d+3	[īn]īya pite katmāti	ניי[את עי] פְּתַח – (את) המכוסות	וְאֵין נִסְתָּר מֵחַמָּתוֹ (תהלים יט:ז)	equivalent	Our proposal: nothing is hidden from the sun – the prayer to the sun-god to open the hidden.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
MA.d+5–6	ittīl-ma etana ibarri … šutta īmur	שָׁכַב אֵתָנָה, ובוחן … חלום ראה	וַיִּשְׁכַּב בַּמָּקוֹם הַהוּא (בראשית כח:יא); בַּחֲלוֹם חָזְיוֹן לַיְלָה … בְּתַנּוּמוֹת עָלַי מִשְׁכָּב (איוב לג:טו); בַּחֲלוֹם הַלָּיְלָה (מלכים א ג:ה)	equivalent	Lying down to receive a dream (incubation); MA gives Šamaš's answer in a dream, SB in direct speech.
MA.e+8	attā-ma etana šar būli	אתה הוא אֵתָנָה, מלך הבהמה	וְגַם בַּהֲמוֹת שָׂדָי (תהלים ח:ח)	equivalent	The ruler of the animals; Foster's "wild beasts" narrows *būlu*.
MA.e+10	ištu qereb šuttati šūlânni	מקרב השוחה – הַעֲלֵנִי	וַיַּעֲלֵנִי מִבּוֹר שָׁאוֹן (תהלים מ:ג); וַתַּעַל מִשַּׁחַת חַיַּי (יונה ב:ז)	cognate	*elû* Š / הֶעֱלָה.
MA.e+13	ana ūm dārâti tanattaka	[ל]יום נצחים תהילתך –	לְדֹר וָדֹר נְסַפֵּר תְּהִלָּתֶךָ (תהלים עט:יג)	equivalent	The vow of praise – here vowed to a man (SB II.127: to Šamaš).
MA.e+16	ušellīka	[אַעַלְךָ]	וְאָנֹכִי אַעַלְךָ גַּם עָלֹה (בראשית מו:ד)	cognate	The same form, in God's promise to Jacob.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
MA.f+2	ištu ṣīt šamši adi šalām šamši	ממוצא הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ – עד שקיעת הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ	מִמִּזְרַח-שֶׁמֶשׁ עַד-מְבוֹאוֹ (תהלים קיג:ג); מוֹשִׁיבִי עֲקֶרֶת הַבַּיִת אֵם-הַבָּנִים שְׂמֵחָה (תהלים קיג:ט)	equivalent	Our proposal: Ps 113 joins "from sunrise to sunset", raising the poor from the dust (113:7) and the barren mother – the three motifs of MA e–f.
MA.f+5	anāku anaddinakku ša alādi šamma	אני – אתן לך את עשב הלידה	וְעֵץ הַחַיִּים בְּתוֹךְ הַגָּן (בראשית ב:ט)	absent	Foster's "plant of life" is a slip: the tablet has *ša alādi* "of birth" – no tree or plant of life in Etana (a false echo avoided).
MA.f+7	pūt būrti umdellâ	את פְּאַת הבור – מילא	וְהַבּוֹר רֵק אֵין בּוֹ מָיִם (בראשית לז:כד); וַיְשַׁלְּחֵם אֶל יִרְמְיָהוּ אֶל הַבּוֹר בַּחֲבָלִים (ירמיהו לח:יא)	cognate	*būrtu* / בּוֹר (gated), MA's only "cistern" (elsewhere *šuttatu*); a practical rescue from a pit, like Ebed-melech's rags and ropes.
MA.f+11	iṣabbuba agappīšu	מנפנף באגפיו	כְּנָשֶׁר יָעִיר קִנּוֹ עַל גּוֹזָלָיו יְרַחֵף (דברים לב:יא)	equivalent	*ṣabābu* "flutter, flap" (Š: "teach fledglings to spread wings"); יְרַחֵף kept for the apparatus.
MA.f+14	u rebūti	ו(פעם) רביעית	וַיֹּאמֶר שֶׁב שֶׁבַע פְּעָמִים (מלכים א יח:מג)	equivalent	Our proposal: an attempt repeated with a rising count until it succeeds.

Key findings

The Bible.

1. **Genesis 37 in a fable.** The eagle's fate follows Joseph's step by step: "come, let us go down" (II.97 – לְכוּ,
   Gen 37:20), stripped – plucked (II.86, 120 ↔ 37:23), "thrown into the pit" with the same verb (*nadû* = הַשְׁלִיךְ;
   37:22, 24), a pit "without water" where he should die of hunger and thirst (II.87 ↔ 37:24), an anonymous "man" (II.132
   ↔ 37:15), and drawn up out of the pit (OBM c+2, MA e+10, f+7 ↔ 37:28). And Ps 105:17 says it in the god's voice:
   (תהלים קה:יז) שָׁלַח לִפְנֵיהֶם אִישׁ – exactly Šamaš's *amēlu ša ašapparakku* (II.132); Gen 45:5 כִּי
   (בראשית מה:ה) לְמִחְיָה שְׁלָחַנִי אֱלֹהִים לִפְנֵיכֶם.
2. **Isaiah 14 completed.** ET2 found Isa 14:13 in the eagle's plan ("I will go up and dwell in heaven", II.43); ET3's lines
   complete it: the one who said it is "brought down to the depths of the pit" and "cast out" (Isa 14:15, 19) – the
   eagle "cast" in the pit (II.146, 151), "brought low" (OBM b+10 *išpil*; Prov 29:23, Obad 1:4).
3. **The lament psalms of the pit.** The eagle's prayer (II.123–127) has their structure and vocabulary: prayer from the
   pit (Ps 88:5, 7; Lam 3:55), "keep me alive" (Ps 30:4, 119:25), and the vow of praise: "for days of eternity I will make
   your *zikru* heard" (II.127) – *zikru* / זֵכֶר [cognate], the same argument as Ps 6:6 and Ps 142:8. MA gives the vow
   to the man instead (e+13).
4. **The barren king's prayer and the "name".** Etana's plea (II.140–142, MA d+4) meets Gen 30 (30:1, 14, 22–23), Isaac's
   and Hannah's repeated prayers (Gen 25:21, 1 Sam 1:7), and above all the "name" that only a son preserves (2 Sam 18:18,
   Deut 25:6, Ruth 4:10); Gen 11:4's name made by building is a [divergence].
5. **The piety the Torah forbids.** Etana's claim on the god lists honouring the gods, *revering the ghosts* and the
   incense of the *šāʾilātu* (female inquirers) – Deut 18:11 forbids the שֹׁאֵל (*šāʾilu* [cognate]) and the inquirer of
   the dead, and Deut 26:14 boasts of giving nothing to the dead; 1 Sam 28:6–7 shows a king who did try dreams and a woman
   diviner. His argument "you ate, Šamaš … earth, you drank the blood" is what Ps 50:13 rejects; Isa 1:11 (rams) likewise.

6. **The bargain in the language of marriage.** The eagle offers the serpent a bridegroom's *nudunnû* (II.114) – Gen 34:12 מֹהַר וּמַתָּן וְאֶתְּנָה – and in OB offers Etana "tell me what you ask, I will give it" (OBM c+7), the same cohortative; 1 Kgs 3:5 ("ask what I shall give you", in a night dream) is the closest royal parallel.
7. **The serpent's refusal and 1 Kings 20.** "If I release you, how shall I answer Šamaš? Your punishment would turn on me" (II.116–118) is the logic of 1 Kgs 20:42: the one who "released" (שִׁלַּחְתָּ = *wuššuru*) the man under the god's ban dies in his place.
8. **Small words and false echoes.** *kutum libbi* is the caul fat of Lev 3:3 (the god's portion; II.83); *petû* = פָּתַח, not Gen 3:5's פָּקַח (OBM c+9, MA d+3); Foster's "plant of life" (MA f+5: the tablet has "of birth"), "lament" (II.73: *unnīnu* "supplication"), "Netherworld" (II.135), "no doubt" (II.100), "king of the wild beasts" (*būlu*), "tail feathers" (*nuballu*), "ambush" (*šubtu* "dwelling") – each checked against the Akkadian.

The ancient mind.

1. **Šamaš's justice and mercy, separated.** He hears the wronged serpent, prepares the trap himself ("I have bound a wild ox for you"), makes the serpent his executioner; he will not save the oath-breaker ("you are under oath – I will not visit you") – yet he does not let him die: he "sends a man". He answers two prayers with one answer: a king without a son and an eagle without wings need each other.
2. **The serpent is an official, not an avenger.** He refuses mercy for fear of answering to the god "above": the punishment he inflicts would fall on him if he relented – the logic of a deputy under oath.
3. **The pious king who has done everything.** Fat sheep, the blood of rams poured on the earth, the gods honoured, the ghosts feared, the incense of the dream-women used up – and no son. Piety as a contract with the god, and the son as the one who will keep the father's "name" and feed his ghost: without him the king dies twice.

4. **Dreams as a technique.** MA: Etana "lay down and examines (*barû*)" – incubation; the god answers in "the bed of the
night"; SB has the same answer in direct speech; and the *šāʾilātu* used incense to obtain dreams.
5. **The hunter's world.** A carcass as bait, a pitfall (*šuttatu*), birds of prey coming down in a crowd, the eagle that
circles and pecks "in front and behind" before going in – exact observation of animals; and the recovery is slow:
seven months, the eighth (OBM), attempt after attempt (MA f).
6. **Friendship as a renewable treaty.** The eagle repeats to Etana the words with which he once bound himself to the
serpent (OBM c+6 = II.9) – the second friendship rises out of the pit of the first; MA seals it "for ever" (e+17).
7. **A Hebrew-only pun:** the cohortative "I will give" (אֶתְּנָה, II.114, OBM c+7) is spelt like Etana's name in
Hebrew; kept vocalized, noted, not exploited.

Open decisions (numbered; the minor ones decided)

1. ***kutum libbi* = מְכַסֶּה הַלֵּב** instead of §10.3's מכסה הקרביים (decided; deviation 1).
2. ***maṣû* Št = חָדַר** (II.83, 110; decided): ET2 restored MA c+22 *uštamṣi?* as הִגִּיעַ ;?הגיע is *kašādu* (Gilgameš; II.90). **Proposal for the coordinator:** MA c+22 → אל מעי ה[ראם – חדר?].
3. ***nuballu* = מְנִיפוֹת** (II.85, 119; decided, italic): Hebrew has no fourth wing word (כָּנָף *kappu*, אֵבָר
abru, נוֹצָה *nāṣu*, אֲגַף *gappu/agappu*; גַּף is *gappu*'s cognate; זָנָב *zibbatu*); eBL "(eagle's) wing;
also a form of snare?" – the spread wing or tail "like a fan". The coordinator may prefer a transliteration.
4. ***šērtu* = עֹנֶשׁ** (II.117, 118, 125; OBM b+5; Atraḫasīs) vs אַשְׁמָה in Gilgameš I 238 and Ludlul III 58 – a
cross-corpus split (lead). Here only "punishment" fits all four lines (אשמתך in II.125 would blame Šamaš).
5. ***ērišu* = חָתָן** (II.114) collides with Gilgameš VI 42, 46, where *ḫāmiru* "husband, lover" is חתן (lead).
6. ***sanāqu* = בָּקַר** (II.131; decided): "check" (Lev 13:36) and "come to (see)"; קָרַב *qerēbu*, נָגַשׁ *ṭeḫû*,
בָּא *erēbu* are taken.
7. ***šubtu* = מִשְׁכָּן** (decided; deviation 3).
8. ***sādu* = מִגְרָשׁ** (II.82, 110; decided): אָחוּ already carries Sum. *u₂-sal* (EA, Agade, Gudea, EWO) and Enūma
eliš *gipāru* – a split the lead may want to look at.

9. ***šuʾu* = שָׂה** [cognate] (שִׂיִי, collective; decided): צֹאן is *ṣēnu* (Enūma eliš VII 131).
10. ***kubru* = עִבְרִי** (decided; deviation 2).
11. **II.133 word order** forced by the FORMULAS regex ^יום יום (deviation 5); the coordinator may relax the regex if
    אֲתָּנָה – יום יום אל שַׁמַּשׁ מתחנן: is preferred.
12. ***unnīnu* תַּחֲנוּנִים** (harmonization) and ***maḫāru* Gtn** (10.3§) מִתְחַנֵּן share a Hebrew root – two pre-set
    renderings; kept (noun / verb), noted in II.73 (lead).
13. ***etēqu* Š = הֶעֱבִיר** (OBM c+2; decided): הֶחֱלִיף means "exchange" (and is *riābu* in the law corpus); *ebēru*
    (whose Š would be העביר) does not occur in Etana – a note for later corpora.
14. **renderings §10.3, MA d+7 row:** the tablet has *etiq šadâm-ma* (חלוף), not *šadâ ebir* – the row should be
    corrected (coordinator).
15. **ET1's OBM header paragraph** quotes c+9 as "פָּקַח את עיניי"; פקח is reserved and the line has פָּתַח. I did
    not edit ET1's paragraph; my paragraph notes it (coordinator may correct).
16. **OBM b+9:** eBL does not lemmatize *er[îm*, so the נשר gate has no licence there; the Hebrew הנ]שר (brackets per
    the ATF *e-r[i-im*) passes. If the tool should license by the normalization too, add *erîm*/*erû* to the ET gate.
17. ***šaṭāṭu* = שְׁסַע** (II.77, 91) beside Ur-Namma's Sum. *šu sur₅* **שסעו** (italic) – minor.
18. ***nāʾeru* = שׁוֹאֵג** (OBM c+3, MA f+16; Gilgameš V 124, 308) vs Atraḫasīs כנשר צורח – an existing split (lead).
19. **II.94** (statement or question) and **II.124** (exclamation; Foster: question) – decided; alternatives in the notes.
20. **II.152** – subject of *uštaqqâššu* uncertain (Etana lifting the eagle, or the reverse); מגביה אותו keeps it open.
21. ***mā*** = הֵן (OBM b+4); the restored *[mā?]* of MA d+7 is untranslated (formula anchor). Decided.

Proposals for the corpus renderings

Fixed strings (exactly as written; later parts copy them; brackets and ? follow each copy's manuscripts):

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
Šamaš's command / execution	לך בדרך, חלוף [את ההר], · כְּפַתִּי לך "רְאֵ[ם ...]. · פְּתַח את לבו, [שַׂסַּע את מעיו], · הַנַּח משכן [במעיו]. · [כל] ציפורי השמים [יורדות – ואוכלות בשר]; · את רֹךְ הבשר – מבקש, בַּמִּגְרָשִׁים? – מתהלך, · אל מִכְסֵה הַלֵּב – חודר. · אל הלב – בבואו – אתה, תפוס אותו – בכנפיו! · כְּרֹת את כנפיו, את אֶבְרוֹתָיו ואת **מְנִיפוֹתָיו**, · מְרֹט אותו – וְהַשְׁלִיכֵהוּ אל השוחה ..., · מות רעבון וצמא – ימות!" / למאמר שַׁמַּשׁ הגיבור – · הנחש הלך, חלף את ההר. · הגיע הנחש אל הראם, · פתח את לבו, שִׂסַּע את מעיו. · הניח משכן במעיו. · כל ציפורי השמים יָ[רָ]דוּ – ואוכלות בשר. · אל הלב – בבואו – הנחש תפס אותו – בכנפיו! · כָּרַת את כנפיו, את אֶבְרוֹתָיו, את **מְנִיפוֹתָיו**, · מרט אותו – והשלי[כהו אל השוחה] ... [...]	equivalent	command → execution in the command's words and order	II.75–93, 110–111, 119–121
the second warning, the descent	רד, אבי! אולי – בלב? הראם הזה –[אל ת]" הנחש רובץ!" · [הנ]שר – עם לבו? – דבר אומר: · ירד ועמד על הראם. · מבקש את אשר לפניו ואשר אחריו. · שָׁנָה – נָסַח? בשר,	cognate (*rabāṣu*, *šanû*)	ET2's MA c strings adopted	II.100–109
the plea and the refusal	בָּאתָ? אל קִנִּי?! · "רַחֲמַנִי! כְּחָתָן – מַתָּן אָתְּנָה לְךָ!" · "(אם) אֲשַׁלֵּחֲךָ – את שַׁמַּשׁ, מלמעלה, איך אענה? · עונשך – יסוב עליי, הֵן –" ; OB "אני – אשר אָשִׁים עליך עונש!· [...] אֲשַׁלַּ[חֲךָ? ...] · עונשך	equivalent	*wuššuru* שְׁלַח; *šērtu* עֹנֶשׁ	II.112–118; OBM b+4–b+5
the eagle's prayer	יום יום – אל שַׁמַּשׁ מתחנן: · "[ב]שוחה – אמות! · מי יודע – איך שׂוּם עליי עונשך? · [א]ותי – את הנשר – הַחַיֵּנִי, · לִימֵי נָצַח – את זִכְרְךָ אַשְׁמִיעָה!"	cognate (*zikru*)	לִימֵי נָצַח for *ana ūmī dārûti* (never עוֹלָם)	II.123–127
Šamaš's verdict and promise	רַע אַתָּה – ואת כְּבֵדִי הֲחֵלֵיתָ! · תועבת האלים – דבר אסור אכלת! · מֻשְׁבָּע אַתָּה – ולא אֲבַקֶּרְךָ! · לְךָ! אדם אשר אשלח לְךָ – רעות כ[בדות? ...] · את ידך יתפוס!" ; OB "תועבת האל[ים? ...]	equivalent	ET2's II.129–130 strings	II.129–132; OBM b+15–b+16

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
Etana's prayer	יום יום – אֶתָנָה אל שַׁמַשׁ מתחנן: · "אכלת, שַׁמַשׁ, את עובי עֲשָׂיִי, · הארץ – שָׂתִית את דם אֵילַי, · את האלים כיבדתי, את האִטִּים יָרֵאתִי, · גָּמְרוּ את מַגְמָרַי – השואלות, · את אֵילַי – בטבח – האלים גָּמְרוּ. · אדוני – מפיך יֵצֵא (הדבר),	cognate (*kabātu*, *šuʾu*, *šatû*, *ṭabāḫu*, *gamāru*)		II.133–139
the plea (for ET4: III.12–14)	תנה לי את עשב הלידה! · הראני את עשב הלידה! · נסח את חרפתי, שִׂים לי שֵׁם!"; III.12 *ibrī idnam-ma šamma ša alādi* → רַעִי, תנה לי את עשב הלידה!; III.19 *lūbilakkum-ma šamma ša alādi* → אביא לך את עשב הלידה (*wabālu* = הֲבִיא, ET1)	equivalent	as §10.3 ✓, unchanged	II.140–142; MA d+4
Šamaš's mission to Etana	לך בדרך, חלוף את ההר, · רְאֵה שוחה – את קרבה בְּחַן, · בלבה מושלך נשר. · יַרְאֲךָ את עשב [הלי]דה." / למאמר שַׁמַשׁ הגיבור – · אֶתָנָה הלך, [חלף את ההר]. · ראה שוחה – את קרבה בחן. · בל[בה] מושלך [נשר]. · מיד – מגביה אותו [...]; MA "לך בדרך, חלוף את ההר, · [את הר]מות – בַּחֲצוֹתְךָ, · [הַסְתַּ]כֵּל בשוחה – אל קרבה קְרַב! · בלבה – נשר מושלך, · הוא – יתן לך את עשב הלידה."	equivalent	*ina pī šamaš qurādi* (≠ *ana zikir*): proposal מפי שַׁמַשׁ הגיבור	II.143–152; MA d+7–d+11
the dream formulas (for ET4)	ב אֶתָנָה, ובוחן: · [ב]משכב הלילה – [שָׂכַ]ב חלום ראה:	equivalent (Job 33:15, Gen 28:11)	*nâlu* שָׂכַב, *barû* בָּחַן, *mayyāl mūši* משכב הלילה, *šutta amāru* ראה חלום (ET1: *šutta šubrû* חלום הֶרְאָה)	MA d+5–d+6

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
the bargain (for ET4)	OB: "רֵעִי, נהיה ידידים – אני ואתה! · אמור לי – את אשר תשאל ממני – אֶתְנָה לְךָ!" · "את עיניי? פְּתַח – את נִסְתָּרַי!"; MA: "תה הוא אַתְנָה, מלך הבהמה! · מקר[ב [א]השו]חה – הַעֲלֵנִי! · [ל]יום נצחים – תהילתך [מן] · [...] אתך [...]" · "(אם) אַחֲיֶה ... השוחה – [אַעַלְךָ], · [עָדַי] עַד – אנ[חנו הלידה [עשב] את לך – אתן אני · "[...]!"	equivalent	אֶתְנָה always vocalized (Etana's name unvocalized)	OBM c+6–c+9; MA e+8–f+5
names and epithets	מלך הבהמה ;★ אֶתְנָה (*šar būli*); the eagle הנשר (*erû*), השואג (*nāʾeru*); שַׁמַּשׁ הגיבור; the sun הַשָּׁמָשׁ ★	–		
speech formulas	X אל ,פתח את פיו Y דיבר: (OB הנשר פתח את פיו, אל אַתְנָה דיבר: / אֶתְנָה פתח את פיו, אל הנשר דיבר: – for III.9, 11) · אֶתְנָה אליו, [אל הנשר, דיבר]: (ET1's formula) · אל אֶתְנָה – דיבר: (*ana etanā-ma izakkaršu* without *pâšu īpuš*) · אֶתְנָה – כש[מעו] את זאת, (*annīta ina šemêšu*, Gilgameš)	–		passim
the eagle's recovery	את ידו תפס – שבעה ירּ[חים?], · בירח השמיני – הֶעֱבִיר (אותו) את שוחתו. · הנשר – מקבל אָכְלָה – כאריה שואג; · כוח – היה לו.; MA [הו] [...]. · א – מנפנף [באגפיו]. ו(פעם) רביעית – [את הנשר – בש]וחה – חייו? [...]	cognate (*warḫu*, *samnu*)	the counting pattern for the MA flights (ET2: פעם אחת, שָׁנָה, שְׁלֹשׁ)	OBM c+1–c+4; MA f+10–f+15

Words (one Hebrew each; grep-checked in all corpora):

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
unnīnu; *maḫāru* Gtn; *maḫāru* "receive"	תַּחֲנוּנִים ; מִתְחַנְּנִים ; קִבֵּל	–	open decision 12	II.73, 123, 133; OBM c+3
kasû D; *šaṭāṭu*; *šubtu*; *nadû* "lay" / "throw" / stative	כְּפֵת ; שְׁסַע ; מִשְׁכָּן ; הֻנַּח / הִשְׁלִיךְ / מֻשְׁלָךְ	equivalent (Judg 14:6; Ps 10:8)		II.76–78, 86, 146
libbu (of carcass, pit); *karšu*; *qerbu*; *kutum libbi*	לֵב ; מֵעַיִם ; קֶרֶב ; מִכְסֵה הַלֵּב	cognate (*qerbu*)	deviation 1	II.77–84, 110–111, 145–151
mimmû; *iṣṣūru*; *šīru*; *nurbu*; *sādu*	כל ; צִפּוֹר ; בָּשָׂר ; רֹךְ ; מִגְרָשׁ	–		II.79, 82, 93
maṣû Št; *kašādu*; *ana ṣēr*	חָדַר ; הִגִּיעַ ; אֶל	–	open decision 2	II.83, 90, 110
kappu; *abru*; *nuballu*; *nakāsu*; *baqāmu*	כָּנָף ; אֵבֶר ; **מְנִיפָה** ; (אֶבְרוֹת) ; כָּרַת ; מָרַט	cognate (*kappu*, *abru*)		II.84–86, 119–120
šuttatu; *būrtu*; *bubūtu*; *ṣūmu*; *mūtu*	שׁוּחָה ; בּוֹר ; רְעָבוֹן ; צָמָא ; מָוֶת	equivalent / cognate (*būrtu*)		II.86–87, 120–124; MA f+7
nasāḫu; *šanû*; *izuzzu*; *še'û* Gtn	נָסַח ; שָׁנָה ; עָמַד ; מְבַקֵּשׁ	cognate		II.105–109
erēbu; *qinnu* (*qunennu*)	בָּא ; קֵן	cognate (*qinnu*)		II.84, 111–112
rêmu; *ērišu*; *nudunnû*; *nadānu* precative	רִחַם (רַחֲמֵנִי) ; חָנַן ; מַתָּן ; אָתְּנָה	cognate (*rêmu*)	open decision 5	II.114; OBM c+7
wuššuru; *šapāru*; *apālu*; *elēnu*; *šērtu*; *saḫāru*; *šakānu*	שָׁלַח ; שָׁלַח ; עָנָה ; מִלְמַעְלָה ; עֹנֶשׁ ; סָבִיב ; שָׁם	–	open decision 4	II.116–118, 125, 132
bulluṭu; *zikru* (name); *dārû*; *šemû* Š; *dārītu*; *tanattu*; *ulla* / *adi*	הֶחֱיָה ; זֵכֶר ; נָצַח ; (לִימֵי נָצַח) ; הִשְׁמִיעַ ; (יום נצחים) נָצַח ; עַד / עֲדֵי ; תְּהִלָּה	cognate (*zikru*)	עוֹלָם reserved	II.126–127; MA e+13–e+17

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
tamû stative; *sanāqu*; *amēlu*; *qāta ṣabātu*	מָשְׁבָּע ; בְּקֶר ; אָדָם ; תָּפַס יָד	–		II.131–132; OBM b+12, c+1
kubru; *šuʾu*; *aslu*; *šatû*; *dāmu*; *kabātu* D; *eṭemmu*; *palāḫu*; *gamāru*; *maššakku*; *šāʾiltu*; *ṭubbuḫu*	עֹבְי ; שֶׂה ; אַיִל ; שָׁתָה ; דָּם ; כִּבֵּד ; אֵט (אִטִּים) ; יָרֵא ; גָּמַר ; מַגְמָר ; שׁוֹאֶלֶת ; טָבַח	cognate (*šuʾu*, *šatû*, *dāmu*, *kabātu*, *gamāru*, *ṭabāḫu*)		II.134–138
bēlu; *ina pî*; *aṣû*	אָדוֹן ; מִפִּי ; יָצָא	cognate (*aṣû*)		II.139
amāru; *barû* (G, Gt); *kullumu*	רָאָה ; בָּחַן ; הֶרְאָה	–	ET1 open decisions 6–7	II.141, 145–150; MA d+5
ullânum-ma; *šaqû* Št	מִיָּד ; הִגְבִּיהַ	–		II.152
OB: *mā*; *watû*; *ašru*; *paʾāṣiš*; *šapālu* G; *lemnētu*; *kabtu*	הֵן ; מָצָא ; מָקוֹם ; **לְרִצּוּץ** ; שָׁפַל ; רָעוֹת ; כָּבֵד	cognate (*kabtu*)		OBM b+4–b+15
OB: *sebe*; *warḫu*; *samnu*; *etēqu* Š; *ukultu*; *nēšu*; *nāʾeru*; *emūqu*; *išû*	שָׂבַע ; יָרַח ; שְׁמִינִי ; הָעֶבִיר ; אָכְלָה ; אַרְיֵה ; שׁוֹאֵג ; כֹּחַ ; הָיָה לְ	cognate (*sebe*, *warḫu*, *samnu*)	open decisions 13, 18	OBM c+1–c+4; MA f+16
OB: *ibru*; *itbāru*; *qabû*; *erēšu*; *īnu*; *petû*; *katimtu*; MA *katmu*	רֵעַ ; יְדִיד ; אָמַר ; שָׁאַל ; עַיִן ; פָּתַח ; נִסְתָּר ; מְכַסֶּה	cognate (*petû*)	פָּקַח reserved	OBM c+6–c+9; MA d+3
MA: *nâlu*; *mayyālu*; *mūšu*; *šuttu*; *ḫuršānu*; *nabalkutu*; *palāsu* N; *qerēbu*	שָׁכַב ; מִשְׁכָּב ; לַיְלָה ; חֲלוֹם ; רָמָה ; חָצָה ; הִסְתַּכֵּל ; קָרַב	cognate (*qerēbu*)		MA d+5–d+9
MA: *būlu*; *šarru*; *elû* Š; *biltu*; *ṣītu*; *šalām šamši*; *šamšu*; *ezēbu*	בְּהֵמָה ; מָלַךְ ; הֶעֱלָה ; מַשָּׂא ; מוֹצָא ; שְׁקִיעַת הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ ; הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ ; עָזַב	cognate (*elû*, *ezēbu*)		MA e+8–f+4

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
MA: *pūtu* (of a pit); *malû* D; *banû*; *artu*; *balāṭu* (noun); *ṣabābu*; *agappu*; *rebû*	פְּאָה ; מְלֵא ; בָּנָה ; עֲנָפִים ; חַיִּים ; נִפְנָף ; אֲגַף ; רְבִיעִי	cognate (*malû*, *banû*)	רְחֵף kept for the apparatus (Deut 32:11)	MA f+7–f+15

Part ET4 – the flights and the dreams (SB III 1–c+7; MA g+1–i+18), 2026-10-22

Round 3, run 2 (../renderings.md §10.5). Translator: sub-agent ET4 (the last part). Files: annotated-III.rtl.md
(the whole tablet: header + all 131 entries), annotated-MA.rtl.md (one header paragraph, "חלק ET4", + g+1–i+18,
53 entries). **184 entries.** Not committed.

Progress and passes

- [x] SB III 1–56 (131 with a+, b+, c+) · [x] MA g+1–i+18 (53) · [x] the III header (all paragraphs) · [x] the MA paragraph
- [x] pass (a) fidelity · [x] pass (b) consistency · [x] pass (c) Hebrew
- [x] python3 -I kings_tools.py verify ET --strict – **585 entries, OK** (no problem, no note: the "same
  transliteration, different Hebrew" notes of the first run were removed by unifying the punctuation of the repeated
  commands and executions)
- [x] python3 -I ../tools/check_bible_quotes.py annotated-III.rtl.md annotated-MA.rtl.md project--ET4.md – 0 problems
- **Order of work:** SB III first (it fixes the Hebrew of the flights, the drops and the dream), section by section,
  each saved at once (1–25, 26–56, a+, b+1–b+16, b+17–c+7); then MA g–i, copying the SB Hebrew wherever the Akkadian is
  the same (i+3 = b+30, i+4 = III.38, i+5 = b+26, i+6/i+13 = b+27, i+7 = b+28) and varying only where it varies.

- **Data:** `kings_tools.py data ET III.1 III.c+7` and `… MA.g+1 MA.i+18`; eBL dictionary per word (buginnu, tarbaṣu,
  kappu, ṣâdu, atwû, tarāku, raṣānu, galātu, maḫāru, nikkas, elpetu, qurunnu, zāʾeru, kanšu, markasu, elītu, wapû,
  sakāpu, ēdēnu, šāninu, tēqītu, bāšītu); every Akkadian precedent looked up in the transliteration lines of all
  corpora (a scratch helper that greps the backticked lines and prints their Hebrew), every new Hebrew word with
  `kings_tools.py grep all`. Every Bible verse printed with `check_bible_quotes.py --show` before quoting.
- **Pass (a) fidelity:** every `>` line against N and the ATF of its manuscripts. Fixed: III.7 bracket split (`הגי]בור`
  tripped the `בור` gate → `[…הגיב]ור`); III.b+14 `ונבהלתי` unbracketed (NinNA3 *ap-ta-ru-u[d*: only the last sign
  broken); MA i+4 `[אותו] העלה` (only the suffix broken); the speech boundaries checked (III.2–6 the eagle to Šamaš;
  12–17 Etana; 18–19 the eagle, without a speech formula, as Foster; 23–27, 31–33, 35–37, 39 the eagle; 40–43 Etana;
  a+6–a+8 the wife?; b+3–b+14 Etana's dream; b+16–b+20, b+27–b+30, b+33–b+34, b+37–b+38 the eagle; MA h+6–h+12 and
  h+22 the interpreter; h+14–h+19 Etana; i+2–i+3 and i+9–i+10 Etana; i+6–i+7, i+13 the eagle); stems and tenses
  re-parsed (*ullû* D vs *šušqû*; *ittūr* perfect; *imtaḫaršu* perfect; *luttallak* Gtn precative; *ṣâdu* with a
  doubled ṣ; *līmida* = *lū* + preterite or precative; *ušamḫir* Š; *ikannušū* present).
- **Pass (b) consistency:** command ↔ execution (III.26–29; b+18–b+23), dream ↔ fulfilment (b+3–b+8 ↔ b+40–b+45),
  the three leagues of both flights and the four drops compared word by word and in order; the plea III.12–14 = II.140–
  142 = MA d+4; the speech formulas (✓ FORMULAS) and ET1's `דיבר Y, אליו אל X:` (b+15, b+26, b+32, b+36; MA i+1, i+5,
  i+8, i+12; with *iqabbi* `אומר`, h+13); the names vocalized at every occurrence (`אֲנוּ`, `שַׁמַּשׁ`, `אֲתָנָה`, `סִין`,
  `בֵּרוּ`, `רֵעִי`, `אִשְׁתַּר`). Collisions found by grep and resolved: `מִשְׁחָה` (Gilgameš XI *piššatu*) → *tēqītu* `הֵבִין`; `סִיכָה` (Enūma eliš *ḫasāsu*) → *maḫāru* Š `הִקְבִּיל`; `כְּלָלוּת` (Enūma eliš *gimru*) → *kiššatu* `כַּף`; `כֹּל` (*rittu*, Gilgameš, Ludlul) → Etana's *kappu* stays `צַד`; `כָּנָף` (*idu*) → *ina lēt* `אֵצֶל`; `רָעַד` (Gilgameš *râbu*) → *galātu* `הָדַף`; `הִתְפַּלֵּץ` (Ludlul *duppuru*) → *sakāpu* `הוֹמָה`; `דָּחַף` (OBM.6 *apâtu*) → *ḫabābu* `צָבַר`; `פָּכָה` (Gilgameš *tabāku*) → *qarānu* `עָרַם`. Remaining splits: open decisions 1–5.

- **Pass (c) Hebrew:** read aloud; vocalized what would be misread: בֵּרוּ (every time: unvocalized "they chose"),
  צָד (vs צַד), חָזִי, שׂוּמָה / שָׂם / שִׂים (not "see!"), עָרְמוּ, לְבָאִים, מַנָּח, עֵינַי, (not "naked"), הַיֵּשׁ, לְרַגְלָי / לְרַגְלַיִךְ, הִסְתַּכַּלְתִּי, אָתְהַלְּכָה, אֶבְיאָה לָךְ, אֶשָּׁאֲךְ, שׁקֶת, מַרְבֵּץ, כְּמוֹ מָה הִיא, כְּמָלֹא, מוּפָעִים, סִיכָה, לְאוֹת, גַּנָּ[ן]; the punctuation of the repeated lines unified (all commands !, all executions .).

Deviations from renderings §10 and the briefs (decided at the first occurrence, with the reason)

1. **The flight's question is not *ibrī amur māta mīnâ ibašši*** (renderings §10.3 and the brief quote the literature):
   the tablet has *ibrī naplis-(ma) mātu kī mīni ibašši* in the first flight (31, 35, 39) and *dugul ibrī mātu kī*
   ibašši in the second (b+27, b+33, b+37; MA i+6, i+13) – two verbs, two word orders, *mīni* only in the first. So two
   strings: רֵעִי, הִסְתַּכֵּל – הארץ, כְּמוֹ מָה הִיא! (*palāsu* N = הִסְתַּכֵּל, ET2) and צְפֵה, רֵעִי – הארץ, איך היא! (*dagālu* = צְפֵה, Gilgameš IX 174, Adapa, Theodicy). §10.3's row should be corrected.
2. ***bēru* + three verbs**: *ištēn / šanâ / šalša bēra* + *ullû* (*elû* D) in the first flight and MA = העלה אותו
   (the root of *elû* kept, as Š הָעֶלָה, MA e+10); *šušqû* (*šaqû* D) in the second = (10.3§) הגביה אותו; *nasāku* in the drops = זרק אותו (Gilgameš XI 293 *issukaššu* הִשְׁלִיךְ; זרקו is *nadû*'s).
3. ***târu ana* "turn into" = נָהְפַּךְ לְ־** (Gilgameš XI 119, IV 106; Ludlul I 18, 84), not שָׁב (licensed by *târu*, but in Hebrew "return").
4. ***kappu* of Etana = כָּנָף** (III.27, b+19), literal, against Foster's "hands": כַּף is *rittu* (Gilgameš VII 170,
   Ludlul V 12); the one Akkadian word for the eagle's wings and the man's "hands" is kept and footnoted.
5. ***ina lēt* = אֵצֶל** (III.25), not צַד (Gilgameš IX 6 *ana lēt* אל צד), because §10.3 gives צַד to *idu* (III.26, b+28); *lētu* as a noun stays לְחִי.
6. ***ṣīt šamši / ereb šamši*:** the coordinator's מְבוֹא הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ / מִזְרַח שֶׁמֶשׁ were not used – neither phrase
   is in my lines (only *ṣītu* "outlet", III.16, a+8 = מוֹצָא, as ET3's MA f+2–f+3 מוֹצָא הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ), and מָבוֹא is
   nērebu (ET2).
7. ***palgu* = תְּעָלָה** (§10.3; = Sum. pa_5, Enki and the World Order 324) kept, although Enūma eliš VII 63 has the
   cognate פֶּלֶג (open decision 1); the cognate is tagged in MA i+10.
8. ***mūšaru* = עֲרוּגָה, *kirû* גַּן**: *kirû* does not occur in my lines (the "garden" of Foster's MA i+9 is *mūšaru*), so גַּן was not used at all; *nukaribbu* = גִּנָּן (b+38).

9. **III.32's restored half-line is not translated** (`[… ?מָפַכְ]ים`): eBL's *nārātu? kī? palgî?* is Foster's oral
   suggestion with three question marks, and Haul restores something else entirely.

Parallels index (ET4)

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
III.3	at[m]ī iṣṣūrī	שִׂי[ח]ת הציפורים	כִּי עוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם יוֹלִיךְ אֶת הַקּוֹל (קהלת י:כ)	equivalent	The bird that carries speech; here Šamaš lets Etana understand the birds (only SB has this).
III.3	at[m]ī iṣṣūrī	שִׂי[ח]ת הציפורים	וַיְדַבֵּר עַל הַבְּהֵמָה וְעַל הָעוֹף וְעַל הָרָמֶשׂ וְעַל הַדָּגִים (מלכים א ה:יג)	divergence	A king's knowledge of birds: Solomon's own wisdom; Etana's is a god's gift at the eagle's request.
III.7	ina pī šamaš qurādi	מפי שַׁמַשׁ הגיב[ור ...]	עַל פִּי יְהוָה יִסְעוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל (במדבר ט:יח)	equivalent	"By the mouth (command) of" the god; *ina pī*, not *ana zikir* (למאמר).
III.12	ibrī idnam-ma šamma ša alādi	רֵעִי, תנה לי את [ע]שב הלידה!	הָבָה לִי בָנִים (בראשית ל:א)	equivalent	The plea of II.140–142, now to the eagle, with "my friend".
III.14	piltī usuḫ-ma šuma šuknanni	נ[סח] את חרפתי, שִׂים [שֵׁ]ם לי!	אָסַף אֱלֹהִים אֶת חֶרְפָּתִי (בראשית ל:כג)	equivalent	= II.142, MA d+4; *šumu* = name and offspring.
III.24	itti ištar bēlti	עם אִשְׁתַּר הגבירה	וַיִּזְכֹּר אֱלֹהִים אֶת רָחֵל ... וַיִּפְתַּח אֶת רַחְמָהּ (בראשית ל:כב)	divergence	The plant of birth is "with Ištar the lady": the way to birth goes through the goddess of love and kingship.
III.26	ina muhhi idīya šukun idīka	על צדיי – [שִׂים את זרועותיך!	יִפְרֹשׂ כְּנָפָיו יִקָּחֵהוּ יִשָּׂאֵהוּ עַל אֶבְרָתוֹ (דברים לב:יא)	equivalent	The eagle that carries on its wings; here practical instructions to the rider (and Akkad-period seals).

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
III.27	nāṣ kappīya	על נוצת כנפיי	הַנֶּשֶׁר הַגָּדוֹל גְּדוֹל הַכְּנָפַיִם אֶרֶךְ הָאֵבֶר מָלֵא הַנּוֹצָה (יחזקאל יז:ג)	cognate	*nāṣu* / נוֹצָה; Ezekiel's three wing words have their Akkadian counterparts in the fable: *kappu*, *abru*, *nāṣu*.
III.30	ištēn bēra ullīšū-ma	– בֵּרוּ אחד [העלה אותו]	דֶּרֶךְ הַנֶּשֶׁר בַּשָּׁמַיִם (משלי ל:יט)	equivalent	The eagle's way in the sky, here measured in double-hours (*bēru*, c. 10 km).
III.31	ibrī naplis mātu kī mīni ibašši	רֵעִי, הִסְתַּכֵּל – הארץ, כְּ[מוֹ מָה הִיא]!	הַיֹּשֵׁב עַל חוּג הָאָרֶץ וְיֹשְׁבֶיהָ כַּחֲגָבִים (ישעיהו מ:כב)	equivalent	The earth seen from above, shrinking; perhaps the oldest such description.
III.32	iḫambubā	[... ?]מְפַכְּ	וְהִנֵּה מַיִם מְפַכִּים (יחזקאל מז:ב)	equivalent	Water trickling thinly; the restored "rivers like canals" left untranslated.
III.33	tâmtu rapaštu mala tarbaṣi	– והים הרחב כְּמִלֹּא מַרְבֵּץ	וְאֶת בְּנֵי עַמּוֹן לְמִרְבַּץ צֹאן (יחזקאל כה:ה); אֵיךְ הָיְתָה לְשַׁמָּה מַרְבֵּץ לַחַיָּה (צפניה ב:טו)	cognate	*tarbaṣu* / מַרְבֵּץ (LH's *tarbaṣum*), *mala* / מְלֹא: the sea, end of the world, the size of a sheepfold.
III.36	ittūr mātu ana musarî	נֶהְפְּכָה הארץ לַעֲרוּגָה	דּוֹדִי יָרַד לְגַנּוֹ לַעֲרֻגוֹת הַבֹּשֶׂם (שיר השירים ו:ב); לְהַשְׁקוֹת אוֹתָהּ מֵעֲרֻגוֹת מַטָּעָהּ (יחזקאל יז:ז)	equivalent	Our proposal: Ezekiel's eagle parable (eagle, poplar צַפְצָפָה, oath, net) also has "garden beds".

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
III.41	ul išebbâ īnāya	לא תִשְׂבַּעְנָה עֵינַי	לֹא תִשְׂבַּע עַיִן לִרְאוֹת (קהלת א:ח)	cognate	*šebû* / שָׂבַע; the meaning diverges: Qohelet's eye is never sated because there is always more; Etana's because there is nothing left to see.
III.42	ibrī ul elli ana šamê	רֵעִי, לא אָעֱלֶה לשמים!	הַשָּׁמַיִם אָעֱלֶה (ישעיהו יד:יג)	divergence	The proud eagle said אָעֱלֶה – ובשמים אַשִּׁב (II.43); the frightened king says "I will not go up", with the same verb.
III.42	ibrī ul elli ana šamê	רֵעִי, לא אָעֱלֶה לשמים!	וּמִגְדָּל וְרֹאשׁוֹ בַּשָּׁמָיִם (בראשית יא:ד)	divergence	Going up to heaven is no rebellion here: Šamaš directs it, Ištar is its goal, and nobody is punished.
III.42	ibrī ul elli ana šamê	רֵעִי, לא אָעֱלֶה לשמים!	אִם אֶסַּק שָׁמַיִם שָׁם אָתָּה (תהלים קלט:ח)	equivalent	Heaven as the limit of a human ascent (with אֶשָּׂא כַנְפֵי-שָׁחַר, 139:9).
III.45	erû imqut-ma imtaḫaršu ina kappīšu	הנשר נפל – וקיבל אותו בכנפיו.	יִפְרֹשׂ כְּנָפָיו יִקָּחֵהוּ יִשָּׂאֵהוּ עַל אֶבְרָתוֹ (דברים לב:יא)	equivalent	The eagle catches the falling Etana on its wings – four times (45, 47, 49, 51). In Deuteronomy the eagle is God.
III.45	erû imqut-ma	הנשר נפל	אֵיךְ נָפַלְתָּ מִשָּׁמַיִם הֵילֵל בֶּן שָׁחַר (ישעיהו יד:יב)	divergence	The "fall" is the eagle's own dive, to catch, not a fall from heaven.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
III.a+4	ikšud-ma ālšu u bīssu	הגיע אל עירו ואל ביתו.	וַיָּשֻׁבוּ וַיָּבֹאוּ אֶל בֵּיתָם הָרָמָתָה; וַיֵּדַע אֶלְקָנָה אֶת חַנָּה אִשְׁתּוֹ (שמואל א א:יט)	equivalent	Our proposal: after the prayer, the return home to the wife (if NinNA1 belongs here).
III.a+9	ana bašāli	לְבַשֵּׁל	וַתֹּאמֶר אֵלַי תָּבוֹא כִּי שָׂכֹר שְׂכַרְתִּיךְ בְּדוּדָאֵי בְּנִי (בראשית ל:טז)	divergence	The wife and the plant: Leah's mandrakes (דּוּדָאִים reserved) vs a plant (or a salve, a+7) cooked at home.
III.a+15	nīš ilī	?חַיֵּי האלים?	וְאוּלָם חַי יְהוָה וְחֵי נַפְשֶׁךָ (שמואל א כ:ג)	equivalent	The oath "by the life of" the gods (*nīšu* = חַיִּים, ET2).
III.a+18	ipaššar	יִפְשֹׁר	וּמִי יוֹדֵעַ פֶּשֶׁר דָּבָר (קהלת ח:א); חָלוֹם חָלַמְנוּ וּפֹתֵר אֵין אֹתוֹ (בראשית מ:ח)	cognate	*pašāru* / פֶּשֶׁר; Genesis uses another root, פָּתַר (reserved).
III.b+3	qereb bāb āni enlil u ea nibāʾa	בְּקֶרֶב? שער אָנוּ, אֶנְלִי[ל – וְ]אֵ[אָה] צעדנו;	אֵין זֶה כִּי אִם בֵּית אֱלֹהִים וְזֶה שַׁעַר הַשָּׁמָיִם (בראשית כח:יז)	equivalent	The gate of heaven seen in a dream; in Etana the dreamer passes through the gates in the order of the gods' rank.
III.b+3	qereb bāb āni … nibāʾa	בְּקֶרֶב? שער אָנוּ … – צעדנו;	וְהִנֵּה סֻלָּם מֻצָּב אַרְצָה וְרֹאשׁוֹ מַגִּיעַ הַשָּׁמָיְמָה (בראשית כח:יב)	divergence	Jacob sees the way between earth and heaven used by others; Etana goes up himself (סֻלָּם reserved).
III.b+4	nuškēna itti aḫāmiš	השתחווינו [זה עם זה]	וָאֶרְאֶה וָאֶפֹּל עַל פָּנַי (יחזקאל א:כח)	equivalent	Prostration before the gods of heaven, as at a royal audience.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
III.b+5	qereb bāb sîn šamaš adad u ištar	בְּקֶרֶב? שער סִין, שַׁמַּשׁ, אֲדַד וְאִשְׁתַּר	וְהִנֵּה הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ וְהַיָּרֵחַ וְאַחַד עָשָׂר כּוֹכָבִים מִשְׁתַּחֲוִים לִי (בראשית לז:ט)	divergence	Joseph's sun, moon and stars bow to the dreamer; Etana bows to the gods of the moon, the sun and Venus.
III.b+11	kussû nadât-ma ištar	כִּסֵּא מֻנָּח – וְאִשְׁתַּר ...	וָאֶרְאֶה אֶת אֲדֹנָי יֹשֵׁב עַל כִּסֵּא רָם וְנִשָּׂא (ישעיהו ו:א); דְּמוּת כִּסֵּא (יחזקאל א:כו)	equivalent	The throne in a vision of heaven, and the figure on it: here a goddess, "a young woman, beautiful of face" (Ludlul III 31's formula).
III.b+12	ina šapal kussî lābū	תחת הכסא לְבָ[אִים?] – [...	וּשְׁנַיִם אֲרָיוֹת עֹמְדִים אֵצֶל הַיָּדוֹת (מלכים א י:יט)	equivalent	A throne with lions: Ištar's animal; Solomon's throne (with 10:20).
III.b+12	lābu	לְבָ[אִים?]	כָּרַע רָבַץ כְּאַרְיֵה וּכְלָבִיא (בראשית מט:ט)	cognate	*lābu* / לָבִיא (Gilgameš II 238 לבאים).
III.b+14	aggaltâm-ma aptarud	הִתְפַּלַּצְתִּי – ונבהלתי	וַיִּיקַץ יַעֲקֹב מִשְּׁנָתוֹ ... וַיִּירָא וַיֹּאמַר מַה נּוֹרָא הַמָּקוֹם הַזֶּה (בראשית כח:טז–יז); וַתִּפָּעֶם רוּחוֹ (בראשית מא:ח)	equivalent	Waking in terror from a dream of the gods (also Dan 2:1; Gudea A xii 13).

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
III.b+16	ibrī šūpâ šunātūka	רֵעִי, מוּפָעִים חלו[מותיך]!	חֲלוֹם פַּרְעֹה אֶחָד הוּא: אֵת אֲשֶׁר הָאֱלֹהִים עֹשֶׂה הִגִּיד לְפַרְעֹה (בראשית מא:כה)	divergence	The interpreter declares the meaning plain; but Joseph's interpretation is "God's" (Gen 40:8), the eagle's a friend's.
III.b+17	alka luššīkā-ma ana šamê	לְכָה, אֶשָּׂאֲךָ לִשְׁמֵי? [אָנוּ?]!	וְאֶשָּׂא אֶתְכֶם עַל כַּנְפֵי נְשָׁרִים וָאָבֵא אֶתְכֶם אֵלָי (שמות יט:ד)	cognate	*našû* / נָשָׂא, the same cohortative-like form (*luššīka* / וְאֶשָּׂא): God carries his people to himself on eagles' wings; here the eagle carries a man to the gods.
III.b+25	ištēn bēra ušaqqīšū-ma	בֵּרוּ אחד – הגביה אותו	אִם תַּגְבִּיהַ כַּנָּשֶׁר וְאִם בֵּין כּוֹכָבִים שִׂים קִנֶּךָ מִשָּׁם אוֹרִידֶךָ (עובדיה א:ד); אִם-עַל-פִּיךָ יַגְבִּיהַ נָשֶׁר (איוב לט:כז)	equivalent	*šaqû* D = הִגְבִּיהַ with the eagle (also Jer 49:16); in Obadiah the height is pride and ends in a fall – Etana's end is lost.
III.b+39	ištu elû ana šamê ša āni	אחרי שעלו לִשְׁמֵי אָ[נוּ]	וַיַּעַל אֵלִיָּהוּ בַּסְּעָרָה הַשָּׁמָיִם (מלכים ב ב:יא)	equivalent	A man goes up to heaven in his body; Elijah does not come back, Etana does (and dies: Gilgameš VII).
III.b+39	ištu elû ana šamê ša āni	אחרי שעלו לִשְׁמֵי אָ[נוּ]	וּמִגְדָּל וְרֹאשׁוֹ בַּשָּׁמַיִם (בראשית יא:ד)	divergence	The heaven of Anu is reached with divine help, for a son – not by building, for a name.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
III.b+40	ina bāb āni enlil u ea ibā’ū	בשער אָנוּ, אֶנְלִיל וְאֵאָה צעדו –;	וַיְהִי כַּאֲשֶׁר פָּתַר לָנוּ כֵּן הָיָה (בראשית מא:יג)	equivalent	The dream is fulfilled in its own words (b+3–b+8 ↔ b+40–b+45).
III.c+7	šāninšu	מתחרהו	וַיִּתְהַלֵּךְ חֲנוֹךְ אֶת הָאֱלֹהִים; וְאֵינֶנּוּ כִּי לָקַח אֹתוֹ אֱלֹהִים (בראשית ה:כד)	divergence	The end is lost; Enoch and Elijah are taken and do not return; Etana went up on a mission, came back, had (per the King List) a son, and sits among the dead (Gilgameš VII 202).
MA.g+8	bāšītu	הַיֵּשׁ	לְהַנְחִיל אֹהֲבַי יֵשׁ (משלי ח:כא)	equivalent	"What there is" = property, from *bašû* "to be", as יֵשׁ.
MA.g+11	ana itti	לְאוֹת	וְזֶה לְךָ הָאוֹת כִּי אָנֹכִי שֹׁלֵחַתִּיךְ (שמות ג:יב)	cognate	*ittu* / אוֹת; a sign, beside a "gate" (broken context).
MA.h+4	[erû šutta] ušamḫir	[הנשר – את החלום] *הִקְבִּיל*	גַּבְרִיאֵל הָבֵן לְהַלָּז אֶת הַמַּרְאֶה (דניאל ח:טז)	equivalent	If Foster's "made understand" is right: the eagle as the dream's explainer. Literally Š of "receive, face".
MA.h+6	šuttaka damqat	[ח]– לומך טוב	וַיַּרְא שַׂר הָאֹפִים כִּי טוֹב פָּתָר (בראשית מ:טז)	equivalent	A "good dream" (*šuttu damiqtu*), a category of Babylonian dream lore; טוֹב licensed by *damqu*.
MA.h+10	taṣabbat … ina qātīka	תתפוס [...] בידך ...	הֲמָלֹךְ תִּמְלֹךְ עָלֵינוּ אִם מָשׁוֹל תִּמְשֹׁל בָּנוּ (בראשית לז:ח)	equivalent	A dream interpreted as rule over others (Haul: "their lead-rope in your hand").

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
MA.h+12	… ina šēpīka	… לְרַגְלֶיךָ	עַד-אָשִׁית אֹיְבֶיךָ הֲדֹם לְרַגְלֶיךָ (תהלים קי:א)	equivalent	The interpretation turns the dream's "at my feet" (h+3) into "at your feet": rule.
MA.h+14	ibrī aṭṭul šanīta šutta	רֵעִי, ראיתי חלום שני:	וַיֵּחָלֵם עוֹד חֲלוֹם אַחֵר וַיְסַפֵּר אֹתוֹ לְאֶחָיו (בראשית לז:ט); וְעַל הִשָּׁנוֹת הַחֲלוֹם אֶל פַּרְעֹה פַּעֲמָיִם כִּי נָכוֹן הַדָּבָר (בראשית מא:לב)	equivalent	The second dream confirms the first (only MA has two dreams).
MA.h+15	paḫrat elpetu ina bīti	נִקְבְּצָה חַלְפָּה בבית	וְהִנֵּה אֲנַחְנוּ מְאַלְּמִים אֲלֻמִּים בְּתוֹךְ הַשָּׂדֶה (בראשית לז:ז)	equivalent	A dream of gathered plants that means kingship – the closest parallel to Joseph's sheaves (with h+16–h+19).
MA.h+16	kī qurunni iqrunū bilāti	כַּעֲרֵמָה עָרְמוּ משאות	וַיִּצְבֹּר יוֹסֵף בָּר כְּחוֹל הַיָּם הַרְבֵּה מְאֹד (בראשית מא:מט)	equivalent	Heaps of produce/tribute in the whole land.
MA.h+17	zârūšunu ṣerrū lemnūtu	שונאיהם – נחשים רעים	לְפָנָיו יִכְרְעוּ צָרָיו; וְאֹיְבָיו עָפָר יְלַחֵכוּ (תהלים עב:ט); יְלַחֲכוּ עָפָר כַּנָּחָשׁ (מיכה ז:יז)	equivalent	Enemies as serpents submitting to the king; in the fable's own terms, the serpent now bows.

Line	Source	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
MA.h+19	kanša ikannušū ana šapluʾa	כְּנוּעִים – כורעים תחתיי	וְהִנֵּה תְסַבֶּינָה אֲלֻמֹּתֵיכֶם וַתִּשְׁתַּחֲוֶיןָ לַאֲלֻמָּתִי (בראשית לז:ז)	equivalent	Things and enemies bow beneath the dreamer – the reverse of the SB dream, where the dreamer bows (III b+4).
MA.i+10	kī mê palgim-ma	[כ]מי פלג	כְּעֵץ שָׁתוּל עַל-פַּלְגֵי-מָיִם (תהלים א:ג)	cognate	*palgu* / פֶּלֶג; rendered פֶּלֶג since the 2026-10-23 harmonization (was תְּעָלָה, which hid the cognate).

Key findings

The Bible.

1. **Deuteronomy 32:11 and Exodus 19:4 told as a story.** What the Bible uses as an image of God – the eagle that
   spreads its wings, takes up, carries on its pinion – is here a narrative in three movements: the eagle tells the man
   how to hold on (III.26–29; b+18–b+23), lifts him league after league, and, when he falls, dives and catches him on
   its wings four times (III.44–51 הנשר נפל – וקיבל אותו בכנפיו). The verb is the very cognate: *luššīka*
   "let me carry you" (b+17) = וָאֶשָּׂא אֶתְכֶם עַל כַּנְפֵי נְשָׁרִים (Exod 19:4) – but there God carries his people to
   himself, here an eagle carries a man to the gods.
2. **Isaiah 14 and Obadiah reversed.** ET2 and ET3 found Isa 14:13–15 in the eagle's boast and fall (II.43, II.146);
   now the eagle lifts (*šaqû* D = הִגְבִּיהַ, b+25; cf. Obad 1:4, Jer 49:16, Job 39:27) and the man says, with the
   same verb as the boast, "I will not go up to heaven" (III.42 ↔ II.43). The ascent in Etana is no hubris: Šamaš sends
   it, Ištar is its goal, a son its purpose. Against Gen 11:4 (וְרֹאשׁוֹ בַּשָּׁמַיִם ... וְנַעֲשֶׂה לָּנוּ שֵׁם) this is the clearest [divergence] of the corpus: a "name" (*šumu*) asked of the gods, not made against them.

3. **Genesis 28 and 37–41 in two versions of one dream.** SB: Etana dreams that he and the eagle pass through the gates
of Anu, Enlil, Ea, then of Sîn, Šamaš, Adad and Ištar, bowing at each, open a sealed house and see Ištar enthroned
with lions; he wakes in terror (Gen 28:12–17 וַיִּירָא … וַיִּיקַץ , שַׁעַר הַשָּׁמָיִם); the friend says the dreams are
plain; and the dream is fulfilled in its own words (b+40–b+45; Gen 41:13). The dreamer bows to the sun, moon and
Venus gods – the exact reverse of Joseph's second dream (Gen 37:9). MA: two dreams instead, of kingship and plenty –
plants gathered, heaps of loads in all the land, enemies "evil serpents" bowing beneath the dreamer – interpreted
as "good" and "at your feet" (h+2–h+22): Joseph's sheaves (37:7), the doubled dream (37:9, 41:32), Joseph's heaps
(41:49), the royal psalms (Ps 72:9, 110:1). The two versions show the same plot carrying two dream types: an
ascent-vision and a kingship-dream.
4. **Throne visions.** Ištar on a throne with lions under it (b+11–b+12) meets 1 Kgs 10:19–20 (the lion throne) and
Isa 6:1 / Ezek 1:26 (the throne seen in heaven); the dreamer's prostration, Ezek 1:28.
5. **The earth from above** (III.31–41, b+27–b+38): Isa 40:22 וַיִּשְׁבָּיהָ כַּחֲגָבִים; the vocabulary of the view is
agricultural – מַרְבֵּץ (*tarbaṣu* [cognate], Ezek 25:5, Zeph 2:15), עֲרוּגָה (*mūšaru*), תִּעָלָה , שׂוֹקֶת, a gardener's dike. (Our proposal:) Ezekiel's eagle parable, which ET2 found in the poplar and the oath, also has the
garden "beds" (עֲרֻגוֹת, Ezek 17:7, 10) and the wing words (17:3) נוֹצָה / אֵבֶר / כָּנָף = *kappu* / *abru* /
nāṣu: Ezek 17 is the closest biblical counterpart of the whole Etana imagery.
6. **Hannah and Leah.** If NinNA1 belongs to Tablet III, Etana "reached his city and his house" and a woman speaks to
him about the plant of birth, a salve(?), cooking (a+4–a+9): the return home after the prayer (1 Sam 1:19) and the
plant passed between wife and husband (Gen 30:14–16; דּוּדָאִים reserved).
7. **False echoes avoided:** Foster's "sacred bond" (*ellu* "pure", MA h+2), "made understand" (*maḫāru* Š),
"hands" (*kappu* "wings"), "wearing a tiara" (*ruṣṣunat*, of a powerful voice), "garden" (*mūšaru* "bed"), "brook /
watery" (the obscure *mēmē*), "rivers … like brooks" (a restoration); סֶלָּם , רָקִיעַ , פָּתַר , מִגְדֹּל kept out
of the Hebrew lines; *pašāru* = פָּשַׁר.

The ancient mind.

1. **The eagle as a royal vehicle.** Akkad-period cylinder seals (24th–22nd centuries BCE) show a man carried up on an
   eagle's back while shepherds and dogs look up: the story is a millennium and a half older than the Nineveh tablets.
2. **The world seen by an irrigation farmer.** From above, the land becomes a garden bed, the sea a sheepfold, a
   trough, the water of a canal, a gardener's dike; the rivers trickle. The ancient imagination measured height in
   double-hours of walking (*bēru*) and the last drop in half-reeds (III.50).
3. **Fear and failure without blame.** At the third league the king who wanted heaven cannot see the land and asks to
   be put down on a path and walk to his city; the eagle does not argue, but lowers him in four drops, catching him
   each time. The first flight fails; the second, after a dream, succeeds.
4. **Dreams as the gods' language, read by a friend.** Not a professional interpreter but the eagle says "your dreams
   are plain" (SB) or "your dream is good" (MA); the "good dream" is a category of Babylonian dream lore; the dreamer
   wakes trembling (as Gudea did); the dream is fulfilled to the letter.
5. **The court of heaven.** The gates follow the gods' rank: the great triad (Anu, Enlil, Ea), then the astral gods
   (Sîn, Šamaš, Ištar) and Adad; at each gate one bows, as at a king's audience; at the end, a sealed storehouse
   (sealings with cylinder seals), a door pushed open, and the goddess enthroned with her lions.
6. **Ištar, giver of birth and of kingship.** The plant is "with Ištar the lady" (III.24): the goddess who sought a
   shepherd for Kiš (I.19–22) holds the means of an heir; the gardener of b+38 belongs to her world (Išullānu,
   Sargon).
7. **Understanding the birds.** SB adds what the older versions take for granted: man and eagle need Šamaš's gift to
   understand each other (III.3–8) – the speech of birds as a divine favour.
8. **The kingship-dream in MA**: the "pure bond above" (*markasu*, the cosmic bond of heaven and earth, cf. Dur-an-ki),
   tribute heaped up, the enemies as "evil serpents" bowing – the fable's serpent turned into the vanquished foe of a
   king.

9. **The lost end.** The Sumerian King List names Etana's son Balīḫ as his successor; Gilgameš VII sees Etana among the
   dead: tradition knew both the son and the death.

Open decisions (numbered; the minor ones decided)

1. ***palgu* = תְּעָלָה** (renderings §10.3; Enki and the World Order's *pa₅*) vs **פֶּלֶג [cognate]** (Enūma eliš
   VII 63; Ps 1:3 פַּלְגֵי מָיִם): the Hebrew cognate is hidden here (guidelines §6.4: among equally good renderings
   prefer the cognate). Proposal for the lead: *palgu* = פֶּלֶג everywhere (MA i+10 would read [כ]מי פלג), Sum. *pa₅*
   following it. **Settled 2026-10-23** (../../harmonization--2026-10-23.md row 7): *palgu* = פֶּלֶג; Sum. *pa₅* keeps תְּעָלָה.
2. ***buginnu* = שִׁקֻּת** (= Sum. *buniĝ*, Gudea B xvii 8 שוקתות) collides with Gilgameš I's *mašqû* שוקת. Proposal:
   mašqû "watering place" = מַשְׁקֶה [cognate] in Gilgameš, שִׁקֻּת left to *buginnu* / *buniĝ* (lead).
3. ***galātu* = הִתְפַּלֵּץ** (III b+14), *parādu* = נִבְהַל (Ludlul I 54); but Gudea's Sumerian *ḫuluḫ* (= *galātu*)
   is נבהל (A xii 13). The Sumerian rule ("a Sumerian word takes the Hebrew of its Akkadian equivalent") would give
   ḫuluḫ התפלץ; minor (lead).
4. ***qarānu* / *qurunnu* = עָרְמָה / עָרַם** (MA h+16) beside EA's Sum. *dub* ערם (= Akk. *šapāku* / *tabāku*,
   Gilgameš XI *tabāku* צבר): an older split; minor.
5. ***īku* = סוֹלְלָה** (b+38; Enūma eliš, EWO *eg₂*): kept for consistency, although the image here is the ditch; the
   note explains. Decided.
6. ***kappu* of Etana = כָּנָף** (literal; footnote), not כַּף (*rittu*). Decided (deviation 4).
7. ***maḫāru* Š (*šutta ušamḫir*) = הִקְבִּיל** (italic; G קִבֵּל), Foster's "made understand" in the apparatus;
   the subject "the eagle" is eBL's restoration. Decided.
8. ***mēmē(-ma)* = מים** (a+19, b+30, b+34, MA i+3; italic): eBL rejects NABU 2012/21's *mê palgi*. Decided.
9. ***ṣâdu* = צָד [cognate]** (III.21; ET2 reserved צָד for it), vocalized against צַד (*idu*). Decided.
10. **NinNA1 (a+1–a+23)** follows eBL's placement in Tablet III; the notes say "if it belongs here". Decided.
11. **Speech boundaries in III.12–19** (Etana 12–17, the eagle 18–19 without a speech formula) follow Foster. Decided.
12. ***tēqītu* = סִיכָה** (a+7; vocalized: EWO's סיכה "pin" is *kirid*); *tarāku* = **הוֹלֶם** (III.52; EA's הולם "befitting" is Sum. *tum₂*, another word): homographs, minor.

13. **III.32's restoration** left untranslated (deviation 9). Decided.
14. ***bēru*** `בֵּרוּ` vocalized at every occurrence (unvocalized "they chose"); the lead may add it to TRAPS.
15. **renderings §10.3, the flights row:** *ibrī amur māta mīnâ ibašši* is not on the tablet (deviation 1); and
    §10.3's *agappu* / *gappu*, *nāṣu*, *ṣīt/ereb šamši* rows: only *nāṣu* and *agappu* occur in ET4 (coordinator).

Proposals for the corpus renderings

Fixed strings (exactly as written; brackets, `?` and the final punctuation follow each copy):

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
X *pâšu īpušam-ma ana* Y *bēlīšu amāta izakkar*	הנשר פתח את פיו, אל שַׁמַּשׁ, אדוניו דבר דיבר –:	–	§10.3 formula with *amāta*	III.1
the plea to the eagle	רָעִי, תנה לי את עשב הלידה! · "הראני את עשב הלידה! · נסח את חרפתי, שִׂים לי שֵׁם!	equivalent	= II.140–142 + *ibrī*	III.12–14
the eagle's promise	די – … [...] ההר, · אָבִיאָה לְךָ [לב]"את עשב ה]לידה!	–	*wabālu* precative = אָבִיאָה	III.18–19
the holding commands / executions	על צדיי – שִׂים את זרועותיך! · על נוצת כנפיי – שִׂים את כנפיך! · על חָזִי – שִׂים את חזך! / על צדדיו – שָׂם את זרועותיו. · על נוצת כנפיו – שָׂם את כנפיו. · על חזהו – שָׂם את חזהו.	equivalent (Deut 32:11)	command → execution in the same words and order	III.26–29; b+18–b+23
the leagues	בֵּרוּ אחד / שני / שלישי – העלה אותו, (*ullû*) · הגביה אותו – …, (*šušqû*) · זרק אותו – …, (*nasāku*) · חֲצִי קָנֶה אל הקרקע – זרק אותו,	equivalent (Obad 1:4)	the first number cardinal, the others ordinal, as in the Akkadian	III.30–50; b+25–b+35; MA i+4, i+11
the eagle's question	"רָעִי, הִסְתַּכֵּל – הארץ, כְּמוֹ מָה הִיא! צָפָה, רֵעִי – הארץ," (first flight) · איך היא! (second flight, MA)	equivalent (Isa 40:22)	two verbs on the tablet	III.31–39; b+27–b+37; MA i+6, i+13
the shrinking world	· והים הרחב – כְּמְלֹא מַרְבֵּץ." נֶהֱפָכָה הארץ לַעֲרוּגָה … · והים הרחב – כְּמְלֹא שֹׁקֶת." · התבונן בים – את צדדיו בְּחַן! · הים – נהפך למים!" · הארץ – **מים**! · הים – נהפכה?] MA · "נהפך לסוללת גַּנָּן! · ערוגה שׁוּמָה, · [הים – [הארץ? ל"נ]הפך, [כ]מי תעלה!	cognate (*tarbaṣu*, *mala*)		III.33–37; b+28–b+38; MA i+3, i+7–i+10

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
Etana gives up	"הִסְתַּכַּלְתִּי – ואת הארץ איני מביט! · והים הרחב – לא תִשְׂבַּעְנָה עֵינַי! · רַעִי, לא אָעֳלָה לשמים! · שִׂים שביל, אֶתְהַלְּכָה אל עירי!"	divergence (Isa 14:13)		III.40–43
the drops	הנשר נפל – וקיבל אותו בכנפיו.	equivalent (Deut 32:11)	four times	III.45–51
the dream ↔ its fulfilment	"בְּקָרֵב? שער אָנוּ, אֶנְלִיל וְאֵאָה – צעדנו; · השתחווינו זה עם זה – אני ואתה. · בְּקָרֵב? שער סִין, שַׁמַּשׁ, אֲדַד וְאִשְׁתַּר – צעדנו; · ראיתי בית – פתחתי את חותמו, · את דלתו – דחפתי, ובאתי בו. / בשער אָנוּ, אֶנְלִיל וְאֵאָה – צעדו; · הנשר ואַתָּנָה – זה עם זה – השתחוו. · בשער סִין, שַׁמַּשׁ, אֲדַד וְאִשְׁתַּר – צעדו; · ראה בית – פתח את חותמו, · את דלתו – דחף, ובא בו.	equivalent (Gen 28:17; 41:13)	the fulfilment in the dream's words	III.b+3–b+8, b+40–b+45
the goddess	יושבת בתוכו – עלמה אחת, · … **אדירת־קול**, יפה זיוה, · כְּסֵא מָנָח – וְאִשְׁתַּר … · תחת הכסא – לְבָאִים … · קַמְתִּי – אני, ולבאים [זינקו עליי?]. · הִתְפַּלַּצְתִּי – ונבהלתי […]."	equivalent (1 Kgs 10:19; Isa 6:1)	עלמה אחת – יפה זיוה = Ludlul III 31	III.b+9–b+14
the interpretation and offer	רַעִי, מוּפָעִים חלומותיך! · לְכָה, אֶשָּׂאֲךָ לִשְׁמֵי אָנוּ! · אחרי שעלו לִשְׁמֵי אָנוּ,	cognate (*našû*, Exod 19:4)		III.b+16–b+17, b+39
MA dreams	**הִקְבִּיל**. · […] [הנשר – את החלום] · יושב לפניו: · "[…] חלומך – טוב, · הָרֹכֶס הטהור – [ב]מרומים, · "רַעִי, ראיתי חלום שני: · בחלומי – נִקְבְּצָה חַלְפָּה בבית, · בכל הארץ – כַּעֲרָמָה עָרְמוּ משאות; · שונאיהם – נחשים רעים – · […כְּ]נוּעִים – כורעים תחתיי."	equivalent (Gen 37:7–9)		MA h+2–h+22
speech formula with *iqabbi*	אֵתָנָה אליו, אל הנשר, אומר:	–	ET1's variant	MA h+13

Words (one Hebrew each; grep-checked in all corpora):

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
bēru; *nikkas*	בֵּרוּ (always vocalized); חֲצִי קָנֶה	–	Gilgameš	III.30–50
elû G; D (*ullû*); Š; *šaqû* D; *nasāku*	עָלָה; הֶעֱלָה; הֶעֱלָה; הִגְבִּיהַ; זָרַק	cognate (*elû*)	Gilgameš XI 293 for *nasāku*	III.30–50, b+25–b+39
maqātu; *maḫāru* G / Š	נָפַל; קִבֵּל / **הִקְבִּיל**	–		III.45; MA h+4
palāsu N; *dagālu*; *naṭālu*; *ṣubbû*; *barû* Gt	הִבִּיט; צָפָה; הִסְתַּכֵּל (of a dream רָאָה); הִתְבּוֹנֵן; בָּחַן	–	Gilgameš, ET2–ET3	III.31–40, b+27–b+28; MA h+14
mātu; *tâmtu rapaštu*; *mala*; *tarbaṣu*; *buginnu*; *mūšaru*; *īku*; *palgu*; *mēmē*	אֶרֶץ; הים הרחב; כִּמְלֹא; מַרְבֵּץ; שׂוֹקֶת; עֲרוּגָה; תְּעָלָה; סוֹלְלָה (since 2026-10-23 פֶּלֶג); **מים**	cognate (*mala*, *tarbaṣu*)	open decisions 1, 2, 5, 8	III.33–37, b+29–b+38; MA i+3, i+9–i+10
târu ana; *šebû*; *īnu*; *kibsu*; *alāku* Gtn	נָהַפְךְ לְ־; שָׂבַע; עַיִן; שְׁבִיל; הִתְהַלֵּךְ	cognate (*šebû*)		III.36–43
idu (eagle / man); *irtu*; *kappu*; *nāṣu*; *agappu*	צַד / זְרוֹעַ; חָזֶה; כָּנָף; נוֹצָה; אֲגַף	cognate (*nāṣu*)		III.26–29, b+18–b+23; MA g+7
ina lēt; *bēltu*; *ṣâdu*; *ēdēnu*; *ezēbu*; *ṣītu*	אֵצֶל; גְּבִירָה; צַד; לְבַד; עָזַב; מוֹצָא	cognate (*ṣâdu*, *ezēbu*)		III.15–25
atmû; *iṣṣūru*; *ina pī*; *mimmû*; *qabû*	שִׂיחָה; צִפּוֹר; מִפִּי; כֹּל אֲשֶׁר; אָמַר	–	Ludlul, Theodicy (*atmû*)	III.3–8
ḫabābu (water); *danānu* D; *rabû*; *biltu*; *tarāku*	פְּכָה (מְפַכִּים); חִזֵּק; גָּדַל; מַשָּׂא; **הָלַם**	–		III.32, 52, b+24
šukênu; *bâ'u*; *bābu*; *qerbu*; *itti aḫāmiš*	עָבַר; הִשְׁתַּחֲוָה (since 2026-10-23 צָעַד); שָׁעַר; קָרֵב; זֶה עִם זֶה	cognate (*qerbu*)		III.b+3–b+6, b+40–b+43
bītu; *kunukku*; *daltu*; *sakāpu*; *erēbu*; *petû*	בַּיִת; חוֹתָם; דֶּלֶת; דָּחַף; בָּא; פָּתַח	cognate (*petû*)		III.b+7–b+8, b+44–b+45; a+3–a+4

Source	Hebrew	Tag	Notes	Lines
ardatu; *ištêt*; *ruṣṣunu*; *zīmu*; *kussû*; *nadû* stat.; *šaplu*; *lābu*; *tebû*; *šaḫāṭu*	עַלְמָה ; אַחַת ; **אדירת־קול** ; זִיו ; כִּסֵּא ; מַנָּח ; תַּחַת ; לָבִיא (לְבָאִים) ; זָקֵן ; קָם	cognate (*lābu*)	Ludlul III 31	III.b+9–b+13
galātu; *parādu*; *wapû* Š; *šuttu*; *damqu*; *pašāru*	הִתְפַּלֵּץ ; נִבְהַל ; הוֹפִיעַ ; חֲלוֹם (חֲלוֹמוֹת) ; טוֹב ; פָּשַׁר	cognate (*pašāru*)	open decision 3	III.b+14–b+16, a+18; MA h+6
našû; *šamû ša Ani*; *emēdu*; *nukaribbu*; *šāninu*	נָשָׂא ; שְׁמֵי אָנוּ ; **נִשְׁעָן** ; מִתְחָרֶה ; גִּנָּן	cognate (*našû*)		III.b+17–b+39, c+7
kašādu; *ālu*; *bašālu*; *tēqītu*; *nīšu* (oath); *pāna šakānu*	הִגִּיעַ ; עִיר ; בִּשֵּׁל ; סִיכָה ; חַיִּים ; שָׂם פָּנִים	cognate (*bašālu*)		III.a+3–a+18
MA: *markasu*; *ellu*; *elâtu*; *šēpu*; *āšibu*; *maḫru*	רֹכֶס ; טָהוֹר ; מְרוֹמִים ; רֶגֶל ; יוֹשֵׁב ; לִפְנֵי	–	Enūma eliš, Gilgameš	MA h+2–h+12
MA: *biltu* stat. *bablat*; *nadānu*; *nišū*; *ṣabātu*; *qātu*	מַשָּׂא – מוּבָא ; נָתַן ; הָאֲנָשִׁים ; תָּפַס ; יָד	–		MA h+7–h+10
MA: *paḫāru*; *elpetu*; *kiššatu*; *qarānu* / *qurunnu*; *zāʾeru*; *ṣerru*; *kanāšu* / *kanšu*	נִקְבַּץ ; חֵלְפָּה ; כֹּל ; עָרֵם / עֲרֵמָה ; שׁוֹנֵא ; נָחַשׁ ; כָּרַע ; כָּנוּעַ /	–	Sum. *a-numun*$_2$ חלפה ; open decision 4	MA h+15–h+19
MA: *bāšītu*; *ai*; *šemû*; *šina*; *ittu*; *mūšaru šaknu*	יֵשׁ ; אַל ; שָׁמַע ; שְׁתַּיִם ; אוֹת ; עֲרוּגָה שׁוּמָה	cognate (*ittu*)		MA g+8–g+11, i+9

Notes for the clean translation

For the coordinator's introduction to the whole epic (`translation--intro.rtl.md`):

1. **Six fragmentary versions, one story, no end.** OB Morgan and Susa (18th–17th c. BCE), the MA tablets from Aššur
   (13th–11th c.), and SB I–III from Nineveh (7th c.); every version is broken, and the end of the epic is lost in all.
   Labels like `a+1` mark the first preserved line after a gap of unknown length; `[]`, `…`, `?` and italics are part
   of the text, not decoration.
2. **The plot in four movements:** kingship comes down from heaven and Kiš has a king but no heir (OBM, SB I); the
   fable of the eagle and the serpent – oath, betrayal, Šamaš's trap, the eagle in the pit (OBS, MA a–c, SB II); the
   childless king's prayer and the rescue of the eagle (SB II, OBM b–c, MA d–f); the dreams and the two flights to
   heaven (SB III, MA g–i). The fable is not a digression: the two needs – a king without a son, an eagle without
   wings – are joined by the god.
3. **Šamaš directs everything**: judge of the oath, maker of the trap, sender of the "man", giver of the speech of
   birds. Ištar holds the plant of birth and sits enthroned with lions at the top of heaven.
4. **Key words kept as the Akkadian has them:** `שֻׁם` (*šumu*) is both "name" and "offspring"; `עשב הלידה` is the "plant
   of birth" (Foster's "plant of life" in MA f+5 is an error); `רֵעִי` (*ibrī*) is the eagle's and Etana's word for each
   other; `בֶּרוּ` is a "double hour" of walking, c. 10 km (three of them c. 30 km); a half-reed (`חֲצִי קָנֶה`) c. 1.5 m.
5. **Repetition is the art.** Identical Akkadian has identical Hebrew: the speech formulas, the oath and its curses,
   the hunt refrain, Šamaš's command and its execution, the plea, the leagues of the flights, the eagle's "look, my
   friend", the drops, and above all the dream and its fulfilment "in the same words" (III b+3–b+8 ↔ b+40–b+45).
   Where a copy differs by a word, the Hebrew differs by that word.
6. **The versions differ in meaningful ways**: SB alone has the speech of birds and the dream of the gods' gates and
   of Ištar; MA alone has two kingship-dreams (Joseph-like), the eagle's identifying Etana and its vow, and gives the
   description of the shrinking earth to Etana; the OB tablets are the shortest and the most direct.

7. **Names are vocalized** where unvocalized Hebrew would mislead: אֶתָנָה (not "אֶתְּנָה", "I will give"), שַׁמַּשׁ
(the god) vs הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ (the sun), אָנוּ (not "we"), אֵט, שַׁבַּן, אִשְׁתַּר, סִין (a ghost).
8. **Biblical words deliberately absent from the Hebrew text** (they belong to the notes): סֻלָּם, מִגְדָּל,
רָקִיעַ, עֲקָרָה, דּוּדָאִים, גּוֹזָל, פָּקַח, חֶרֶם, פָּתַר, שְׁאוֹל; נָשָׁר, נָחָשׁ, שׁוּחָה, בּוֹר, רֶשֶׁת,
אֵבֶר, נוֹצָה, חֲרָפָה, פַּח appear only for their Akkadian counterparts.
9. **The afterlife of the story**: Akkad-period seals (24th–22nd c.) show the man on the eagle; the Sumerian King List
calls Etana "the shepherd who went up to heaven" and names his son Balīḫ as successor; in Gilgameš VII Etana sits in
the house of dust (יושב אֶתָנָה, יושב שַׁבַּן).
10. **The main biblical comparisons** (for the reader of the commentary): Gen 11:4 and Isa 14:12–15 (ascent and fall,
as [divergence]); Exod 19:4 and Deut 32:11 (the carrying eagle); Gen 28:12–17 (the dream of heaven's gate);
Gen 37 and 40–41 (dreams, doubled dreams, interpretation; the pit); Gen 30 and 1 Sam 1 (the plea for a child, the
"name"); Ezek 17 (eagle, poplar, oath, net, garden beds); 1 Kgs 10:19–20 (the lion throne).